



St. Joseph's Academy

Est. 1868

2026-2027

STUDENT HANDBOOK

CHANGES OR ADDITIONS MADE TO POLICIES INCLUDED IN LAST YEAR'S HANDBOOK ARE IN RED.

ST. JOSEPH'S ACADEMY HANDBOOK

2026-2027

HANDBOOK INTRODUCTION

MISSION STATEMENT

The mission of St. Joseph's Academy is to educate young women as responsible and unifying members of the world community. In the spirit and charism of the Sisters of St. Joseph, St. Joseph's Academy offers opportunities for faith development in the Catholic tradition, academic excellence and personal growth.

VISION STATEMENT

We see SJA as a place where young women experience a faith community, the pursuit of academic excellence and clarity of vision for the future so that their lives reflect confidence, dignity and self-worth; gospel compassion and justice; and the grace of bearers of reconciliation in our world.

PHILOSOPHY

St. Joseph's Academy is a secondary school for girls founded in 1868 by the Sisters of St. Joseph and staffed by the Sisters and dedicated laypersons. Primarily a college-preparatory school, St. Joseph's Academy strives for high standards of excellence in its academic program and its religious orientation within the Catholic tradition. The school believes in being responsive to the times while being faithful to the best that tradition has to offer. It affirms the principles of American democracy and especially attempts to foster responsible freedom. By the development of a critical understanding of society and its values, the school hopes to prepare students to serve as responsible citizens who will make positive contributions to society. St. Joseph's Academy seeks to broaden the perspective of students so that they see themselves as planetary people and stewards of the earth's resources.

The faculty recognizes parents as the primary educators who extend to and share with the school the responsibility for the education of youth. The home and family are viewed as the basic educational environment where values are communicated and character formation is begun and continued. St. Joseph's Academy affirms the importance of open lines of communication between parents and educators and sees collaboration as essential.

The Academy values education that is seeking the development of the whole person. It recognizes the importance of the quality of relationships among students, teachers, administration and the staff of the learning community. The faculty is concerned with learning that makes a difference: making for more sensitive living with a greater range, variety and richness because of the underlying confidences of the student in her own self-worth and her ability to live life fully.

The school's philosophy of education centers on the principle that the student, not the teacher, needs to be the primary agent in the education process. The teacher's key role is that of organizing and designing effective learning experiences and facilitating the student's learning. Learning means acquiring both cognitive skills (knowledge, comprehension, application, analysis, synthesis and evaluation) and affective skills (appreciating, valuing and responding).

The school recognizes that the gospel values Jesus taught and lived are at the heart of its religious orientation and that these Christian values are often at odds with those of society. The faculty affirms the importance of personalizing the Catholic Christian tradition and heritage in an atmosphere of community and service. The school endeavors to assist students in their moral development and in becoming life-affirming, life-loving, life-sharing persons after the model of Jesus.

The program of studies, co-curricular activities, Academic Counseling Center program and total learning environment attempts to respond to the characteristics and needs of students as adolescents in their physical,

emotional, intellectual, social, cultural and spiritual development; as members of an affluent society; as young women seeking to form realistic and personally fulfilling career plans within the context of becoming contributing members of society.

St. Joseph's Academy offers a college-preparatory curriculum which includes the theoretical and practical sciences, the arts and humanities and theology studies. The program of studies is planned to prepare students to continue their education in ways that best suit their needs and talents. A variety of methods and community resources are used in dealing with the various subject areas. The faculty recognizes the importance of both the content of a particular discipline and the processes which provide order, direction and opportunity for active learning. Faculty, parents and students are open to thoughtful experimentation and innovation which promise more effective achievement of educational goals.

Co-curricular activities are provided for the development of interests and talents. Desirable outcomes of such activities are growth in leadership, initiative, responsibility and cooperation. Students are encouraged to use their gifts and abilities not only for their own enjoyment, but also in service to others.

The school's discipline system is designed to uphold the dignity of the individual, to provide an atmosphere conducive to study and to respect the needs of all members of the school community. What is essential and desirable at all times is that each student assumes responsibility for her own actions.

The faculty, parents and students of St. Joseph's Academy believe that those in the school are both capable of and responsible for creating a life-enhancing environment. They affirm the importance of giving attention to the quality of life for everyone in the school, not just for students, but for all who live there each day. They believe that striving to live the values of Jesus -- love, justice and service -- is truly the way to grow in the art of living.

HISTORY

St. Joseph's Academy's history began 158 years ago, shortly after the Civil War. The Sisters of St. Joseph were asked to take over an orphanage that cared for 11 children left parentless by the war. On October 22, 1868, four Sisters arrived by boat from New Orleans. The leader of the group was 21-year-old Mother Albina Thollot from Bourg, France. In less than two weeks, she established a school on what is today Seventh Street and named it St. Joseph's Academy. In 1869, the school was moved to Fourth and Florida streets.

In 1875, SJA was granted a charter under the laws of the state of Louisiana. In 1877, the Academy had its first graduate: Josephine Bahlinger.

As the Academy continued to grow, Mother Albina realized that new facilities were needed. She bought the property on the corner of Church and Florida streets. The original building was moved to the back of the property and became the orphanage. On the bottom floor, she opened a steam laundry to help raise funds for the new school. The laundry was sold to Kean's in 1910.

The school Mother Albina built cost \$35,000. The first student enrolled was Carrie Elder Gibbens. By 1910, there were 340 students, 39 boarders and 30 orphans.

SJA was accredited by the state of Louisiana in 1926 and has been accredited by the Louisiana State Department of Education since 1931 and will continue to be accredited by Lumen Catholic School Accreditation through the Institute for the Transformation of Catholic Education at The Catholic University of America.

Mother Alice Biguenet was named principal of SJA in 1930. At the time, enrollment at the downtown Academy topped 500, and the student body had outgrown the collection of makeshift buildings which

served as classrooms. Mother Alice acquired a 15-acre tract on Broussard Street, and in September of 1941, the new St. Joseph's Academy opened its doors.

In 1947, Mother Alice oversaw the construction of Medaille Hall, and in 1965, she directed the building of the new convent, children's home, cafeteria and chapel complex. She died shortly before the Sisters moved into the convent, named Mother Alice Hall in her honor. Today, her picture hangs in its lobby.

In 1966, the Sisters appointed lay advisors to serve on the SJA Advisory Board. The SJA Foundation of Baton Rouge was established in 1968, as part of the school's 100-year celebration. Kindergarten was closed after the 1969-70 school year, and plans were made to phase out the elementary grades. In 1977, SJA became a high school, educating students in grades 9-12 only.

In 1988, dedication ceremonies marked the completion of the Activity Center and the renovation of the former gym and stage areas into the library and world language department.

In 1990, the Sisters dissolved SJA's Lay Advisory Board and established the SJA Board of Directors, a policy-making board responsible for the viability of the school. Corporate members were charged with ensuring faithfulness to the mission.

In 1991, SJA was named a Blue Ribbon National School of Excellence by the United States Department of Education. The school would be acclaimed as a Blue Ribbon School again in 1996, 2002, 2016 and 2023.

SJA's laptop computer program was introduced in 1998. Wireless internet access was installed campus wide, and construction began on the Irene W. Pennington Science Center, which opened in 1999. In 2002, SJA was one of three schools in the nation to be recognized by the United States Department of Education for excellence in technology.

The Mission Effectiveness Team (MET) was established in 2003 to ascertain the effectiveness of the SJA mission and ensure a balance between its three pillars of faith development, academic excellence and personal growth. The MET ensures faithfulness to the mission through understanding, planning, assessing, informing, validating and assuming responsibility for the sustainability of St. Joseph's Academy.

On June 1, 2004, SJA implemented a new president/principal administrative model, with Sister Adele Lambert, CSJ, a 1954 graduate, becoming SJA's first president and Linda Fryoux Harvison, class of 1966, becoming the first lay principal. The name of the Board of Directors was changed to the SJA School Board; the Corporate Board (comprised of Sisters of St. Joseph) was renamed the SJA Board of Directors.

In August of 2005, the school's enrollment grew to more than 1,000 students as SJA accepted 250 New Orleans-area students displaced by Hurricane Katrina. Nearly all returned to their homes and schools for the start of the spring 2006 semester.

With the beginning of the 2005-2006 academic year, the Academy began to build upon its fine arts program by adding new electives in the visual and performing arts as a complement to the academic core curriculum. SJA was designated as Baton Rouge's first Local Historic Landmark by the Metropolitan Council of the City of Baton Rouge and Parish of East Baton Rouge. The school hired its first full-time college advisor.

The SJA Foundation Board was reestablished in 2006. A full-time campus minister was hired for the 2006-2007 school year. SJA was named the winner of the 2007 Outstanding School Team Achievement Award by the Consortium of School Networking.

For the 2007-2008 academic year, SJA moved from Dell laptop computers to Toshiba tablet computers in order to provide more integration of technology into the curriculum. SJA was the 2007-2008 winner of the

Southern Quality Ford Cup as the most outstanding overall athletic program in Class 5A. SJA is the first all-girls school to win the competition.

SJA celebrated its 140th anniversary during the 2008-2009 academic year. The Academy also marked the 10th anniversary of its laptop computer program and student-run Help Desk.

In November 2008, SJA announced and kicked off the public phase of the Always the Academy Capital Campaign. The campaign is the significant element of the overall Master Plan, and the goal is to construct an Arts Center to bring even greater balance to SJA's outstanding core curriculum. The project focuses on providing a superior facility for classes in fine arts, music, dance and drama and commits SJA even more solidly to the mission of educating the whole person.

During the 2009-2010 academic year, renovations to Mother Alice Hall were completed, transforming the Sisters of St. Joseph's former residence and children's home into spacious classrooms for theology and visual arts, a cooking lab, sewing lab, art lab and gallery and weight room. The use of Mother Alice Hall is a gift from the Congregation of St. Joseph valued at \$6 million.

To honor its patron, St. Joseph, the original Academy building was renamed St. Joseph Hall.

SJA is the recipient of the 2010 Spotlight School Award from the Lausanne Laptop Institute. The award recognizes schools whose laptop/tablet computer programs serve as international models of innovation and expertise.

In June of 2010, SJA rolled out the new Fujitsu T730 tablet computers to students, faculty and staff. The process to select new units began in the fall of 2009.

Following a March 2011 site visit by a Quality Assurance Review Team of the Council on Accreditation and School Improvement, Southern Association of Colleges and Schools (SACS), SJA will continue as an accredited member. SJA has been continuously accredited by SACS since 1931.

SJA hosted a ground-breaking ceremony for the Academy Arts Center on May 2, 2011. The building now houses a choral studio, dance studio, black box theater, four large classrooms, lobby and gathering spaces to accommodate SJA's rapidly expanding visual and performing arts curriculum.

The name of the SJA Development Office was changed to Mission Advancement. The change reflects the Academy's commitment to ensuring that all work is undertaken in support of the mission of the Sisters of St. Joseph and the school.

Academy President Sister Adele Lambert, CSJ, retired at the end of the 2011-2012 academic year. She became the first president in the school's history when it moved to the president-principal model of administration in 2004. Jan Rhorer Breen, class of 1969, was named Sr. Adele's successor. She is the Academy's first lay president.

The 2012-2013 academic year began with the much-anticipated opening of the Academy Arts Center, a 29,000-square-foot facility that houses SJA's vibrant visual and performing arts curriculum. A record 804 students were enrolled in an arts elective during the year.

SJA partnered with St. Vincent de Paul during 2013-2014 to help fight hunger in the Baton Rouge community. Over the course of the year, students, faculty and staff provided approximately 5,000 brown bag lunches, called Sticker Sacks, for distribution each Tuesday.

Technology continued to play an integral role in SJA's educational philosophy. When icy roads closed school

for three days in January 2014, SJA held a virtual school day, utilizing a full array of technology tools to enable students to learn from home.

Principal Linda Fryoux Harvison '66 retired at the end of the 2014-2015 academic year. She became the first lay principal in the Academy's history in 2004. Dr. Michele Lambert was named Mrs. Harvison's successor.

SJA continued its partnership with St. Vincent de Paul, providing Sticker Sacks each week to help combat hunger in the local community. SJA also joined forces with Catholic High School for a food drive in conjunction with the Challenge Day competition. The two schools collected more than 95,000 pounds of nonperishable food items for the Greater Baton Rouge Food Bank, drawing Twitter support from talk show host Ellen DeGeneres.

The Andrea Clesi McMakin '74 STEM Lab was dedicated in June of 2015, and the academic year began with students utilizing the lab to explore cross-curricular, hands-on learning opportunities in the fields of science, technology, engineering and math. The latest technological tools are incorporated into students' work, including laser cutters and 3D printers. Teachers bring students to the STEM lab to work on projects in all areas of study; the STEM director offers one-to-one help as students bring their projects to fruition.

The 2016-2017 academic year began with the opening of the Innovation and Design Lab, a project-based learning resource for all SJA students. Using the Innovation and Design model, students take an idea from inception to completion. Employing design-based thinking (identify, interpret, ideate, invent, implement, improve), students create possible solutions to problems using the 21st century skill of collaboration, critical thinking, communication and creation. Distinctive qualities include the potential for failure and how students regroup/respond for a solution. Another feature is empathy; projects involve solving a problem in one's community or world.

SJA was named a National Blue Ribbon School for the fourth time in school history. The Academy was among just 50 private schools in the country to be recognized in 2016 as a National Blue Ribbon School by the U.S. Department of Education. SJA was one of only nine schools in the country to have achieved Blue Ribbon status four times: 1991, 1996, 2002 and 2016.

Stacia Andricain was named principal of St. Joseph's Academy in September 2017. She began her career at SJA in 1996 and became a member of the school's administration in 2002.

Throughout the 2017-2018 academic year, construction continued on the Academy Student Center, which was dedicated on August 8, 2018, to kick off the year-long celebration of the 150th anniversary of SJA's founding in 1868 by the Sisters of St. Joseph. The state-of-the-art complex enables SJA to enhance its health and wellness curriculum; expand its intramural athletic program; continue its outstanding interscholastic athletic program; further the wellbeing of each student through exercise, conditioning and learning opportunities focused on healthy lifestyles; and create much-needed space to celebrate masses and other school events with extended families, grandparents and friends.

SJA was the winner of the 12th annual Louisiana High School Online Technology Challenge. SJA has competed in the state-wide event since its inception, and this year marks the first time an Academy team finished first.

The SJA Cheerleaders won the 2018 National High School Cheerleading Championship in the Super Varsity Division.

During 2018-2019, St. Joseph's Academy celebrated the 150th anniversary of its founding in 1868 by the Sisters of St. Joseph. A year's worth of activities commemorated the milestone year, including the dedication and blessing of the new Academy Student Center; a mass of Thanksgiving to celebrate the 150th anniversary

of the arrival of the Sisters in Baton Rouge; a Day of Service for students, alumnae, parents and friends; and a speaker series featuring internationally known author and death penalty opponent Sister Helen Prejean; *New York Times* bestselling author Laura Schroff; Olympic gold medal-winning gymnast Mary Lou Retton; the Catholic Institute's Dr. Allen Hunt; and political strategists James Carville and Mary Matalin. The year culminated on April 27, 2019, with the 150th Anniversary Gala at Raising Cane's River Center.

The Academy was honored as the Outstanding Youth in Philanthropy Award winner by the Greater Baton Rouge Chapter of the Association of Fundraising professionals.

Three hundred eighty-five students took AP courses, with 82.1 percent scoring a 3 or higher on their AP exams to earn college credit. SJA had a record 125 AP Scholar Award winners, including two National AP Scholars.

The fall of 2019 saw the swim team win its ninth consecutive Division I-Class 5A state championship and the cross country team win its fourth consecutive Class 5A state title. The track and field team made history by winning the indoor state championship for the first time in school history (February 2020).

In the spring of 2020, SJA responded to the coronavirus pandemic (COVID-19) and suspended on-campus classes beginning on March 13. All schools across Louisiana remained closed for the remainder of the school year. SJA developed a Continuous Learning Plan in order for students to continue their schoolwork remotely for the fourth quarter. End-of-the-year events and all summer on-campus activities were held remotely or cancelled.

SJA began the 2020-2021 academic year with a hybrid plan of on-campus and online learning. Each student was on campus two days a week and learned remotely two days a week. Wednesdays were at-home work days for students for virtual group collaboration, homework, assignments and Zoom meetings with counselors, teachers and support services personnel.

Aggressive mitigation efforts and a robust approach to environmental cleaning helped keep the Academy community safe, and students returned to five days a week of on-campus learning on September 14. Safety measures and protocols were tightened, and large gatherings were put on hold. SJA used the gift of technology to celebrate schoolwide Liturgies of the Word with virtual ceremonies originating from the school's chapel.

With the start of the spring semester, the administration created strategies to host end-of-the-year events, especially for the senior class of 2021.

SJA began the celebration of the Year of St. Joseph with a virtual Feast of St. Joseph prayer service and food collection for St. Vincent de Paul.

As the 2021-2022 school year began, campus life returned to normal. Social distancing was discontinued, and the mask mandate was lifted. Regular school activities and events were reinstated.

SJA continued the celebration of the Year of St. Joseph through December 8, 2021, and incorporated the Examen into the daily schedule. The entire school community paused at 1:53 each afternoon to pray the Examen, a sharing of the heart which helps us review the day with God, grow in faith and become aware of God's sustaining presence in our everyday lives.

Ground was broken in February 2022 on the Student Commons.

The 2022-2023 academic year saw a number of highlights, including the dedication of the Fife Student Commons. The newest addition to campus provides comfortable table seating for indoor dining; auditorium-style seating for presentations; spaces for individual and group study, meetings and evening events; and

additional outdoor dining and meeting spaces on the Investar Bank Quad.

SJA dedicated the orchard to the Sisters of St. Joseph. The orchard was planted with pecan trees in 1940 when the Sisters purchased 15 acres of farmland on Broussard Street. The trees grew from pecans that were gathered from the last crop of trees on the grounds of SJA's former home on Church Street in downtown Baton Rouge.

The SJA soccer team made history, winning the state championship for the first time in the program's 32-year existence.

A new entrepreneurship class was established to introduce students to the world of small business ownership and management. The course builds knowledge of types of business ownership, legal issues, business finance/start-up costs, business trends, site selection, marketing, pricing strategies and the development of a business plan on the students' product/service of choice.

With the doubling in size of the school's STEM Lab and its relocation to Medaille Hall, the library was renamed the Technology and Learning Center. In addition to housing the STEM Lab, the TLC is home to the Learning Center, which provides free-of-charge assistance to any student needing extra help with math, science, English or writing; the Writing Center; the student-run Help Desk; and the eSports practice and competition room.

During the 2023-2024 school year, St. Joseph's Academy was named a National Blue Ribbon School for the fifth time. SJA is one of just eight schools in the country to have earned five Blue Ribbons.

SJA dedicated the new Pillars Plaza, a green space located between Medaille Hall and the Activity Center, to celebrate and symbolize the three pillars of the SJA mission statement: faith development, academic excellence and personal growth.

St. Joe Dough, SJA's first-ever student-run enterprise, opened for business, selling cookies to students, faculty, staff and parents. Students in SJA's Entrepreneurship class built the business from scratch, learning about the world of small business ownership and management through market research and customer surveys, creating a business plan and by studying finance and start-up costs, trends, site selection, marketing and pricing strategies. St. Joe Dough's kitchen and storefront are located in the Sister Agatha Dining Hall.

SJA was named a STEM School of Excellence for the second year in a row by the International Technology and Engineering Educators Association.

A new statue of St. Joseph the Worker was dedicated in December of 2024. The statue is a reminder of the sanctity of our daily work and the importance of joyful action in service to the dear neighbor without distinction.

For the third year in a row, SJA was named a STEM School of Excellence by the International Technology and Engineering Educators Association for 2024-2025. The ITEEA recognizes superior K-12 and post-secondary STEM programs in schools around the world.

Following the successful debut of St. Joe Dough, SJA launched a new chapter in entrepreneurship education in 2024-2025. The newly created role of director of entrepreneurship spearheaded the continued growth of the student-run cookie business. The Entrepreneurship Club hosted business fairs in the fall and spring semesters to showcase the products and services of students who are already small business owners.

SJA introduced a new broadcast journalism course in 2024-2025. A broadcasting studio in The Technology and Learning Center offers students the opportunity to produce newscasts and podcast episodes as well as

twice-weekly morning announcements broadcast into classrooms across campus.

Driven by a strong mission, a commitment to excellence and a desire for continuous growth, St. Joseph's Academy embarked upon a new strategic planning process with the start of the 2025-2026 academic year. Four strategic focus areas were identified to guide our work for the next three years and further enhance our standing as a pillar of excellence in the Baton Rouge community: Identity, Academic Excellence, Holistic Wellness and Organizational Vitality.

To start the 2025-2026 academic year, SJA created the Faculty Fellows Program, a leadership development initiative designed to support employees who are interested in exploring roles in educational leadership and administration.

SJA was named an ITEEA STEM School of Excellence in 2025-2026 for the fourth year in a row.

The water feature in the courtyard between Pennington Science Center and Medaille Hall was dedicated to the young women of SJA. A plaque incorporated into the Fountain of Living Water reads: Dedicated to the young women of St. Joseph's Academy, whose faith, wisdom and confident inspire the future.

A newly created program, the Academy Scholars Program, is a PSAT/NMSQT-focused endeavor for invited students to maximize their academic and test-taking skills through tutoring and in-school practice.

PORTRAIT OF AN SJA GRADUATE

Standing on a firm foundation of our Catholic faith and traditions, with arms wide open to the challenges of the world;

Focusing her eyes on the choices and diversity before her, with ears listening to all sounds, the voices of the needy;

Serving with a compassionate heart, "the dear neighbor."

With a mind and the discerning spirit that embraces life-long learning in an ever-changing world, living as the good steward of Earth, so that "all may be one,"

The journey begun at the Academy in sanctity, joy and action,

The SJA graduate leads her family and community as a "woman for others."

PORTRAIT OF AN SJA FACULTY MEMBER

Embracing the mission of St. Joseph's Academy, the faculty member is grounded in personal integrity and faith, being a role model while striving for excellence in all endeavors. Welcoming a diversity of learners, serving in "gentleness, joy and peace" while creating a student-centered environment. Committed to life-long learning, an expert in a chosen discipline of teaching. Leading in building a community of faith and solidarity with worldwide colleagues, the SJA faculty member reaches out to the dear neighbor so that all may be one.

ALMA MATER

Lyrics by Cecilia Marks '54 and Margo Kirsch '54; music by Patricia Marks

Lift up your voices to our Alma Mater.

Pledge her your loyalty as long as she may live.

Always remember the spirit and the way

Of Sanctity, Joy and Action, Dearest SJA.

High fly her banners to the world proclaiming

Immortal standards in colors red and white:

Red for devotion, white for purity.

Imparting her wisdom through the years,

This is SJA.

COLORS

Red and white

MASCOT

Redstickers

EMBLEM

Shield

The shield on the floor in the foyer entrance to the Academy is the shield of the Sisters of St. Joseph. Tradition has it that no one is to step on the shield out of respect for the Sisters.

MOTTO

Sanctity, Joy and Action

LEADERSHIP (ADMINISTRATIVE TEAM)

Stephanie Spielman Cargile, President

cargiles@sjabr.org; (225) 388-2210

The president articulates the mission and ensures the charism of the Sisters of St. Joseph is alive in the school. The president gives direction to the Board of Directors and the SJA Foundation Board as well as oversees the fiscal administration of the Academy and the investments. The president partners with Facilities, Communications, Finance and Mission Advancement and represents the Academy to its various publics.

Jan Rhorer Breen, President Emeritus

breenj@sjabr.org

Retiring at the conclusion of the 2025-2026 academic year after 14 years as president of SJA, Jan Breen was named president emeritus and will spend the beginning of the 2026-2027 academic year assisting with the transition of her successor and seeing unfinished initiatives through to their conclusion.

Stacia B. Andricain, Principal

andricains@sjabr.org; (225) 388-2217

The primary duty of the principal is to effect a community environment in which the mission of the school can be realized. The Principal is responsible for all aspects of school management and is invested with the authority to require that all goals, programs and objectives are in harmony with the mission, philosophy, policies and traditions of SJA.

As the primary representative of SJA, the principal is the academic leader of the school community; provides leadership in developing and interpreting the mission, philosophy and objectives of the school with faculty, staff, parents and students; maintains a constant presence to the school community by interacting regularly with students, faculty, staff and parents; and works with the Administrative Team to facilitate the day-to-day operation of the school.

Aubrey DeJohn, Dean of Academics

dejohna@sjabr.org; (225) 388-2269

The dean of academics, working in collaboration with the principal and dean of curriculum and instruction, directs the academic progress of the school and evaluates students' academic progress with the Counseling Center. She works in collaboration with the Counseling Center, admissions director and registrar on student scheduling and works in collaboration with the principal to hire new faculty members. The dean works to implement the academic policies as outlined in the School and Faculty/Staff handbooks.

Melissa Bahlinger Brocato, Dean of Curriculum and Instruction

brocatom@sjabr.org; (225) 388-2215

In collaboration with the principal and dean of academics, the dean of curriculum and instruction provides leadership and vision in the ongoing planning, implementation, development and evaluation of the school's curriculum. She works to ensure that the school's educational objectives are aligned with the school's mission, accreditation, standards and practices to yield the highest standards of student achievement and instructional excellence.

Christina Richardson, Dean of Women

mylesc@sjabr.org; (225) 388-2278

The dean of women is responsible for discipline. She administers the discipline system adopted by the school to work with students in a fair and caring manner, correcting students' behavior in how they are to relate to one another and how they represent themselves and the school.

ADDITIONAL CONTACT INFORMATION

For additional information about various aspects of campus life, please contact the following staff members. A complete faculty/staff directory is available under the About section on our website.

Activities

Aimee Cronan, Activities Coordinator

cronana@sjabr.org; (225) 388-2266

Athletics

Erin Hart, Athletic Director

harte@sjabr.org; (225) 388-2260

Campus Ministry

Rachael Duchmann, Campus Minister

duchmannr@sjabr.org; (225) 388-2295

College Advising

Allison Hipwell Bruton, M.Ed., College Advising Director

brutona@sjabr.org; (225) 388-2299

College Prep and Testing

Jonathan Durocher, Assistant Dean of College Prep and Testing

durocherj@sjabr.org; (225) 388-2212

Communications

Mindy Brodhead Averitt, Communications Director

averittm@sjabr.org; (225) 388-2258

Counseling Center

Linday Carlino, Department Chair

carlinol@sjabr.org; (225) 388-2225

Dining Hall

Lauren Guy, Food Services Director

lguy@sagedining.com; (225) 388-2247

Discipline

Brianna Sommers, Assistant Dean of Women
sommersb@sjabr.org; (225) 388-2275

Help Desk

Sharon Cashio, Technology Operations Manager
cashios@sjabr.org; (225) 388-2246

Mission Integration

Jade Spears, Mission Integration Director
spearsj@sjabr.org; (225) 388-2296

Registrar

Cristina Latiolais, Registrar
latiolaisc@sjabr.org; (224) 388-2226

Science Fair

Jacqueline Savoia, Science Fair Director
savoiaj@sjabr.org; (225) 388-2213

Service

Isabel Knaup, Assistant Campus Minister, Service Coordinator
knaupi@sjabr.org; (225) 388-2221

Wellness

Melissa Shaw, Wellness Educator
shawm@sjabr.org; (225) 388-2347

HANDBOOK ACKNOWLEDGMENT FORM

The School Handbook for Parents and Students is being provided to communicate pertinent information about your school. It is your responsibility to read this handbook and to be informed of its contents.

Signing and returning the Handbook Acknowledgment Form on MySJA ensures that you have read the handbook and agree to follow and uphold the policies and practices of St. Joseph's Academy. Your signature also grants permission for your daughter's photograph, video image, name and/or interview answers to be used for publicity purposes, on the SJA website, in Academy-produced publications and in various SJA and external media outlets, including social media platforms. (See the Communications section of this handbook for complete policy.)

Failure to abide by the regulations and policies of the school handbook by either the student or the parent/guardian may result in the student's removal from school.

The School Handbook can be amended at any time during the school year. Students will be notified of changes via email; parents will be notified via the Parents Newsletter. Final interpretation of all items is determined by the administration.

The Handbook Acknowledgment Form must be completed and submitted using MySJA by **Friday, August 7, 2026**. If you experience issues with this form, please contact Registrar Cristina Latiolais at latiolaisc@sjabr.org or (225) 388-2226.

PERSONALLY IDENTIFIABLE INFORMATION

As a non-public school, SJA is not required to abide by the state law which requires parents to make an

election at the beginning of each year as to whether you grant or deny consent for this school to collect your child's Personally Identifiable Information (PII) and disclose it to the Louisiana Office of Student Financial Assistance (LOSFA) for TOPS and other financial aid or to the state's colleges and universities (institutions) for admissions. We will share this information unless you request through your daughter's grade-level counselor that it be withheld.

CUSTODY INFORMATION

St. Joseph's Academy abides by the provisions of the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA) with respect to the rights of parents and, in the event of divorce, the rights of custodial and noncustodial parents. In the latter case, absent a court order to the contrary, the school will provide the noncustodial parent access to academic records and other school-related information regarding the student. If there is a court order specifying that no information is to be given, it is the responsibility of the custodial parent to provide the school with a copy of the court order. We do not need the complete court order, only the portion dealing with custody. Please direct questions to Principal Stacia Andricain at andricains@sjabr.org.

ARCHIVES

The SJA Archives, located in Mother Alice Hall, contains records dating back to the beginning of St. Joseph's Academy. A well-documented, highly organized source of memorabilia covering the history of the Academy and Baton Rouge is on file.

We are grateful for and appreciative of the donation of items. To donate items to Archives, please contact Archivist Stacy Rennhoff at rennhoffs@sjabr.org or (225) 388-2318.

FAITH DEVELOPMENT

As a Catholic school rooted in the Gospel and our charism, we are committed to nurturing the spiritual, moral and personal formation of every student. Our Faith Development program exists to ensure that the mission of the school is lived, woven into daily life, academic learning and community culture.

The Director of Mission Integration leads this work, guiding the school's efforts to form students who think deeply, act justly and grow in faith. In collaboration with the Campus Minister and the Assistant Campus Minister/Service Coordinator, the team provides a holistic and enriching Catholic experience for all students. Together, they oversee liturgical life, retreats, service-learning opportunities, pastoral support and programs that help students understand and embrace their call to serve the dear neighbor.

Through this integrated approach, our school strives to cultivate a community where faith is enriched, lived with conviction and expressed through compassionate action.

CHARISM THEMES

Each year, the St. Joseph's Academy community is guided by a charism theme which supports the vision and mission of the Sisters of St. Joseph and SJA.

2026-2027

Leadership: Weave One Heart

This charism theme highlights collaboration and responsibility. As we strive to weave one heart, we are reminded of the first Sisters of St. Joseph who wove lace to support their service to the dear neighbor without distinction.

2027-2028

Great-Hearted Love: Serving the Dear Neighbor

This charism theme calls us to address the needs of the times and all people while working for systemic change to promote a culture of inclusivity and mutuality.

2028-2029

We Are All One: Gifted and Transformed in the Spirit

This charism theme calls us to celebrate the unique gifts of each person and all of creation. As a school community, it is also our desire to promote holistic development and uphold human dignity.

2029-2030

Relationships: Sacred Threads that Connect

This charism theme focuses on our care for our community and on reconciliation with God, oneself and others. We are called to be bearers of reconciliation and light in the world.

THEOLOGY PROGRAM

Faith development permeates all aspects of student life at St. Joseph's Academy, with Theology being taught at each grade level in a classroom setting. All students take a full credit of Theology, and classes meet daily. Courses include Sacred Scripture, Church History, Morality, World Religions, Theology & Film, Theology of the Body and Spirituality & Faith. Working under the guidance of the USCCB's Curriculum Framework, each course is designed to foster our students' developing faith while informing their growing intellect.

SPECIAL RELIGIOUS ACTIVITIES

Retreats

Specified school days are devoted to student reflection, prayer, guidance and discussion. Seniors participate in an out-of-town, two-day/one-night retreat. The junior retreat is held on or off campus but within the city. Sophomore and freshman retreats are usually held on campus.

Participation in retreats is required for promotion to the next grade level and to graduate from St. Joseph's Academy. Appointments, extra-curricular activities and travel should not be planned on a student's retreat day(s). These absences will not be excused unless they are part of a school-sponsored event, and approval is given by the campus minister. This includes but is not limited to out-of-school competitions for club teams, college visits, college recruitment events and any other outside event.

All absences, excused or unexcused, must be made up with a full Catholic retreat of equal or greater duration by the last regular day of school (not including exam days). A student who is absent from her grade-level retreat should research a retreat she can attend to fulfill the make-up requirement. She should submit the retreat request to the campus minister for approval. Retreats attended as mandatory elements of preparation of a sacrament (i.e., confirmation retreats) are not eligible to be used to make up a missed grade-level retreat. Retreats must be in person and intended for high school students.

Retreat questions should be directed to **Campus Minister Rachael Duchmann at duchmannr@sjabr.org or (225) 388-2295.**

Community Prayer

As a Catholic school rooted in the charism of the Sisters of St. Joseph, daily prayer is important for our faith development. Therefore, the SJA community intentionally pauses after 7th period each day to still our bodies and lift our minds and hearts to God in prayer.

Each **Monday**, we focus on a maxim, a short spiritual saying that Father Jean-Pierre Medaille, SJ taught to the early Sisters to enrich their souls. We use the modern maxims which are more applicable to today's young people and pray through the intercession of our patron, Saint Joseph.

On **Tuesday**, we look at those people who courageously died for their faith or who, by their exemplary lives, remind us how to live as modern-day followers of Jesus Christ. We pray for the Holy Saints of the Church to guide us.

On **Wednesday**, we are invited to meditate on our sacred scriptures for reflection and prayer. Using the sacred scriptures, we reflect on our call to be modern disciples of our Lord Jesus Christ. We conclude our prayer asking Jesus to guide us.

Intentional intercessory prayer guides us on **Thursday** as we reflect on the needs of our global world, our nation, our state, our SJA community and our own heart's intentions. We pray together for compassionate hearts to respond with generosity to the needs of our times.

Friday invites us to do an examen, gathering the graces of the past week. We ponder where and how we had glimpses of God's grace in our hearts/lives. We reflect on how we have tried to put our yearly charism theme into action throughout the past week and ask for God's guidance for the weekend.

Our prayer is attuned and shaped by the liturgical seasons of the Church as well as contemporary needs of the times. We invite all members of the Academy community to join us in prayer.

Eucharistic Adoration is offered bimonthly in the Chapel by the Campus Ministry office during lunch. Student Ministers serve as committed adorers and invite the Academy community to join them in Eucharistic Adoration.

School Masses

Throughout the school year, students, faculty and staff come together to celebrate the life they share as a high school community in the liturgy of the Eucharist. School masses are celebrated on special occasions, especially during liturgical seasons such as Advent, Christmas, Lent and Easter, and always on holy days of obligation. Dress uniform is required for students at mass. Visitors are welcome to attend any school mass. Please sign in at the kiosk in the Academy Student Center.

May Crowning

An assembly is held in late April or early May to celebrate the crowning of Mary.

Prayer Services

St. Joseph's Academy gathers as a school community for prayer services at Thanksgiving and Holy Thursday.

Sacrament of Reconciliation

The Sacrament of Reconciliation is made available to students twice during the year and during all grade-level retreats.

Student Ministry

Student Ministry is a club open to juniors and seniors who are interested in growing in discipleship and evangelization in the context of the spirituality and mission of the Sisters of St. Joseph. The charism of the Sisters, since their founding in 1650, has been and continues to be unity, as in oneness, that all may be one in relationship with God and one another. Student ministers are given opportunities to experience spiritual growth and encourage this growth in their peers and the Academy community.

Students who complete the point requirements of the Student Ministry Club during both their junior and seniors years will be recognized at the service assembly at the end of the year.

Parents Who Pray

Parents participate in this email group and receive confidential prayer requests. Please submit confidential prayer requests to parentswhopray@sjabr.org. Please join our Prayer Warriors as we support our spiritual community.

Stickers for Life Club

This club is committed to a consistent life ethic that respects the sanctity of all human life from conception to natural death. The club meets monthly and often hosts guest speakers on topics that deal with adding value to the human life. Members sponsor several events including lunchtime events to share Stickers for Life issues with the school community. Club members also participate in the Bishop's Pro- Life Rally, Louisiana Life March and March for Life in Washington, D.C.

Liturgy Committee

The Liturgy Committee is a student club whose members help prepare for school masses and two annual prayer services. Members assist in planning, setting up for mass, training and participating in various liturgical roles. The committee also helps educate the school community about upcoming liturgies and offers an opportunity to grow in leadership, faith and understanding of Catholic worship. Open to all students regardless of faith.

Adoration

Offered bimonthly in the Chapel at SJA by the Campus Ministry office during lunch. Student Ministers serve as committed adorers and invite the Academy community to join them in Eucharistic Adoration.

Wednesday Morning Rosary

Every Wednesday morning at 7 a.m., the Rosary is recited in the Chapel at SJA.

Service Immersion Trips

The goal of the SJA Service Immersion program is to provide an encounter with Christ in the poor that leads to conversion and propels students to a life of service in their local community. In order to foster an encounter with Christ in the poor whom we serve, students are immersed in prayer and the sacraments during the experience, and relational service is prioritized. After an immersion experience, students are challenged to take what they've learned and invest it in meeting the needs of the Baton Rouge community. Mission/service immersion trips may be offered to students during the school year, including holidays, and summer breaks. Students can do service work domestically or abroad. Mission trips are offered according to chaperone availability. In the application process, first priority is given to students who have not yet had the opportunity to participate in an SJA service immersion, and second priority is given to upperclasswomen. Among those who have not attended an immersion trip and have equal seniority, placements will be determined on a first-come, first-served basis. Rising sophomores will not be eligible to participate in international service immersion trips.

Catholic Leadership Encounter

CLE challenges high school students to develop their God-given leadership abilities anchored in Christian principles. Students participate in team-building activities, outdoor adventures and assessments of the charism of the Sisters of St. Joseph and Brothers of the Sacred Heart. They are challenged to develop God-centered responses to practical leadership situations. In addition to spiritual formation, students participate in developing skills in active listening, managing conflicts, consensus building and delegating responsibility.

2026-2027 SJA SERVICE POLICY

The St. Joseph's Academy service program is a vital component of the faith development pillar of the school's mission statement. Our Catholic faith calls each student to serve the dear neighbor as an overflow of the love of God in them. "We love because He first loved us. If anyone says, 'I love God' but hates his brother, he is a liar; for whoever does not love a brother whom he has seen cannot love God whom he has not seen. This is the commandment we have from Him: Whoever loves God must also love his brother." (1 John 4:19-21)

Jesus has identified himself with those most in need in saying, "Amen, I say to you, what you did not do for one of these least ones, you did not do for me." (Matthew 25:45) The goal of the SJA service program is to

foster an encounter with Christ in those most in need and a desire to sacrifice oneself for them with acts of charity and through the spiritual and corporal works of mercy. Students will form sustained interpersonal relationships with the dear neighbor that allow them to see all as created in God's image and likeness and to serve them through the corporal and spiritual works of mercy.

The SJA Service Policy states that freshmen and sophomores are required to complete 15 hours of service during the 2026-2027 academic year while juniors and seniors must complete 20 service hours. The 2026-2027 Freshman and Sophomore Service Directory and the 2026-2027 Junior and Senior Service Directory can be found on MySJA and the Service Hour Opportunity Teams Channel. Please review the revised policies before completing service hours. **We recognize that the directories do not comprise an exhaustive list of opportunities available to SJA students.** Students can participate in opportunities outside of those included in the service directories only after receiving written permission via email from the Campus Ministry Office at service@sjabr.org. All students will use their Mobile Serve account to log service hours. These accounts will be set up during Student Orientation. User guides for the website and cellular application can be found on the Service Hour Opportunities Team Channel. Parents, grandparents and immediate family members cannot verify students service hours.

All service hours must be done through a non-profit agency or through a for-profit business, with prior written approval, that serves those most in need. Service performed through a for-profit business must be non-clerical in manner. Tasks such as filing, answering the phone, etc., will not be permitted as part of the service program. SJA and CHS club hours do not roll over at any time, and SJA and CHS club hours must be independent and separate from the SJA service program. SJA and CHS sports team hours do not roll over at any time, and SJA and CHS sports team hours must be independent and separate from the SJA service program. **Service hours completed at church on a Sunday may not impede a student's Sunday obligation to attend and be an active participant in Catholic mass or your faith tradition's church service.**

Visiting with patients in nursing homes or hospice facilities does not need prior approval. All service hours must be done outside of normal school hours. Donations of any kind, including Sticker Sacks, are not eligible for the service program. However, SJA may offer a schoolwide donation opportunity for service hours. SJA reserves the right to limit the number of hours earned on mission trips; hours earned on SJA mission trips will be determined and applied after the trip is complete. This will ensure students receive accurate credit for the number of hours served. **Overnight, residential summer camps are not permitted for any student's service hours.**

The 2026-2027 service year for students returning to SJA began Tuesday, April 14, 2026, and will end on Wednesday, April 7, 2027. Students who are new to SJA for the 2026-2027 school year can begin earning service hours on Monday, June 1, 2026, and end on Wednesday, April 7, 2027. Hours for all students must be verified by the supervisor no later than Friday, April 9, 2027. All service hours must be logged electronically in each student's school issued Mobile Serve account. Hard-copy verifications will not be accepted. Failure to complete service hours by the deadline will be examined on a case-by-case basis and may result in disciplinary action. Seniors must complete their service requirements in order to graduate from SJA, and underclasswomen must complete their service hours in order to take their final exams.

In conjunction with their senior retreat, members of the senior class participate in a day of service in the Baton Rouge community. This experience serves as an opportunity for the class to give back to the community as a group. Students are assigned to a service site for this day. Senior Service Day is considered part of the senior retreat and is a requirement for graduation.

Please direct questions about service hours to the Assistant Campus Minister/Service Coordinator at service@sjabr.org.

SERVICE REQUIREMENTS BY GRADE LEVEL

Class of 2027

Students will choose one agency whose primary focus is those most in need and will earn 20 hours from their chosen agency. Approved agencies can be found in the Junior and Senior Service Directory on MySJA and the Service Hour Opportunity Teams Channel. Students may only participate in opportunities outside of those included in the Service Directory after receiving written permission via email from the Assistant Campus Minister/Service Coordinator at service@sjabr.org. Students wishing to earn the 50-hour service award must obtain 30 additional hours from their chosen agency or any of the approved agencies included in the Junior and Senior Service Directory whose primary focus is those most in need. **Please note that event set up and concessions will not receive approval for any service hours.**

Class of 2028

Students are required to earn 20 hours from agencies whose primary focus is those most in need. Approved agencies can be found in the Junior and Senior Service Directory on MySJA and the Service Hour Opportunity Teams Channel. Students may only participate in opportunities outside of those included in the Service Directory after receiving written permission via email from the Assistant Campus Minister/Service Coordinator. Students wishing to earn the 50-hour service award must obtain 30 additional hours from the same approved list of agencies in the Junior and Senior Service Directory whose primary focus is those most in need. **Please note that event set up and concessions will not receive approval for any service hours.**

Class of 2029

Students are required to earn 15 hours. Approved non-profit agencies can be found in the Freshman and Sophomore Service Directory on MySJA and the Service Hour Opportunity Teams Channel. Students may only participate in opportunities outside of those included in the Service Directory after receiving written permission via email from the Assistant Campus Minister/Service Coordinator. Students wishing to earn the 50-hour service award must obtain 35 additional hours from the same approved list of agencies in the Freshman and Sophomore Service Directory.

Class of 2030

Students are required to earn 15 hours. Approved non-profit agencies can be found in the Freshman and Sophomore Service Directory on MySJA and the Service Hour Opportunity Teams Channel. Students may only participate in opportunities outside of those included in the Service Directory after receiving written permission via email from the Assistant Campus Minister/Service Coordinator. Students wishing to earn the 50-hour service award must obtain 35 additional hours from the same approved list of agencies in the Freshman and Sophomore Service Directory.

Service Exclusions

The handbook policy clearly articulates what counts towards service program hours. Items listed below **do not** count towards the SJA Service Program. This list is not all-inclusive and is subject to change at any time.

1. Sticker Sacks
2. Donations of any kind, which includes but is not limited to buying, preparing and delivering food to a shelter.
3. Fundraising
4. Job Shadowing
5. All work at Friends of the Animals, Cara's House, Cat Haven, Dante's Hope, etc.
6. Fostering animals
7. Neighborhood homeowner's association events and pools; i.e., Tara, Country Club of Louisiana, etc.
8. Club sports teams and pools
9. Political campaigning
10. Any non-SJA/CHS summer camp must have written approval from the Assistant Campus Minister/Service Coordinator before a student volunteers. SJA's Sizzling Summer and Summer at CHS do

not need pre-approval.

11. Overnight, residential summer camps.

12. Open House for students working for bonus points, Ambassador points or any other requirement.

13. Babysitting

14. Any part of the student's own sacramental preparation, including but not limited to sacramental requirements (i.e. Confirmation retreats, service hours, etc.).

15. Mission trips sponsored by for-profit agencies. If your mission trip is sponsored by a non-profit or your church that is not SJA, you must seek prior approval from the Assistant Campus Minister/Service Coordinator. Hours earned on mission trips will be determined and applied after the trip is complete.

16. Hours should be completed on a service site; no hours can be completed virtually or at home.

17. SJA and CHS club hours do not roll over at any time and must be independent from the SJA service program.

18. SJA and CHS sports team hours do not roll over at any time and must be independent from the SJA service program.

ACADEMIC EXCELLENCE

EXAM PREPARATION DAY

Exam Preparation Day will typically be two days before exams start. This is a school day, and attendance will be taken. The only points that can be earned during Exam Preparation Day are participation points for work completed in class. Students' grades should not be penalized for excused absences during these days.

Exam Preparation Day is intended for planned review and academic preparation. In classes with an exam, teachers should use class time for structured review activities such as review games, active review exercises, small-group work, whole-class discussions and enrichment activities designed to prepare students for their exams.

In non-exam classes, teachers should use class time to reinforce and extend learning from throughout the semester. Appropriate activities include student presentations, enrichment media that supports course content, Socratic seminars, end-of-semester course surveys, preparation for the next-level course when applicable and labs or hands-on application activities.

For all classes, to preserve the focus on review and reinforcement, no new material may be introduced and no quizzes, tests, pre-exams or major projects may be assigned or due during Exam Preparation Day. The only exceptions are English writing exams and World Language speaking and listening exams. Homework may not be assigned during these days; however, previously assigned work may be collected and graded on Exam Preparation Day, provided it was completed before class. Work completed during Exam Preparation Day may not be graded, except for participation credit. Teachers may assign make-up work for students who still need to complete prior assignments. Any exceptions to this policy must be approved by the Dean of Academics. Teachers should maintain an academic focus throughout Exam Preparation Day and avoid parties or other non-academic activities.

There should be no mandatory co-curricular or athletic activities unless approved by the Dean of Women. Any approved event must be optional for the student.

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY POLICY

In keeping with the mission of faith development, academic excellence and personal growth, students at St. Joseph's Academy are encouraged to research ideas, seek information, analyze data, document facts and develop their skills and talents to their fullest potential.

Students must understand that intellectual theft is illegal, unethical and immoral. Cheating, plagiarism and misuse of AI are serious offenses. Final decisions on plagiarism/cheating are made by the Administration. The

use of *Turn It In* is encouraged to avoid unintentional plagiarism.

The use of artificial intelligence (AI) to complete any portion of assignments or classroom content is prohibited unless specifically directed by the teacher. Students should use original course content when completing graded or ungraded assignments unless directed by the teacher. This includes using AI tools to generate content such as text, video, audio and images. Students should recognize that use of AI is a form of plagiarism when used in lieu of independent thinking. The use of AI for any student work, whether graded or ungraded, is prohibited unless explicitly permitted by the teacher.

When AI use is permitted by the classroom teacher, students must ensure that the information is accurate and represents their own work and ideas. Student use of AI to correct grammar errors is only permitted when allowed by the classroom teacher and when used to correct sentence structure or sentence errors but cannot be used to change the central ideas or content. AI tools include but are not limited to Chat GPT, Grammarly, copilot, Gemini, anthropic and a general wildcard (google type) search for AI. Students should contact their teacher if they are unsure or have questions before using AI for any assignment.

When AI is used, the generated content must be properly cited and referenced in accordance with the school's guidelines on plagiarism. Students must not present AI-generated content as their own original work or use it to plagiarize the work of others. Students should save their original work that was created before it was submitted to an AI platform. The student should be prepared to present her original work as evidence of appropriate AI use and save any AI content utilized. Students should recognize that AI tools have limitations and can produce inaccurate information.

If unauthorized AI use is suspected, students will be expected to defend their work to the classroom teacher and Dean of Academics. An academic dishonesty infraction may be the end result, and the grade may be affected. Issues of academic dishonesty will be brought to the Dean of Academics, who will work with the Dean of Women prior to issuing any consequences.

Some examples of cheating and/or plagiarism are, but not limited to, the following:

- The visual appearance of cheating; i.e., speaking to another student while taking an assessment, looking at another student's test/work or having access to test materials, notes or any prohibited device that is accessible during testing.
- Copying, emailing, duplicating, photographing or transmitting using any technology, including AI, in assignments that will be turned in as the student's own work;
- Sharing work with another student who then copies it as her own, intentionally or unintentionally, and uses it for her own work;
- Exchanging assignments/tests/quizzes by email, printout, flash drive, disc, camera or other electronic means and then submitting as the student's own work;
- Writing information on the student, a desk or other object for use on a test, quiz or other graded assessment;
- Using programmed materials in watches, calculator, cell phones, computers or any other electronic device;
- Relaying questions or answers from a test or quiz to students who have not yet taken the test/quiz or trying to obtain this information from a student who has already taken the test/quiz;
- Submitting someone else's assignment as the student's own work;
- Submitting material without giving the appropriate credit to the creator/author;
- Taking credit for group work when little individual contribution was made;
- Not following additional specific guidelines on cheating as established by a teacher or department (for example, working with another student when the assignment was to be done independently, using prohibited websites, gaining access to hotspots on campus, etc.). These guidelines include the use of AI which does not adhere to the guidelines of the Academic Integrity Policy. Using AI to edit

assignments without direction from the teacher is prohibited.

- Stealing tests, answers or materials or having unauthorized possessions of such materials, including the possession or attempted possession of materials designed for teacher use.
- Students in dual enrollment courses will be held to the SJA Academic Integrity Policy as well as LSU's Policy on Academic Dishonesty, Plagiarism and AI Use.

Violation of the Academic Integrity Policy will result in disciplinary action as outlined in the discipline policy. This policy covers all school work both in and out of class.

Teachers will require students to stow away cell phones, smart watches, earbuds or other devices that might distract the student while completing any graded work in the classroom. The classroom teacher has the discretion to determine when these items must be put away. During tests, all personal items, including backpacks, must be stowed away from the student in an area designated by the teacher.

Implementation of Varying Levels of Consequences for Infractions

When an academic dishonesty infraction is identified, the Dean of Academics, working with the teacher, will issue an academic consequence. In addition, the Dean of Women will issue a Category II infraction for the first offense (two-hour Saturday school) and a Category III (suspension) infraction for the second offense. There will be a discussion with the Principal for dismissal for the third offense.

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY AGREEMENT

As a student of St. Joseph's Academy, I understand and agree to the following terms as I undertake this assessment.

I understand that cheating is defined as using deceptive means to complete an assignment, such as but not limited to copying another's work, submitting another's work as my own, working with someone else on an assignment intended to be completed individually, plagiarism in any form and using prohibited materials. I further understand that plagiarism is defined as intellectual theft, a significant form of dishonesty in which one uses another's words, ideas and/or efforts without giving credit to the original source. A complete list of prohibited materials and examples of cheating and/or plagiarism are listed in the Academic Integrity Policy.

In research, I agree to follow the documentation form (MLA or APA) required by my teacher for this particular assignment. I agree to acknowledge all sources used in my research and any ideas not entirely my own.

I agree to use parenthetical documentation (in-text citation) where it is necessary to acknowledge my use of direct quotations, paraphrases and synopses from any outside source. I further agree to submit a correctly formatted, works-cited page or bibliography, as specified by my instructor, listing all sources consulted and/or cited during my research. If I do not understand any of the aforementioned requirements, I agree to ask my teacher for clarification before I hand in the assignment.

I understand that the use of AI to complete assignments is prohibited unless specifically directed by the teacher and used within the guidelines of the Academic Integrity Policy. Students should recognize that the use of AI is a form of plagiarism when used in lieu of independent thinking.

I understand that failure to meet the agreed-upon criteria for intellectual honesty will result in disciplinary and/or academic consequences.

ACADEMICS AT SJA

SJA offers a traditional, college-preparatory curriculum with emphasis on English, Science, Math, Social Studies, World Language, Theology, Arts, Technology and Physical Education. Honors, advanced placement and dual enrollment courses are also available.

As part of the educational foundation provided by SJA, tablet computers are used as a teaching tool in all academic areas. This innovative approach creates a dynamic learning environment in which both students and faculty can access up-to-the-minute electronic information.

While the information in this section will answer most questions about St. Joseph's Academy and its policies, it is important to understand that the final word on curriculum and academic matters rests with the Administration.

Specific questions should be directed to Dean of Academics Aubrey DeJohn at dejohna@sjabr.org.

ACADEMIC SUPPORT

Students may be placed on Academic Support at the discretion of the grade-level counselor or an administrator. Students will be placed on Academic Support based on academic performance. Students placed on Academic Support will be required to meet with their grade-level counselor at least once every other week. The counselor will determine if more frequent meetings are needed. The counselor and student will develop an academic plan based on each student's individual needs.

Students on Academic Support are required to visit The Learning Center a minimum of once a week. Failure to meet the minimum attendance requirements results in the student not being granted any extensions on assignments, make-up work, extra credit or the ability to retest.

The grade-level counselor will notify parents of their daughter's participation in the Academic Support program.

Teachers will be required to write comments on the progress of their students. Students on Academic Support will be re-evaluated each quarter. Students who show improvement will be removed from Academic Support.

ACCOMMODATIONS

St. Joseph's Academy offers preferential seating, paper tests, calculators and extended time on tests and exams as our accommodations policy. A full psychoeducational evaluation report is required to be considered for these accommodations. The grade-level counselor must receive the report in its entirety to be reviewed for consideration. Please note that a diagnosis by a physician is not sufficient for consideration of accommodations. The full psychoeducational evaluation report for accommodations must include specific recommendations for accommodations as well as an explanation of why each accommodation is recommended and how it alleviates the impact of the disability when taking a timed standardized test.

Documentation must include a comprehensive evaluation with objective evidence of an impairment. The documentation must also indicate how the impairment interferes with the student's academic performance and the specific recommendations for accommodations.

Evaluations must be sent to the student's grade-level counselor no later than December 1 to receive accommodations for mid-year exams in December and no later than May 1 for end-of-the-year exams in May. Additionally, College Board and ACT corporations have specific deadlines for requesting accommodations.

Students who qualify for extended-time testing must take their extra time after school in the Technology and Learning Center on the same day the test is given. If the student has an extenuating circumstance, she must discuss it with the teacher and finish the test after school on the following day. The full psychoeducational evaluation must provide the results of age-appropriate diagnostic testing performed by a licensed psychologist. Documentation, including all standard scores and percentiles (including subtests) that are reliable, valid and standardized measures, must address the following:

1. Description of the presenting problem(s) and its (their) developmental history, including relevant

- educational and medical history.
2. Parent interview.
 3. Student interview.
 4. A review of the family history.
 5. Age of onset and the course of the illness.
 6. Evidence of early impairment which, by definition in the Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders (5th Ed., Text Revision) (DSM-V-TR), is first exhibited in childhood and manifests itself in more than one setting.
 7. Evidence of current impairment including a statement of presenting problem and diagnostic interview.
 8. Neuropsychological or psychoeducational evaluation which includes results of an aptitude assessment using a complete and comprehensive battery.
 - a. Wechsler Intelligence Scale
 - b. Woodcock-Johnson Tests
 - c. Connors Continuous Performance Tests
 - d. Teacher report forms
 - e. Youth self-report forms
 - f. Parent report forms
 9. Results of a complete achievement battery.
 10. Results of an assessment of information processing.
 11. Other appropriate assessments for consideration of differential diagnosis from co-existing neurological or psychiatric disorders.
 12. The history of treatment for the disorder. Note: If the treatment includes medication, please provide evidence of continuing problems that, despite the benefits of medication, make test accommodations necessary for access to this examination.
 13. Number of applicable DSM-V-TR criteria and description of how they impair the individual.
 14. Specific diagnosis and evidence that alternative explanations were ruled out.
 15. Description of the functional limitations supported by the test results and a rationale for the recommended test accommodations specific to those functional limitations.

Noise-Reducing Devices: Students with an official diagnosis which includes noise-reducing headphones as an accommodation are able to wear them during independent worktime with the teacher's permission. Earbuds, headphones and earplugs can only be worn for standardized testing with approved accommodations through ACT or College Board. Questions about standardized testing accommodations should be directed to the student's grade-level counselor. Students with this accommodation should not wear the noise-reducing headphones or earbuds of any kind while teachers are actively teaching or at any school assembly unless specific permission is given by an administrator.

Each request for accommodation is evaluated on a case-by-case basis using the information described above. If a particular element of documentation is not provided, the diagnostician must explain why it is not included in the submission. SJA will determine which, if any, accommodations will be allowed. Additionally, families must show compliance with accommodations at home.

ASSIGNMENTS FOR STUDENTS

It is expected that students will have homework to reinforce, expand and enhance classroom work. All assigned work should be purposeful and should be evaluated. Teachers are required to put major projects/tests and significant quizzes on the test calendar, which is supervised by the Dean of Academics, and students will be allowed ample time to prepare. Students cannot be assigned more than two major tests and one significant quiz per day or one major test and three significant quizzes per day. Students will be responsible for communicating with the Dean of Academics and their teacher if they have more than the allowed number of assessments on one day. Projects/tests are not to be assigned during Exam Preparation Day (refer to the Exam Preparation Day Policy) immediately before exams. Interdepartmental projects/papers are valuable and encouraged.

All next-day assignments must be posted before the end of the class period. If circumstances arise in which this is not possible, teachers should inform the students in class if an assignment will be posted after the end of the class period. A teacher cannot email the class later in the day with the expectation of finishing the assignment for the next day.

Each department will have a late-work policy for missed assignments. This policy will be stated in the course syllabus and on the MySJA course page. Students are responsible for meeting late-work policy requirements. All missing work will be marked with a zero grade until the student makes up the work (if she is permitted to do so).

Teachers will review tests in class in order for the student to receive feedback.

Students are encouraged to use *Turn It In* to avoid issues of plagiarism and academic dishonesty. Students can only use AI at the discretion and with the expressed permission of the teacher. AI must be used within the guidelines of the Academic Integrity Policy.

CLASS RANK

SJA does not report class rank. When it is an absolute requirement or when it may benefit a student's application for admission or scholarship, the College Advisors, at their discretion, may report rank directly to the college or scholarship committee.

COLLEGE CREDIT BY CONCURRENT ENROLLMENT

Concurrent enrollment at LSU for credit is available with permission from the Dean of Academics for those students who have surpassed our course availability and are capable of fulfilling the requirements of SJA and LSU.

COLLEGE CREDIT BY DUAL ENROLLMENT

College credit is available for dual enrollment in Pre-Calculus, Calculus, English and U.S. History at LSU. To participate, students must meet the requirements in the Course Catalog. The cost is determined by the university and is in addition to SJA tuition. Students enrolled in English must enroll with and pay tuition to LSU. For other courses, students are not required to be enrolled at LSU. Grades earned in these classes will be reflected on the student's college transcript. **LSU offers credit choice modality, allowing students to elect if the grades are reflected on their college transcript.**

COURSE REQUIREMENTS AND OFFERINGS

Complete information regarding course offerings can be found in the Course Catalog posted on the SJA website under the Students and Parents portals. The Course Catalog is updated each January by the Dean of Academics.

Freshmen are required to take a course load of 7 units. Sophomores are required to take a course load of 6.5 units and may take as many as 7 units. Juniors and seniors are required to take 6 units and may take as many as 7 units. If a student has chosen to take a course outside of the regular school day (Summer PE **or Athletic PE**), a student could have as many as 7.5 units.

All elective courses are offered by demand. Several elective courses are offered with Catholic High School. If too many students sign up for a limited-enrollment elective course, the administration has the right to require students to choose another elective. Additionally, we reserve the right to not offer courses if minimum enrollment numbers are not met.

GRADUATION REQUIREMENTS

The Louisiana State Department of Education requires 24 units of high school credit for graduation. St. Joseph's Academy requires 25.5 units of credit. A senior will not be allowed to graduate if she fails to fulfill

SJA's academic requirements. In addition, service requirements, all grade-level retreats, job shadowing at the junior and senior levels and junior year ACT must be completed to graduate. Details of SJA's academic requirements and course descriptions, as well as the TOPS core curriculum, are listed in the Course Catalog.

TOPS requirements are found at <https://mylosfa.la.gov/students-parents/scholarships-grants/tops/>

A TOPS core unit worksheet is a helpful tool for estimating purposes. Visit the Counseling Center Moodle page for your class to access the worksheet.

Transfer students must follow their individual transfer agreement. Students taking non-SJA credit courses **through an online program** still must meet the requirements below.

- English: 4 credit units (at least one credit must be taken each school year)
- Science: 4 credit units (at least one credit must be taken each school year)
- Mathematics: 4 credit units (at least one credit must be taken each school year)
- Social Studies: 3 credit units (Civics, U.S. History and World History are required)
- Theology: 4 credit units
- World Language: 2 credit units of the same language at SJA (Transfer students will receive credit for world language courses at previous high schools.)
- Health and Physical Education: 2 credit units (one-half credit must be taken each school year)
- Fine Arts: 1 credit unit of same art at SJA
- Electives: 1.5 additional units from any of the courses offered Total: 25.5 units

Beginning with the class of 2028, students must complete financial literacy credit by completing:

- 0.5 unit of the Financial Literacy course and passing the Financial Literacy proficiency test OR
- 1 unit of the Financial Literacy course OR
- Passing the Financial Literacy proficiency test.

Students who enroll in the Financial Literacy course need to take only 1 credit of an elective course to fulfill all graduation requirements.

HONORS AND ADVANCED PLACEMENT COURSES

SJA offers a variety of honors and advanced placement courses. See the Course Catalog for details.

Admission to honors and advanced placement courses is based on teacher recommendations, grade point average, acceptable standardized test scores and a strong work ethic.

In order to effectively utilize the faculty and physical facilities of each school, certain honors and advanced placement courses are taught in conjunction with Catholic High School.

If a student earns a failing grade in an honors course, no quality points will be awarded.

ENROLLMENT REQUIREMENTS FOR ADVANCED PLACEMENT COURSES

Enrollment requirements for AP courses can be found in the online Course Catalog. Sophomores, juniors and seniors may take AP courses. To take an AP course, a student must have the recommendation of her teacher, grade-level counselor and the administration based on GPA, standardized test scores and a strong work ethic. A student enrolled in an AP course is required to take the test.

Because AP courses are rigorous, the administration requires that at least one parent attend a mandatory meeting about AP courses when their daughter is taking a course for the first time. AP scores are returned in July. Course changes will not be permitted based on the score received on a previous test.

A student interested in taking an AP exam in a course in which she is not enrolled must notify the Dean of

Curriculum & Instruction. Deadlines will be communicated to students via email. Once the Dean has been informed, payment is required. Please note that refunds will not be granted.

GRADING SYSTEM AND REPORT CARDS

Students' report cards and transcripts will be published on MySJA. St. Joseph's Academy will not mail report cards. Report cards will be posted four times a year, and transcripts will be posted at the end of each semester. MySJA instructions and login information are issued to new parents in August. The daily work, class participation, assignments, quizzes and unit tests given in a nine-week period are taken into consideration in determining a student's grade. Numerical grades are given for quarter and exam grades. Letter grades are calculated for final marks at the end of each semester.

The value of each grade is as follows:

A = 100-90

B = 89-80

C = 79-70

D = 69-60

F = 59 and below

Honors and AP courses are weighted.

The final marks for each semester are based on the nine weeks' grades and the semester examination. The semester examination is worth 20 percent of the grade for the semester. If the exam grade is below 60 percent, the student is eligible to lose her credit for the semester. This decision will be made in a teacher-administration conference.

In a course in which there is no exam, the semester average is based on the two quarters, unless the course has an alternative final assessment.

Full Credit Courses:

	Quarter (40%)	Quarter (40%)	Exam (20%)	Final Mark
Student A	98 $98 \times 40\% = 39.2$	80 $80 \times 40\% = 32$	85 $85 \times 20\% = 17$	$(39.2) + (32) + (17) = 88.2$ B
Student B	94 $94 \times 40\% = 37.6$	94 $94 \times 40\% = 37.6$	90 $90 \times 20\% = 18$	$(37.6) + (37.6) + (18) = 93.2$ A
Student C	98 $98 \times 40\% = 39.2$	98 $98 \times 40\% = 39.2$	93 $93 \times 20\% = 18.6$	$(39.2) + (39.2) + (18.6) = 97$ A

Multiply the numerical value for the quarter by the percentage assessed to the quarter or exam to arrive at the product for each quarter or exam. Add the product of the quarters and exam to arrive at the percentage for the final mark. Refer to the scale to assign the final letter grade.

Only final letter grades for the semester are used in computing the official/true GPA for a student. GPAs are reported at the end of each semester and are the official/true GPA. GPAs are included on the report cards but only reflect the GPA from the previous semester.

At the end of each semester, the calculation of the cumulative GPA includes the final semester letter grades for all courses completed to date, including semester courses. Therefore, the GPA that appears on the transcript at that time is the official/true GPA.

Report cards listing numerical grades will only be sent to another school if requested by the student. GPA is computed using the following quality point scale:

Honors/AP Courses	College Prep Courses
A 5.0	A 4.0
B 4.0	B 3.0
C 3.0	C 2.0
D 2.0	D 1.0
F 0	F 0

Cumulative GPA = Historical grade points + Year grade points ÷ Historical credits attempted + Year credits attempted

Senior Exams: If a senior has an A for the third and fourth quarters, she can be exempt from the final exam. The exam grade will be the average of the third- and fourth-quarter number grades. Since letter grades are reflected on the transcript, exempt students may not elect to take the final exam to raise their numerical average. This does not apply to students in dual enrollment courses. This does not affect the determination of the valedictorian and salutatorian.

CREDIT RECOVERY

Beginning in the summer of 2025, students may remediate a course in summer school if they earned a D or F semester grade during the most recent school year. Students may not attend summer school for remediation for a previous school year. Students may not remediate a course if an A, B or C grade is earned. Only those classes that are required for graduation may be remediated. Students may not remediate an elective course.

If a student fails a semester by earning a grade of F, she must follow the failure policy below to return to SJA the next school year and graduate.

A student may choose to remediate a course for a grade of D in a semester in order to improve her GPA, including her TOPS GPA. **In these cases, the grade earned in summer school will not be reported if the grade is the same or lower than the grade earned in the course during the school year. For example, if the student earns a D semester grade and a D grade in summer school, the summer school grade is not reported.**

Grades received in summer school courses do not replace the failed grade on a student's SJA transcript but are averaged in as an additional grade. For her TOPS GPA, the grade earned in summer school replaces the semester grade earned.

Example SJA Transcript

2024 - 2025 - Ninth Grade					
St. Joseph's Academy					
Course title	S1FM	Credits	S2FM	Credits	Cumulative Credits
Alg 1	D	0.50	C	0.50	1.00
Civics	C	0.50	C	0.50	1.00
Eng 1	B	0.50	B	0.50	1.00
Spanish I	A	0.50	A	0.50	1.00
H & PE 9/10		0.00	B	0.50	0.50
Media Arts 1	A	0.50		0.00	0.50
Phys Sc	C	0.50	F	0.00	0.00
Theology 1	B	0.50	C	0.50	1.00
Total cumulative		3.50		3.00	6.50
Catholic High School					
Course title	S1FM	Credits	S2FM	Credits	Cumulative Credits
Algebra 1	A	0.50			0.50
Physical Science			C	0.50	0.50
Total cumulative		4.00		3.50	7.50

Students taking summer school courses must do so at Catholic High School unless special permission has been granted by the Dean of Academics. Students attending summer school may not take summer P.E.

Students who fail three or more subjects during the fall semester may be asked to leave St. Joseph's Academy. Students who fail more than four semesters cannot return to SJA the following school year or graduate from SJA. Students are not allowed to repeat a grade.

Failure Policy

First semester: If a student fails a course for the first semester, in order to pass the course for the year, she must earn at least a C average for the second-semester letter grade. In such cases, on the student's final transcript in the Student Transcript System (STS), the transcript database for the Louisiana Department of Education which is used for TOPS eligibility and college admissions, the student is assigned one letter grade for the entire course.

Example

Semester 1 letter grade earned	Semester 2 letter grade earned	Grade reported on STS
F	D	Must attend summer school
F	C	D
F	B	Numerical averages from 1st and 2nd semesters averaged to determine final grade
F	A	C

A student would not be assigned a letter grade lower than a D if she earned a C or higher in semester two. If she earns a D for the second semester, she does not pass the course and must make up the half-credit from the first semester in summer school. Once completed, the summer school grade replaces the semester grade in STS.

Failure in second semester: If she earns an F and fails the second semester, in addition to failing the first semester, a student must earn the whole credit in summer school. Students who pass the first semester and fail the second semester must make up the second semester in summer school.

GRADE APPEALS

Final course grades are considered official at the conclusion of the academic year. If a parent or student wishes to request a review of a final grade, the request must be submitted within two weeks of the last day of the school year.

After this two-week period, grades will be considered final and will not be considered for review or change. Requests to revisit grades from previous school years will not be considered.

Grade review requests should be directed first to the classroom teacher and must include specific information regarding the concern. If the concern is not resolved, the matter may be referred to the Dean of Academics.

ACADEMIC LETTERING

Each fall, students who completed the previous school year at SJA with a cumulative grade point average of 3.5 or higher after two, four or six semesters will receive either an academic letter or academic pin. Students who attain a cumulative GPA of 3.5 will first receive an academic pin and will be eligible to purchase a letter jacket. Students who maintain a cumulative GPA of 3.5 will then receive an academic bar. Qualifying students will be awarded at a ceremony at the beginning of the following academic year. Graduating seniors receive special academic awards at Honors Convocation for their cumulative academic

performance in lieu of an academic pin or bar. Transfer students would not earn academic awards based on academics from their previous school but could earn an academic letter the following school year.

WORLD LANGUAGE HONOR SOCIETIES

St. Joseph's Academy offers membership in three World Language Honor Societies: *Sociedad Honoraria Hispánica* (SHH) for Spanish, National Latin Honor Society (NLHS) and *Société Honoraire de Français* (SHF) for French. Each recognizes high academic achievement and encourages ongoing interest in language and cultural studies. Students who meet the criteria are invited to apply in the fall and, upon acceptance, are inducted during a spring ceremony. Members receive recognition through pins awarded at the Academy Awards Ceremony and diploma seals for graduation.

Qualifications for Membership

- Actively enrolled in an upper-level world language course (Level III or higher)
- Completed at least three semesters of the language with an A average in those semesters
- Overall weighted GPA of 3.5 or higher
- No D or F semester grades in any previous world language course
- Good behavior record with no discipline issues
- Transfer students must complete one full semester of the language at SJA before eligibility.

Membership Application and Induction

Eligible students will be invited to apply during the first few weeks of school. Applicants must submit a completed form and teacher recommendation and meet all listed criteria. Chapter sponsors may consult the Dean of Women regarding discipline concerns. Accepted students will receive a congratulatory letter outlining membership expectations and details for the induction ceremony.

Membership Expectations

- Maintain a 3.5 cumulative weighted GPA
- Complete at least five hours of service related to the language. Specific details on volunteer activities can be found on the MySJA Honor Society Page.
- Maintain a good behavior record
- Submit dues (\$15) and meet all deadlines

Failure to meet expectations may result in probation or removal from the society.

NATIONAL HONOR SOCIETY

In order to become a member of the Aquinas Chapter of the National Honor Society at St. Joseph's Academy as juniors or seniors, students must have a cumulative grade point average of 3.8 at the end of their sophomore or junior year. If inducted as a junior, a student must have maintained a 3.8 GPA at the end of her junior year and completed her required service through NHS to remain a member as a senior. Students who are members of NHS must be in good standing with the school and must exhibit the qualities of leadership, scholarship and service. Only members who complete all requirements, including GPA and NHS service hours, will be given an NHS seal on their diploma.

BETA CLUB

Beta Club is a national organization that is based on scholarship and service. Membership in the SJA Beta Club is open to students in grades 10, 11 and 12 (including transfer students). Juniors not currently in the club but who meet the 3.4 cumulative GPA requirement in May must contact SJA's Beta sponsors in August in order to be considered for admission. Sophomores who meet the 3.4 cumulative GPA requirements will be offered membership at the beginning of their sophomore year. To maintain active membership, students must complete 20 Beta service hours and maintain a 3.4 GPA. Students who remain active Beta members during their years at SJA will receive Beta Honors on their diploma upon graduation.

BILITERACY SEAL

St. Joseph's Academy confers the Seal of Biliteracy to graduating seniors upon successful completion of a level four or above world language course and earned qualifying scores on the English and Reading sections of the ACT. The seal is affixed to the student's diploma. This recognition provides universities with a method of giving credit to applicants for attaining high-level skills in multiple languages and allows employers to identify those with important 21st century language skills.

HONOR GRADUATE REQUIREMENTS

If clarifying questions arise regarding the following criteria, the Administration has the final say on the interpretation of the wording.

Honors Diploma

All honors and AP courses are weighted on a 5.0 scale. The requirements for an honors diploma are a GPA of at least 3.8 after eight (8) semesters of work and the completion of eleven (11) weighted courses over the four years.

The following criteria are the minimum course requirements each year. Please note these requirements do not add up to the required 11 weighted courses. The remaining four (4) weighted courses required to earn an honors diploma can be taken in any grade and can be chosen from any weighted course offered by SJA.

- A minimum of two (2) weighted courses must be taken during the freshman and sophomore years combined.
- At least two (2) weighted courses must be taken junior year.
- Among the weighted courses taken during the freshman, sophomore and junior years, two (2) must be AP courses and must be completed by the end of junior year.
- At least three (3) weighted courses must be taken senior year, and two (2) of those weighted courses must be AP courses.
- There is no AP score requirement to earn the honors diploma.

If the student has taken the highest-level core AP courses prior to senior year, the Administration will work to find alternate courses to fulfill the honors diploma requirements, which might be but are not limited to courses at Catholic High School or a postsecondary university.

To earn an honors diploma, the student must earn all As and Bs in all courses but can earn one (1) C in a weighted course. Honors diploma recipients receive a gold SJA medallion and red stole to wear at graduation. Students are reminded about the honors diploma and its requirements during the scheduling process by their grade-level counselor.

First and Second Academics

First academics must earn a 3.6-5.0 cumulative GPA with no Ds or Fs during 10th, 11th and 12th grades. They receive a silver SJA medallion and double red cords to wear at graduation. Second academics must earn a 3.3-3.599 cumulative GPA with no Ds or Fs during 10th, 11th and 12th grades. They receive a bronze SJA medallion and single red cord to wear at graduation. There are no requirements regarding honors/Advanced Placement courses for the first and second academics.

VALEDICTORIAN/SALUTATORIAN REQUIREMENTS

The valedictorian and salutatorian must meet the criteria for an honors diploma and have the two highest GPAs, based on the following criteria.

- Must have attended St. Joseph's Academy for four years.
- Cannot schedule any unstructured periods during their four years of high school.
- Must have an A in all courses taken outside of normal school day hours (for example, Summer PE, **Athletic PE** and any extra course that the Administration has given a student permission to take and

that will be included on her transcript). However, courses taken outside of the normal school day will not be calculated in the final GPA that determines the valedictorian and salutatorian. Final determination is made by the Administration.

- The GPA will be calculated using 7 credits earned each year, during the regular school day, over the four years of high school.
- Must have taken AP U.S. History, World History AP, English III AP, English IV AP, AP Calculus AB and at least one AP science course. If an AP science course is not offered in the year a student requests it, Physics Honors can be substituted with the approval of the Administration, but only if Physics AP is not offered at SJA.

If students are unable to complete the requirements due to course offerings, the administration will make the final determination.

Valedictorian/Salutatorian Tiebreaker

If there is a tie for valedictorian, a tiebreaker is only enacted if there are four or more students with equivalent GPAs who meet the requirements for valedictorian and salutatorian. In such cases, an average of these students' numerical semester averages from every class their junior and senior years are calculated. This includes all classes taken outside of the normal school day. The student with the highest average will be named the valedictorian, and the remaining students will all be named as salutatorians. In the event there is still a tie for valedictorian due to equivalent averages, those students will share the title of valedictorian, and the remaining students will be named salutatorians. In the event there is no tiebreaker due to three or fewer students having equivalent GPAs, no salutatorian will be named. There is no tiebreaker for salutatorian in any case.

FINANCIAL LITERACY

Beginning with the class of 2028, all students are required to complete one full credit of Financial Literacy.

A proficiency test allows students to earn Financial Literacy credit if they pass the test, which can eliminate the requirement of taking the full year-long course.

Students will be offered three options for earning the credit for this course without losing valuable elective opportunities.

1. One-Semester Course with Proficiency Test

Students can take one semester of Financial Literacy, after which they must pass a proficiency test. Students who successfully pass both the course and proficiency test will earn full credit for Financial Literacy. If she does not pass the test, a student can take the proficiency test again. If she does not pass the test after her second attempt, she must enroll in Part 2 of the course during the following school year.

2. Full-Year Course Option

Students who prefer to take the full year of Financial Literacy without a proficiency test can choose this option at any time. Students will complete two semesters of the course across separate school years, and this will count as one full academic year of credit. There will be no proficiency test required for this option.

3. Proficiency Test Only

Students who feel confident in their ability to independently master the Financial Literacy content may choose to prepare for and take only the proficiency test. In this case, self-paced study materials will be provided to help students prepare. Students who do not pass the test on the first attempt can retake the test or opt to enroll in the course the following year. Students must pass the test prior to the spring semester of their junior year or they will have to enroll in the course.

If a student decides to take the proficiency test only, she will earn a “P” on her transcript indicating she passed and received credit. The “P” grade does not affect her GPA. If a student takes the course, she will earn a letter grade on her transcript that will be calculated into her GPA.

The course will be available to students beginning in their sophomore year, but students may prefer to defer the course to their junior year.

LEARNING CENTER

St. Joseph’s Academy offers students additional free-of-charge resource opportunities outside the classroom in the areas of Math, Science, English and Writing. Also offered is academic counseling.

Students will be notified of dates and times of resource opportunities through the daily announcements and email.

MAKE-UP TEST POLICY

Students are expected to complete their make-up assessments within one week. Failure to attend a scheduled make-up date will result in an infraction issued by the teacher. Students who do not attend department make-ups within the one-week timeline are required to make up the test on Friday after school. If a student has a pattern of missing test days, she may be required to take the exam immediately upon returning to school.

Each department has its own make-up test policy. Make-up quizzes of 20 minutes or less may be completed at the teacher’s discretion. Otherwise, makeups are not allowed during class time or at lunch.

The Arts

AP Art History makeups will take place Wednesdays after school or on another designated day and time agreed upon by the teacher and student. Students must schedule a makeup test time with their teacher upon returning to school. All other art courses do not require scheduled make-up days; students should work with their teachers on making up projects.

English

Students should use the Make-up Scheduler assigned by the English department to sign up to take make-up tests and quizzes for all English classes. Tuesday slots are from 3 to 3:50 p.m., and Thursday slots are from 6:30 to 7:20 a.m. every other week. See the make-up proctor to sign in and receive either your password or your paper test or quiz.

Unless you have permission from your English teacher, you should schedule the next available day for your make-up test. Failure to do so may lead to an infraction.

You must sign up for tests by the end of the school day prior to the test slot.

World Languages

All makeups for written assessments will be Monday afternoons from 3 to 3:50 p.m. or Thursday mornings from 6:45 to 7:20 a.m. All speaking and some listening sections of assessments should be scheduled with the student’s teacher in a timely manner and may be at a different time than the written assessment. Students should use the Make-up Scheduler on the World Language Department MySJA page to sign up to take make-up tests and quizzes for all World Language classes. Unless you have permission from your world language teacher, you should schedule the next available day for your make-up test. Failure to do so may lead to an infraction.

Mathematics

Students should use the Math Make-up Scheduler link, posted on the Math Course MySJA page to sign up to take make-up tests and quizzes. Monday slots are from 3 to 3:50 p.m., and Wednesday slots are from 6:30 to

7:20 a.m. You must sign up for tests by the end of the school day prior to the test slot. Unless you have permission from your math teacher, you should schedule the next available day for your make-up test. If you cannot attend Monday or Wednesday makeups, your teacher may require you to attend the Friday afternoon session.

Physical Education

Makeups can be completed Friday before school. Please be sure to schedule with your teacher. A deadline for taking a makeup is set at the teacher's discretion.

Science

Students should use the Make-up Scheduler to sign up to take make-up tests and quizzes. Tuesday slots are from 6:30 to 7:20 a.m., and Thursday slots are from 3 to 3:50 p.m. You must sign up for tests by the end of the school day prior to the test slot. Unless you have permission from your science teacher, you should schedule the next available day for your make-up test. Failure to do so may lead to disciplinary consequences.

Social Studies

Students must contact their teacher to schedule a make-up test or quiz. Makeups are given on Tuesday afternoon from 2:50 to 3:40 p.m. and Friday mornings from 6:30 until 7:20 a.m. Unless prior arrangements have been made with the social studies teacher, failure to take a makeup within one week may result in a 10 percent drop every make-up date a student doesn't attend. Social studies faculty members will proctor these sessions on a rotating basis.

Theology

Students should use the Make-up Scheduler on the theology department page to sign up to take make-up tests and quizzes. All make-up tests and quizzes must be taken during theology department make-up times, which are Tuesdays and Thursdays from 6:40 to 7:20 a.m.; or Wednesdays and Thursdays from 3 to 3:40 p.m. You must sign up for tests at least 12 hours in advance. You are not allowed to make up a test during your lunch period. Once a test is scheduled, you are responsible for attending your appointment. All theology make-ups will be held in MAH 209.

Extended Time

Students who qualify for extended-time testing must take their extra time after school in the Technology and Learning Center on the same day of the test. If the student has an extenuating circumstance, she must discuss this with the teacher and finish the test after school on the following day.

NATIONAL ACT TEST DATE FOR ALL JUNIORS

All students in the junior class will be required to take the ACT on campus on a designated date in the spring. The testing fee will be included in tuition. More details will be given closer to the test day.

ACT TEST DATE FOR SENIORS

All seniors will be required to take the ACT on campus in the fall. The testing fee will be included in tuition. **The only students who are exempt are those with a score of 31 or higher prior to the test date.**

NON-SJA COURSE CREDIT

All courses required for graduation must be earned at SJA or in conjunction with Catholic High School or through concurrent enrollment at a university or accredited school that is first approved by the Dean of Academics.

Concurrent enrollment for college credit is available with permission for those students capable of fulfilling the requirements of SJA and a university.

Incoming ninth graders who have earned high school credit prior to entrance into St. Joseph's Academy may

receive a Carnegie unit with a grade of P **at the discretion of the Administration**. No grade point average is assigned to the course(s). The course will be listed as an honors course on SJA's transcript if it is so designated by the previous school. **High school credit earned in middle school will not be awarded in Art, English, Science (except physical science depending on placement test) or Health and PE**. Transfer students must follow their individual transfer agreement.

Students wishing to earn external credit must first meet with the Dean of Academics.

Online Courses

Students with a prolonged illness may need to drop from SJA and finish the semester or school year online through an outside program.

Students may not take online courses through another program and remain enrolled at SJA unless special permission is given by the administration.

Students required to take courses through an online program will not be considered for valedictorian and salutatorian unless such courses were necessary because the student exceeded the course availability in core subjects (for example, a student needing to enroll in Calculus BC because it is not offered at SJA or CHS in the year she takes it) or due to extenuating circumstances involving PE credits that were taken in lieu of summer PE. Final determination is made by the administration. In these cases, for valedictorian and salutatorian, As must be earned in the courses if not included in the calculation that determines the valedictorian and salutatorian. (See the Valedictorian and Salutatorian Requirements section of the handbook.)

Courses that are designated as honors or AP at an online program will be designated as such at SJA as long as there is an honors level offered at SJA. An exception would be AP Calculus BC. Even though not offered at SJA, it would be given a weighted grade at SJA.

In some circumstances, online courses are offered to students through **online programs** for extenuating circumstances that are not related to illness. In these cases, the parent will be responsible for tuition payment to **approved** online courses. The final decision on tuition payments is made by the Administration.

REMOTE LEARNING

Some school days will be deemed virtual by the administration, either for professional development purposes or weather emergencies. Student responsibilities for remote learning follow.

All enrolled students must attend classes on campus daily as we will not offer virtual/remote access to classes. Students who are ill should stay home and make up the work when feeling better. Remoting as a matter of convenience to the student or family will not be an option. Individualized plans will be made with those students who are absent due to the need to quarantine or those experiencing a prolonged illness.

SCHEDULE CHANGES

Once courses are selected in the spring, the master schedule is planned. If an elective course is not filled, it will not be offered, and the student is contacted to choose an alternate course. Faculty is hired based on the courses chosen; therefore, students will not be able to add **or drop** a course after parental approval forms are returned. Any schedule-change requests made after the parent approval form is returned will be brought to the Dean of Academics for consideration. Final decisions are made by the administration. Copies of the final schedule are posted online in late July. We do not honor requests to move the time of a class, change lunch periods or change teachers.

Once the school year begins, changes will be considered based on level changes only (i.e., moving from Algebra II Honors to Algebra II College Prep) during the first two weeks of classes. These requests are honored only if dropping or adding a course does not affect class sizes or teacher load and if the change is

possible in the student's schedule. Because electives are not required courses and are based on student choice, schedule changes are not honored after parent approval forms are returned in the spring. Only honors or AP elective schedule-change requests are considered. Once summer PE classes begin, students enrolled in the course may not alter their schedule by dropping full-credit electives for unstructured periods or half-credit courses.

After the first two weeks of classes, changes to a student's schedule will only be considered due to extenuating circumstances. A student may not drop a course due to poor grades, teacher issues, a loss of interest or other demands on her time. Requests to change a schedule for a half-credit course in the spring will be subject to the same guidelines as all other courses. It is important that students understand the commitment they are making when requesting courses.

SJA/CHS SHARED CLASSES GUIDELINES

St. Joseph's Academy and Catholic High School are pleased to provide their students the opportunity to participate in shared classes on the campuses of both schools. The following guidelines provide direction for students, parents and teachers as we work cooperatively in this program of shared classes.

We consider a student's participation in a shared class to be a special opportunity that implies significant responsibility, which is a recurring theme throughout these guidelines. It is very important that a student and the student's parents understand these responsibilities and are willing to make the necessary commitment to ensure a successful academic experience. School officials will offer support, direction and encouragement to facilitate the student's success.

Academics

- Student performance: Both schools and teachers involved in the shared classes program have high expectations for student performance. Students must assume full responsibility for completing assigned homework and appropriate classwork to ensure academic success.
- Progress reporting: Parents will be informed about student performance through methods currently available, including but not limited to academic status/mid-quarter grades and report cards.
- Makeup work: Although every attempt will be made to minimize scheduling conflicts caused by assembly schedules of the two schools, occasionally, conflicts will be unavoidable. Teachers will use their discretion in assigning work. Scheduling conflicts will be considered, but it will remain the student's responsibility to complete all assigned work. On days when schedules conflict, any tests will be forwarded to the appropriate school so that the test can be taken as scheduled.

Behavior

- Commuting between schools: All SJA and CHS students should walk **the designated route to and from** unless given specific permission to drive by the SJA Dean of Women or CHS. Students will walk every day unless otherwise notified by the administration, even in inclement weather. In any case, students should conduct themselves appropriately and responsibly in transit between schools. Students should not travel to CHS by themselves. On days when a student is not traveling due to special schedules, she is expected to sign into the TLC and remain there for the duration of the class period.
- Attendance: Students and teachers will cooperatively make arrangements to reconcile any scheduling conflicts. Each student and each teacher of shared classes will receive copies of both schools' weekly calendars. Students should inform teachers about upcoming absences at least one week in advance. SJA students will receive the weekly calendar via email. When one school is not in session, students from that school are expected to attend shared classes at the other school unless the student is participating in a school activity or is excused by the teacher. Students should not travel to CHS by themselves. If they are the only student traveling, they should go to the Main Office or Deans' Office for an escort.

- Absences: Each teacher should notify the office in his or her school of a student's absence. The attendance office of that school should then contact the attendance office of the sending school to report each student's absence. Information regarding excused and unexcused absences will be reported to the individual teacher through the attendance office at his or her school.
- Tardiness: Students arriving after the start of class will be considered tardy. Tardiness problems will be handled by the individual teacher in consultation with the Dean of Women.
- Dress and grooming: Students are expected to be neatly dressed and groomed at all times during the academic day. Students from SJA are expected to wear the complete SJA uniform whenever attending classes at CHS, even on special dress or out-of-uniform days. CHS students are expected to comply with the requirements of the CHS dress code whenever attending classes at SJA. This policy remains in effect regardless of whether classes are being held at the sending school.
- Conduct: Each student is expected to conduct him or herself in an appropriate manner both in the classroom and in other locations on the campuses of both schools.

Parent/Student Conferences

Students and teachers are encouraged to meet to resolve academic or behavioral problems. Should either a teacher or a student feel the need to consult with a third party, he or she should contact the appropriate school administrator (academics: Dean of Academics at SJA or Academic Assistant Principal at CHS; behavior: Dean of Women at SJA or Assistant Principal for Discipline at CHS). This administrator will then contact his or her counterpart to begin the process of resolving difficulties.

Miscellaneous

These guidelines are not intended to be overly prescriptive; rather, they are intended to provide the maximum amount of flexibility to the individual classroom teacher as he or she works with students from both schools. Should questions arise which are not specifically addressed by these guidelines, students, parents and/or teachers are encouraged to talk to an administrator. It is our hope that in the spirit of true cooperation between schools and among students, teachers and parents, each participant will realize the maximum benefit from his or her participation in this program of shared classes.

ALTERNATE PE CREDIT

Summer PE

The Summer PE course is for students who choose to take seven full credit courses during the school year and cannot fit a half credit of PE into their schedules. Summer PE takes place the summer before the start of the school year. Students must choose one session and may not attend other sessions to fulfill the requirements. Students must attend 10 of the 12 classes offered during the selected session and must complete home health assignments each week of class. Students who take Summer PE will not be permitted to schedule an unstructured period the next academic year. Additionally, students are not eligible to take Summer PE for half-credit electives. Students who sign up must be physically capable of completing the session. If a student must enroll in summer school, she cannot take Summer PE and will need to change her schedule.

All requirements must be met, and all assignments must be completed. Assignments will be posted on MySJA. Health assignments will be completed off campus. Students should be in class prior to the start of each session. If a student arrives after the start of class, she will be counted as tardy and will lose participation points. If a student is more than 10 minutes late, she will be considered absent.

There is an extra fee for this course. Each session of Summer PE has an enrollment limit. Session availability is communicated to students and parents after course selections. Every effort is made to honor a student's first or second choice.

Incoming freshmen or transfer students enrolled in Summer PE must participate in a computer training session prior to the start of sessions.

This course is not included in the determination of valedictorian or salutatorian. Please refer to the Graduation Requirements section of the handbook.

Earning PE Credit Through Athletics/Band

Students may earn 1 PE credit over two years for participation in SJA or Catholic High School athletics or band programs during their junior or senior year. Students may earn a maximum of ½ PE credits per school year. Student transcripts will list the course as PE III/IV – Athletic team name or Band.

Eligible activities include

- LHSAA-sanctioned sports (basketball, bowling, cross country, varsity golf, gymnastics, powerlifting, soccer, softball, swimming, tennis, track & field and volleyball)
- SJA Cheer
- Red Steppers
- CHS Cheer
- CHS Bruinettes
- Band

The administration makes final decisions on the eligibility of athletes for this PE credit. Student managers, club sports (including beach volleyball) and intramural sports do not qualify for PE credit. Students must be in good standing and complete the full season to receive credit, and guidelines will be established for each sport. Verification of participation must be provided by the SJA or CHS athletic departments. If a student leaves a team for any reason, she must enroll in an SJA PE course the following semester or as directed by the Dean of Academics, which may result in a significant schedule change. Students who join a team after scheduling classes may replace their scheduled PE class with Athletic PE upon making the team; however, course changes are dependent on scheduling availability and require timely communication between the student, parent and Dean of Academics, as the Athletic Director is not responsible for communicating on behalf of the student regarding schedule adjustments. If a student enrolled in an SJA PE course or Summer PE joins a team after completing the PE course, she will earn PE credit through non-athletic PE instead of athletic PE and may not earn a full PE credit more than once in the same school year. Although students may earn credit through athletics or band, they may choose to enroll in PE III/IV or F.I.T.; in this case, they will earn PE credit through non-athletic PE and may not earn more than one full PE credit in a single school year.

Dual-sport athletes will receive PE credit through only one sport per school year. If circumstances arise that are not covered in this policy, school administration will make the final determination regarding the awarding of Health and PE credits.

Students will receive a semester letter grade based on attendance, active participation and fulfillment of all team or marching band requirements. Grades are not based on skill level or playing time.

SJA Gameday Cheer is not eligible to earn alternative PE credit.

TRANSFER STUDENTS

Young women from other schools interested in becoming an SJA student must contact the Director of Admissions.

Due to SJA graduation requirements, a student will not be accepted as a new student after the first semester of her junior year. Students who transfer from another high school will earn credits that align with SJA's credit system. A transfer student's official transcript from her previous school(s) will be reviewed by the Registrar. When a comparable course is not found, a course is defined in the student management system, and appropriate credit is assigned. For honors designation, only those courses offered at the honors level at SJA are designated as such and weighted. These courses must be designated as an honors course on the previous school's transcript.

When a student transfers to St. Joseph's Academy, transferred credits and GPAs earned will be equated as fairly as possible in alignment with SJA's curriculum and GPA requirements. Final approval of credits will be made by the Principal and Dean of Academics.

Transfer students and parents must meet with the Dean of Academics and sign an individualized transfer agreement. After the student has transferred, a meeting will be scheduled between the student and the Dean of Women to discuss campus life and policies, including clubs, Dining Hall procedures, parking, student ID pictures and uniform information. The student and parent will be required to sign the Handbook Acknowledgment Form on MySJA.

All questions regarding transfer student athletic eligibility should be directed to the SJA Athletic Director. If enrolling after a team holds its tryouts, transfer students may not be able to join the team until the following year.

Service Requirements

Transfer students enrolled at St. Joseph's Academy are required to participate in the service program. Transfer students completing more than 50 hours of service in one school year will receive special recognition at the end of the year. Students who complete 50 hours of service during every academic year, at their previous high schools as well as St. Joseph's Academy, will receive the Service Award and be recognized at Honors Convocation following their senior year. Transfer students must show evidence of prior service hour completion during the admissions process. Transfer students who did not complete 50 or more hours during an academic year before coming to SJA will not be allowed to apply extra service hours in their years at SJA towards making up the deficit.

Course Requirements

Theology: Transfer students are required to take a Theology course for each year they attend SJA, enrolling in the corresponding grade-level course (Theology II for sophomores, Theology III for juniors). Depending on previous coursework, a student may be required to take more than one Theology course in a year, particularly if Theology II is needed to meet a social studies credit requirement. While theology courses from previous high schools will be recorded on the student's transcript, they do not substitute for the required theology course at SJA for each year of attendance. Final determination of accepting credits for theology is made by the Dean of Academics.

Health & PE: In order to fulfill health requirements, transfer students may need to enroll in SJA Health & PE courses that surpass the required activity credits needed to graduate. **Health credits are only offered in the Health & PE I/II course.** Transfer students who earn high school credit for health in middle school may receive a Carnegie unit with a grade of P. **Transfer students may need to enroll in a full credit of PE in order to fulfill graduation requirements.** Transfer students enrolled in Summer PE must participate in a computer training session prior to the start of sessions.

World Language: Transfer students must meet state requirements for world language courses by completing two Carnegie units of the same language. High school credits earned in middle school can count toward this requirement. If a transfer student has met the necessary requirements but chooses to continue studying a world language, or if she needs to complete the requirement, she must take a placement test to determine the appropriate course level. Due to variations in course rigor, students may be asked to repeat a level previously taken at their previous school.

Core Courses: All students must take a math, science and English course each year of high school. For social studies course, all students must meet the requirements for graduation.

UNSTRUCTURED PERIODS

All students with unstructured periods in their schedule may use this time for reference work and for

arrangement of conferences with teachers and guidance counselors/college advisors. These periods enable students to develop habits such as responsibility, self-discipline and wise and efficient use of free time, habits that will benefit them beyond high school. Students are not allowed to leave campus during their unstructured period. Students are welcome to spend their unstructured time (before/after school, unstructured periods and lunch) in the Technology and Learning Center, Fife Student Commons, dining hall or outdoor areas. When permitted by the teacher and with supervision, a student may spend her unstructured time in an academic classroom/building.

If a student has scheduled two unstructured periods, she will have one unstructured period in the fall semester and one in the spring semester. If a student has scheduled one unstructured period, it will be scheduled in one semester only. The student does not have a choice in which semester the unstructured period occurs. Additionally, the student will not be able to choose the class period in which the unstructured period occurs. Unstructured periods are scheduled during the class period and in the semester that work best for the student's schedule and the entire SJA master schedule.

Late-arrival or early-dismissal unstructured periods are a senior-only privilege. Parents and students are required to complete the Senior Late Check-In Permission Slip for Unstructured First Period or the Senior Early Check-Out Permission Slip for Unstructured Last Period. Both forms are located on MySJA. Seniors with first period unstructured are allowed to check in late but must arrive 10 minutes before the end of first period. In the event of a morning assembly, seniors are required to be checked in by 7:30 a.m. All first-hour students are required to sign in at the main office. Sophomores and juniors must sign in by 7:28 a.m. Seniors are required to sign in 10 minutes before the first period.

Seniors with eighth period unstructured are allowed to leave after community prayer unless there is an end-of-the-day assembly, such as a pep rally.

WITHDRAWAL FROM SJA

A student who withdraws from SJA, regardless of the reason, must fulfill any pending financial obligations, return her school-issued laptop computer, including the case, stylus and cord in working condition, and any issued textbooks to the school.

PERSONAL GROWTH

LIVING IN COMMUNITY: RULES, POLICIES AND PROCEDURES

St. Joseph's Academy encourages our young women to be responsible and unifying members of the world community. SJA attempts to play an appropriate role in guiding students to make good choices. While it is not the province of SJA to prescribe what limits or freedoms parents choose for their daughters, we do expect students to conduct themselves at all times in a manner consistent with the mission of SJA with a Christian attitude and respect for others. This expectation applies at all times (whether the student is on campus or off campus and regardless of whether the student is participating at the time in an SJA-sponsored event). Students should be aware that their actions (no matter when engaged in) can reflect on SJA and that they are subject to disciplinary consequences on a 24/7/365 basis.

The interests of a St. Joseph's Academy student are best served by cooperative relationships among the student, her parents, teachers and the school's administrators. The regulations and procedures set forth in this handbook are designed to serve the students' interests and to facilitate a spirit of cooperation. At times, disagreements may arise between a student's parents and the school concerning application of school regulations. In such instances, reasonable efforts are made to resolve the disputed issues. But if cooperative efforts fail and an impasse results, the student may be subject to dismissal from St. Joseph's Academy. In developing policies for St. Joseph's Academy, the administration has tried to anticipate as many issues as possible. But as new and unusual situations may arise, the principal has the authority to make decisions under

any circumstances not precisely covered by handbook rules.

Wherever the term “parent” is used in this handbook, “guardian” is implied.

THE COUNSELING CENTER

Counselors remain with their class for all four years.

Class of 2027

Lindsay Carlino '02 (Department Chair)
carlinol@sjabr.org; (225) 388-2225

Class of 2028

Allison (Allie) Adler Dasso '16
dassoa@sjabr.org; (225) 388-2281

Class of 2029

TBA

Class of 2030

Kellie Braud Wintz '02
wintzk@sjabr.org; (225) 388-2223

College Advisor (A-Lawrence)

Allison Hipwell Bruton '95 (Director of College Advising)
brutona@sjabr.org; (225) 388-2299

College Advisor (LeBlanc-Z)

Ellen Frazier
fraziere@sjabr.org; (225) 388-2251

Wellness Educator

Melissa Shaw '96
shawm@sjabr.org; (225) 388-2347

Counseling Center Data Specialist, Testing Coordinator

Valerie Bordelon Brubaker '95
brubakerv@sjabr.org; (225) 388-2233

Goals

The Counseling Center participates in SJA's mission to assist students in attaining faith development, academic excellence and personal growth.

Student Services

Counselors meet with students in individual and group settings to guide them toward meeting the above goals. Counselors meet with students throughout the year to discuss standardized test score reports, GPA and scheduling requirements for SJA. Additionally, counselors meet with students in small groups to discuss college readiness and will give basic college information. If a student asks for help or is referred to the counselors by faculty, staff member or parents for emotional issues, drug use, suicidal ideation or other issues that pose a threat to the emotional, physical or psychological well-being of the student, the counselors, along with the administrators, may require or recommend professional mental-health counseling.

Disclosure Statement Regarding Confidentiality

Our primary obligation and loyalty are to the student. Therefore, any information shared with the counselors will be treated with the utmost respect. In general, the counselors will not disclose any confidential information a student has shared with them. However, the law and/or the ethical standards of the counselors' profession may require them to disclose information in certain situations including, for example, to various legal authorities, school administration and/or to the parents of minors when sharing such information may protect the student or others from harm. In addition, it may become necessary to inform school officials of any intent to harm school property if such information becomes known to a counselor through a counseling session.

Students should be aware that the sharing of information from a counseling session will only be done after careful consideration, and every effort will be made to notify the student in advance of the obligation and intention to disclose confidential information.

The signing of the handbook acknowledgment form gives permission for the counselors to meet with students and discuss with administration the possible need to refer a student to outside professional counseling, mental health evaluation or education evaluation.

By signing the handbook acknowledgment form, the student and parents recognize that a counselor may, by law and ethical standards of the profession, be required to disclose confidential information provided by the student to third parties.

Mandated Reporting

All SJA faculty and staff are mandated reporters. Teacher or childcare provider is any person who provides or assists in the teaching, training and supervision of a child, including any public or private school teacher, teacher's aide, instructional aide, school principal, school staff member, bus driver, coach, professor, technical or vocational instructor, technical or vocational school staff member, college or university administrator, college or university staff member, social worker, probation officer, foster home parent, group home or other childcare institution staff member, personnel of residential home facilities, a licensed or unlicensed daycare provider or any individual who provides such services to a child in a voluntary or professional capacity. The school is not obligated to alert a parent when a report has been made.

ADMISSIONS

Admissions Policy

St. Joseph's Academy is a Catholic, all-girls, college-preparatory high school. SJA has an admissions policy that is nondiscriminatory regarding race or national origin. Students of all faiths, educational and socioeconomic backgrounds who have the academic ability and motivation to succeed are invited to apply. Special consideration is shown to Catholic families who have consistently supported Catholic education or who have a legacy at SJA. Final decisions regarding admission are made by the President and Principal with recommendations from the Admissions Committee and the support of the SJA Board of Directors.

Admissions criteria are overall middle school record; standardized test scores; personal interview with applicant and her parents; space availability at SJA; recommendation of elementary/middle school principal (for students attending Catholic elementary schools); admissions exam (PreACT 8/9) results; discipline and attendance records and completed online application.

Attendance at SJA Welcome Week, typically the last week of July, is mandatory. Dates are provided in the admissions packet.

Information regarding transfer students can be found in the Academic Excellence section of the handbook.

AFTER-SCHOOL RULES AND REGULATIONS

After dismissal, students may remain on campus in one of the following designated areas: Fife Student Commons (FSC), Investar Quad, courtyard or Technology and Learning Center (TLC) between 2:50 and 3:30 p.m. Students may not leave campus after dismissal to roam the neighborhood. At 3:30 p.m., an announcement will direct students to sign in at the FSC while they wait for their ride (unless they are supervised by an adult in an after-school activity, including club meetings and athletic practices) or at the TLC for tutoring or quiet studying. The after-school sign-in is for SJA students who remain at SJA and are on campus past the dismissal bell. If a student leaves campus for an activity at Catholic High School (practice, club meeting, tryout), **she should be picked up from CHS after her activity unless arrangements were made in advance with the Dean of Women. If a student is not picked up immediately after her meeting, practice or make-up test, her adult supervisor will either wait with her for pick-up or walk her to one of the after-school spaces if it is before 5 p.m.**

Guests from other schools cannot sign in or be on campus **unless with a sanctioned activity supervised by an adult (ex: club meeting)**. Students cannot return to school to sign into the TLC/FSC after they leave campus. On a shortened schedule when students are dismissed before 2:50 p.m., students who are still on campus and unsupervised by an adult are expected to sign into the TLC or FSC 40 minutes after the bell rings. Students who are unsupervised by an adult and found on campus after authorized times are subject to disciplinary action.

Students who remain after school and desire after-school tutoring or who wish to book a study carrel must sign into the iPad at the TLC Station before 3:30 p.m. They will be required to be picked up in front of Medaille Hall in the Medaille Circle by 5 p.m. Students who start in the TLC for tutoring but are unable to be picked up by 5 p.m. will be escorted by an after-school monitor to the FSC for pick-up. If a student is in the FSC and desires support from the Learning Center before 5 p.m., she should notify the after-school monitor who will communicate with the TLC after-school Monitor for transition.

Food and drinks other than water are not permitted in the TLC after school.

Our security officer is on campus until 5:30 p.m. each school day.

A student must be picked up from where she signs in and **must sign out before she leaves**; students who are picked up from the TLC are picked up from the Medaille Circle, and students who are signed into the FSC should be picked up from the Kleinert lot. If a student is not picked up by 5:30 p.m., this will be reported to Dean of Women Christina Richardson, and a plan will be made.

ATTENDANCE

Regular attendance in classes and school-related activities helps to promote better academic performance and build school and community spirit. Excessive absenteeism and tardiness prove costly in terms of lost productivity. While a certain amount of absenteeism and tardiness is inevitable in any organization, students and parents are expected to cooperate in maximizing attendance.

When it is necessary for the student to be absent, the parent or guardian should notify the Attendance Coordinator by completing the Attendance Reporting Form found on the Resources page on MySJA. If a student will miss any classes, for a reason other than illness, advance notice from the parent must be sent to the Dean of Women via the Attendance Reporting Form at least one day before the absence in order for it to be considered.

Louisiana requires students to attend school for a certain number of days and complete 26,400 instructional minutes per semester to be promoted to the next grade and earn credit for the course [Bulletin 741 Handbook for nonpublic schools]. If a student misses a specific class **10** times in a semester, regardless of whether the absences are excused or unexcused, the student may be subject to academic or disciplinary consequences in

that course. If a student misses more than 10 school days (or 70 classes) in a semester, regardless of whether the absences are excused or unexcused, she will be required to withdraw and may have to return her computer to SJA. Families should reference the SJA calendar to ensure the maximum number of school days are attended.

Any student absent from school or who misses more than four periods is not permitted to attend a school-sponsored event on that day and must be fever free and not vomiting for at least 24 hours before returning. She is allowed to make up any and all work missed during her absence. It is the student's obligation to find out about missed assignments. Each department has a make-up policy/days. See the course MySJA page and this handbook for specifics on each class/department. The make-up test policy can be found in the Academic Excellence section of this handbook. Seven accumulated missed class periods will equate to one full day absent. **An unstructured period is considered a class period for students.**

TYPES OF ABSENCES

The Assistant Dean of Women makes the determination of excused versus unexcused absences. Absences are recorded per class period, with seven accumulated missed class periods equating to one full day absent. Absences are evaluated based on classes and school days missed. If a student misses a specific class 10 times in a semester, regardless of whether the absences are excused or unexcused, the student may be subject to academic or disciplinary consequences in that course. This may include loss of credit in the course and/or issuing an attendance contract. On the sixth absence in a single class in a semester, a doctor's note must be presented to have any further absences excused. If a student misses more than 10 school days (70 class periods) in a semester, regardless of whether the absences are excused or unexcused, she will be required to withdraw and return her computer to SJA. Parent notification of a student's reason for an absence must be turned in by the end of the school day, or the absence will be considered unexcused and will not be changed. Students are considered to have attended a class if they are present for more than 50 percent of the class time. A late arrival to an attendance class will be recorded as a tardy, and an early dismissal will count as a check-out. Excused or exempt absences have no academic or disciplinary consequences, while unexcused absences are subject to consequences.

Type of Absence	Examples (not inclusive)	Student allowed to make up work?	Count towards the total allowed by the state?
Absent Excused Tardy or Check-Out Excused	· Documented doctor's appointment (therapy, dentist, lab work etc.) A signed doctor's note is to be provided by the office of the appointment. · Personal illness or injury · College visits (see College Visit section of handbook) · Three outside-SJA events/competitions submitted/approved in advance · Death of a family member/funeral · Approved family event submitted/approved in advance (wedding, graduation, etc.) · DMV visits *A signed doctor's note provided by the office of the appointment	Yes. Part of the approval process will include the student reporting to each of their teachers for information about makeup assignments. Students are required to make up assignments within each department's policy. For extended absences, a student can work with her counselor on an appropriate makeup plan.	Yes. Absences of this nature are counted towards the student's overall attendance record.
Absent Unexcused Tardy or Check-Out Unexcused	· Family vacation/trips · Driving time and/or classes · Absence without notification by the end of the school day · Non-medical appointments · College visits without prior notice/documentation · Missing school to complete service hours · Concerts	No. Students are expected to turn in assignments on their original due dates. Late assignments are subject to each department's late work policy.	Yes. Absences of this nature are counted towards the student's overall attendance record. An unexcused absence can result in an infraction.
Absent Exempt	· Educational evaluation with a signed excuse from the professional administering the assessment. · Educational absence affiliated with SJA school events, such as science fairs, conventions, Student Minister-led retreats, field trips and SJA athletic events. · Inpatient medical	Yes. It is the student's responsibility to speak with her teachers about any work that will be missed. Whenever possible, assignments should be turned in on their original due dates. Otherwise, students are required to make up assignments per each department's policy.	No. The student must complete any make-up assignments per the make-up policies of each department. Any exempt absences will not be counted against a student's overall attendance.

Excused Absence

Absences will be excused for the following reasons. Requests for any other reason must be approved in advance by filling out the Absence Reporting Form and emailing the Assistant Dean of Women.

- Personal illness or injury. A parent must complete the Absence Reporting Form by 7:30 a.m. if his/her student will be absent due to illness. If notification isn't received from the parent, the absence is marked as unexcused, and an email is sent to the parent inquiring about the student's attendance. If no response is received from the parent by the end of that school day, the absence will remain unexcused on the student's record. If a student is absent three consecutive days, she must bring a doctor's note to the Attendance Coordinator within three days of the absence. The student will be considered unexcused until the doctor's note is received, and she will receive an infraction.
- Medical appointment. A signed doctor's note is required for the check in/out or absence to be considered excused. All excuses must be turned in via the Attendance Reporting Form within three days of the absence. If a signed doctor's note is not turned in within the time frame, the absence will remain unexcused on the student's record. Submitting the doctor's note at a later date will not change the absence to excused.
- Migraines. If a student checks in or out or misses school due to migraines, a signed medical doctor's note is required for the absence to be excused.
- Death of a family member.
- College visit (see College Visit section)
- Educational absence affiliated with school events, such as science fairs, conventions, Student Minister- led retreats and athletic events. The student is required to complete any make-up assignments. These absences are considered exempt and do not count against a student's attendance record.
- Outside competition/non-SJA team competitions and events. While students are encouraged to maintain their extra-curricular competitions and teams outside of SJA, we will allow only three excused events during the school year. A parent or guardian must complete the Absence Reporting Form at least one school day prior to the competition with proof of participation. Approval may be denied if a student has acquired excessive absences and/or is failing an academic course. **Students who have missed three days should reach out to the Assistant Dean of Women in advance to discuss how future absences will affect overall attendance.** Additional non-SJA events in excess of the three allowed may be approved with advance notice submitted to the Assistant Dean of Women. Consequences and a conversation with the Assistant Dean of Women will take place if a student misses more than her allowed number of excused absences. These additional absences could include disciplinary and academic consequences.

Additional days missed outside of the competition as personal days are considered unexcused, and there will be disciplinary consequences.

Unexcused Absence

If a student is absent from school without a legitimate reason or if a student is absent from school as a matter of convenience to herself or her family, it will be considered unexcused. The student will receive an infraction for each day she has an unexcused absence. She must make up any assignments missed during the absence. Examples include but are not limited to vacations/trips, **personal days**, concerts, non-medical appointments, driver's education classes and/or driving time (excluding DMV visits). Parent notification of a student's reason for an absence must be turned in by the end of the school day, or the absence will be considered unexcused and will not be changed.

Upon a student's third unexcused absence, a call or meeting with a dean will take place and the student will face academic consequences which may include a zero grade for any homework or classwork missed.

Excessive/Extended Absence

If a student misses a specific class 10 times in a semester, regardless of whether the absences are excused or unexcused, the student may be subject to academic or disciplinary consequences in that course. This may include loss of credit in the course and/or issuing of an attendance contract. If a student misses a class more than six times in a semester, a doctor's note will be required for all health-related absences.

Louisiana requires students to attend school for a certain number of days and complete 26,400 instructional minutes per semester to be promoted to the next grade and earn credit for the course (Bulletin 741 Handbook for nonpublic schools). Seven accumulated missed class periods will equate to one full day absent.

If a student misses more than 10 days in a semester (70 classes overall), regardless of whether the absences are excused or unexcused, she will be required to withdraw and may have to return her computer to SJA. The student may be able to return the following semester or year if she is able to make up her classes through an accredited program approved by SJA. Students who are deemed by the administration to have excessive absences will be put on an attendance contract for the remainder of the school year or asked to withdraw.

Part of the determination on attendance consequences depends on the student's motivation to keep up with assignments. Students with excessive absences on quiz or test days may be subject to academic consequences. Students who had excessive tardies or absences during the prior academic year may be asked to sign an attendance contract before the start of the new school year.

- On the 3rd absence in a semester (21 classes), an email will be sent to the student's parent.
- On the 6th absence in a semester (42 classes), a conference will be requested between the Dean of Women and the parent. With this number of absences, a doctor's note must be presented to have any further absences excused. College visits, field trips, non-SJA outside events/competitions and other optional absences may not be approved after the 6th absence.
- On the 8th absence in a semester (56 classes), a second conference will be requested between the administration, student and parent.
- On the 9th absence in a semester (63 classes), a formal notice of the student's course credit and continued enrollment is given.
- On the 10th absence in a semester (70 classes), the student will be required to withdraw and may have to return her computer to SJA.

Absences During Exams

All students are expected to take their exams during their regularly scheduled time. If there is a serious conflict, special permission must be obtained from the Dean of Women. If a student misses an exam and cannot make it up during conflicts, the student will take the exam during the following week. No early exams will be given except in the case of an extreme emergency. Students who take more than one class in the same subject area must see the Dean of Academics to schedule a conflict exam during exam days.

Modified Schedule of Attendance

In cases of extended absences due to health reasons and when a student's health does not allow for a full day of classes upon her return, the grade-level counselor will work with the student on a modified schedule of attendance. The counselor will send the final schedule to the Dean of Academics. The student's classes will be scheduled with her regular teachers. The student must have a signed medical note stating the reason. Teachers will be given information on the scheduling requirements for the student. If the modified schedule must be utilized for an extended period of time, the student may be asked to withdraw from SJA. Any type of medical exception should be documented with a doctor's note stating the accommodation and time frame for the accommodation.

CHECK-IN/CHECK-OUT PROCEDURE

To help maintain a learning environment that is as uninterrupted as possible, a student should be aware of her

early check-out time prior to the start of class, inform her teacher before class begins and leave quietly at the appropriate time without disrupting instruction.

Illness or Injury

If a student becomes ill or is experiencing any health-related issues during the day and must leave campus, she must report to the School Nurse **first**, who will then call the student's parent to obtain permission before the student leaves. Forms filled out for a future sick checkout will not be accepted. If the student fails to check out with the nurse for an illness or any health-related issue and uses the checkout station in the main office instead, the absence will remain unexcused. **If a student checks out ill, she is not permitted to return for school events during the school day.** Seven accumulated missed class periods will equate to one full day absent. An unstructured period is considered a class period for students.

Medical Appointments

Most routine visits to the doctor should be scheduled outside of school hours. If a student knows in advance that she must leave early for a doctor's appointment, the parent must complete the Attendance Reporting Form by 7:30 a.m. on the day of the checkout. A signed and dated note must be submitted through the Attendance Reporting Form, or a physical copy can be turned into the main office. If a signed note is not turned in within three days of the appointment, the absence will remain unexcused on the student's record. Students who check out during their lunch period for appointments will also be required to provide a doctor's note.

Any check-outs other than medical appointments or illnesses must have prior approval. This includes check-outs during lunch periods.

Seniors with Unstructured Periods

Only seniors who sign the appropriate documentation will be given the opportunity to arrive late or leave school early during their unstructured period. Students in grades 9 through 11 do not have this privilege. Students and a parent are required to complete the Senior Late Check-In Permission Slip for Unstructured First Period or Senior Early Check-Out Permission Slip for Unstructured Last Period form that is located on MySJA.

Seniors with first period unstructured are allowed to check in late but must arrive 10 minutes before the end of first period. (Example: Following Schedule 1, first period ends at **8:19** a.m.; the student should sign in by **8:09** a.m.) Seniors with eighth period unstructured are allowed to leave at the end of the day unless we have an end-of-the-day assembly, such as a pep rally.

COLLEGE VISITS

Students are encouraged to visit colleges of interest during the summer and school holidays.

Seniors are allowed three excused college visits during the academic year. (These three events are not in addition to the 10 days already allowed.) Juniors and sophomores are allowed two excused absences for college visits during the academic year. When necessary, a travel day is allotted for each college visit.

Notification of a student's college visit and confirmation of the tour from the university, if applicable, must be submitted through the Absence Reporting Form by a parent at least one school day before the scheduled absence. If notification is not received, the absence will be marked as unexcused. Any student who misses more than her allowed number of excused absences for college visits will receive an infraction. No college visits will be approved during midterms, final exams or AP testing. College visits should be avoided on test days. Students are responsible for paying attention to their test calendar.

Please note that any day missed for college visits, whether considered excused or unexcused, counts towards a student's overall absences for the semester.

EARLY DISMISSALS

For school activities or athletics: Students who consistently leave school early for a school-sanctioned activity can contact the Dean of Academics prior to the start of the athletic season to establish an alternative schedule during the athletic season or for the duration of the activity. This alternative schedule could include time within the school day for making up missed work and attending the class that is most often missed. Students who are struggling academically and do not follow the revised schedule will be subject to exclusion from the sport or activity.

For Professional Learning Communities and Faculty Professional Development: The intention of this early dismissal time for students (Schedule 3 and 8) is to allow teachers who teach the same course to meet. These professional learning communities (PLCs) allow for professional dialogue and collaborative study that will ultimately improve the educational environment of St. Joseph's Academy. The vision is for stronger leadership and teaching that will, in turn, lead to greater student achievement in the classroom and on standardized tests.

All early dismissals will be listed on the school calendar. If there are school closures during the year, that time will be made up by cancelling the necessary number of PLCs.

On early dismissal days, students can choose to remain on campus to utilize the Learning Center (Math, Science, Writing and English Resource). The Technology and Learning Center and Help Desk will be open during this time. Sports practices and club meetings sponsored by a faculty member will not begin during the PLC time. On early dismissal days, students must sign into the Technology and Learning Center no later than 40 minutes after the bell.

The complete bell schedule can be found under the Quick Links section of the SJA website.

TARDINESS

Students are expected to be on time for every class. Excessive tardiness to a given class may result in an infraction from the teacher. The warning bell rings at 7:25 a.m., and the tardy bell rings at 7:28 a.m.

A student who does not arrive to her first hour class prior to the tardy bell must report to the main office to sign in. **The Attendance Coordinator will provide a tardy slip through the sign-in system so the student can enter class.** Beginning with the third unexcused tardy, an infraction is given for every unexcused tardy. Excessive tardiness may result in a two-hour Saturday school or Saturday suspension. See below for a sample flow of consequences for excessive tardiness in a semester:

1st and 2nd unexcused tardy: Recorded in MySJA without additional consequence.

3rd unexcused tardy: Recorded in MySJA, infraction issued.

4th-6th unexcused tardy: Recorded in MySJA, detention earned.

Beginning with 7th unexcused tardy: Recorded in MySJA, meeting with the Dean of Women, parent contacted, Saturday School earned for each unexcused tardy moving forward.

TRAFFIC

Students are permitted to arrive as early as 6:30 a.m. Traffic issues are expected and will not be approved as an excused tardy. We ask that students and their families make adjustments in their morning routines to ensure they are at school by the morning bell. Extreme weather, road accidents and out-of-the-ordinary circumstances are considered excused on a case-by-case basis and at the discretion of the Dean of Women. The parent is asked to contact the main office if he/she anticipates their student will be tardy. The tardy will remain unexcused unless a parent makes contact by the end of the day. All students are allotted two unexcused tardies without a consequence when traffic causes them to be late. Beginning on the third tardy, an infraction is issued.

CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES ATHLETICS

Interscholastic athletics are an integral part of the total educational program at St. Joseph's Academy. The purpose of athletic activities is to provide educational experiences not otherwise provided in the curriculum that will contribute to the student's knowledge, physical skills and emotional and spiritual development.

SJA student-athletes compete in the following sports:

- Basketball
- Bowling
- Cross Country
- Golf
- Gymnastics
- Powerlifting
- Soccer
- Softball
- Swimming
- Tennis
- Track and Field (indoor and outdoor)
- Volleyball

Non-LHSAA sanctioned sports:

- eSports
- Beach Volleyball
- Red Steppers
- SJA Gameday Cheer Squad
- SJA Cheerleaders

The combination of outstanding athletes and nationally acclaimed coaches has enabled SJA to win district, city and state championships. The outstanding individual efforts of many Redstickers have led to continued careers as collegiate scholarship athletes.

SJA is a member of the Louisiana High School Athletic Association (LHSAA) and enjoys a statewide reputation for compliance with all LHSAA regulations and policies. All athletes must meet the scholastic and eligibility requirements as outlined by the LHSAA.

Any student-athlete who has a reasonable chance to play collegiate sports and/or to earn a college scholarship in athletics must register online with the NCAA Eligibility Center at the end of her freshman year in high school. For more information on the NCAA Eligibility Center and the online registration process, please refer to this website: <https://www.ncaa.org/sports/2021/2/8/student-athletes-future.aspx>

For additional information, contact SJA's Athletic Director.

All student-athletes must have an LHSAA physical form completed and signed by a physician and their parents before they can try out for any SJA sport. The form can be found on MySJA in the Resources Board, Athletics. This form can also be found on the SJA website under Quicklinks, Forms. You will print the form and take it to your daughter's physician to complete and sign. Please scan the completed form or take a picture of it with your smartphone and upload to MySJA, Resources, Athletics before tryouts. Once the team is selected, additional information will be provided for parents to complete the remaining required forms.

Please note that student-athletes must attend all tryout dates listed with their sport.

Student-athletes may be placed on probation if their academic standing falls below the requirement or for

consequences of disciplinary infractions.

Please [click here](#) for the Athletic Department Policy Manual.

LHSAA Student-Athlete Concussion Protocol

All requirements must be met before a student can return to participation in an athletic program.

- Any player who exhibits signs, symptoms or behaviors consistent with a concussion (such as loss of consciousness, headache, dizziness, confusion or balance problems) shall be immediately removed from the contest and shall not return to play until cleared by an appropriate healthcare professional.
- A concussion is a traumatic brain injury that interferes with normal brain function. A student-athlete does not have to lose consciousness to have suffered a concussion.
- A student-athlete who exhibits any signs or symptoms of a concussion will be removed from the activity immediately.
- If a student-athlete is diagnosed with a concussion, she will complete a Return to Play Program with the athletic trainer.

Return to Play Program per LHSAA

Steps cannot be started without a written note from a physician. If a student needs to have limitations in the classroom, e.g., not able to use a computer and not taking tests, then she is not able to move on to Step 2.

Step 1

a: Rest day: Full day of rest with no symptoms.

b: Return to class/academics: Full day of school with no symptoms. This includes using computers and having no limitations while at school.

Step 2: Light Aerobic Activity

This usually includes a stationary bike ride to increase heart rate for 10-15 minutes. If at any point the student-athlete has symptoms, then Step 2 stops. Step 2 can be repeated once symptom free for 24 hours.

Step 3: Sport-Specific Training (non-contact)

This consists of controlled sport-specific exercises. If at any point the student-athlete has symptoms, then Step 3 stops. Step 3 can be repeated once symptom free for 24 hours.

Step 4: Training Drills (non-contact) Resistance Training

This consists of controlled resistance training exercises. If at any point the student-athlete has symptoms, then Step 4 stops. Step 4 can be repeated once symptom free for 24 hours.

Step 5: Full Contact Training (with physician clearance)

Full practice with no limitations with no symptoms. If at any point the student-athlete has symptoms, then Step 5 stops. Step 5 can be repeated once symptom free for 24 hours.

Step 6: Return to competition

After all steps are completed, then a physician clearance note is required.

Athletic Lettering Requirements

In order to receive a varsity letter in a particular sport, a student-athlete should demonstrate skill through her participation in games, practices and all team functions. She should exhibit a willingness to work toward team goals, good sportsmanship and a spirit of cooperation with her coaches and teammates. To letter, a student-athlete must make a significant contribution to her team in all of these areas as determined by and at the discretion of the head coach.

Intramural Program

All SJA students can enjoy athletic competition, thanks to our intramural sports program. Each year, our Intramural Sports Director offers students the opportunity to compete in team or partner sports, including volleyball, ping pong, lacrosse, badminton, archery, dodge ball, pickleball, flag football, rock climbing, ultimate frisbee and more. Additionally, students can join students from Catholic High School to compete in the coed sports of volleyball (fall) and kickball (spring).

New and different activities are offered each year. Many intramural activities/events are held in the fall and repeated in the spring to accommodate the busy schedules of our students.

For more information, contact Intramural Sports Director Tim LaBauve at labauvet@sjabr.org.

Clubs/Student Organizations

Numerous clubs are available for students. Each club meets monthly and has its own individual membership criteria. Some clubs meet and work with their Catholic High School counterparts. Also, many clubs are affiliated with state and national organizations. All clubs must be approved by the Activities Coordinator, who appoints an official club moderator. Requests to form new clubs must be presented to Activities Coordinator Aimee Cronan at cronana@sjabr.org.

- American Sign Language Club
- Art Club
- Art History Club
- Beta Club
- Black Box Company (SJA/CHS Drama Club)
- CHS Bruinettes
- CHS Cheerleaders
- CHS Marching Band
- Coding Club
- Cooking and Crafts Club
- Creative Writers' Club
- Criminal Justice Club
- Diversity Club
- Entrepreneurship Club
- Environmental Club
- Film Club
- French Club I
- French Club II
- French Honor Club
- Games Club
- Jane Austen Society
- Key Club
- Latin Club
- Liturgy Committee
- Media Club
- Mu Alpha Theta
- Music Club
- My Sister's Keeper
- National Honor Society
- Podcast Club
- Praise and Worship Band

- Quiz Bowl
- Science Club
- SJA Ambassadors
- Spanish Club
- **Speech and Debate**
- Stickers for Life
- Student Council
- Student Ministry
- Video Games Club
- Women's Empowerment
- Yoga Club
- Youth & Government

Club Officers

Club elections are held at various times throughout the year. Each club has election guidelines, but all elected club officers must adhere to the following requirements and restrictions:

Requirements:

1. Each nine weeks, the GPA of each officer must meet the club requirement and will be checked by the Dean of Women. Each officer must also maintain a passing grade in each of her subjects each nine weeks.
2. If the officer falls below the grade requirements or is in danger of failing any subject, she is placed on probation. The GPA will be rechecked the following nine weeks, and if the officer meets academic requirements, she may reclaim the office. If the officer does not meet the requirements, she is suspended from office for that school year.
3. If an officer receives consequences for disciplinary infractions, she may be subject to probation or removal from the office or club at the discretion of the administration.

Restrictions:

1. A student may be president/editor of only one co-curricular activity.
2. The president of a school club can also be a state officer in the same club.
3. A student may hold office in a maximum of two co-curricular activities.

Proposing a New Club

Any student may propose a new club by requesting the New Club Proposal Form from the Activities Coordinator. All club proposals will be discussed and decided upon by the administrative team.

STUDENT-ATHLETE NAME, IMAGE AND LIKENESS AGREEMENTS

In this policy, the term "student-athlete" is defined as any person who is enrolled in school at St. Joseph's Academy and participates in a competitive endeavor, whether that be with a sport or team sponsored by St. Joseph's Academy or with an institution that is not partnered or affiliated with St. Joseph's Academy.

In accordance with state law and LHSAA policies, both current and those enacted after the implementation of this policy, St. Joseph's Academy permits student-athletes to engage in Name, Image and Likeness (NIL) agreements under the following parameters:

1. All St. Joseph's Academy student-athletes must disclose and present a copy of any NIL agreement or contract to the Principal of St. Joseph's Academy via the Athletic Director, prior to official engagement by the student-athlete and/or her family. Failure to disclose NIL agreements as prescribed may result in consequences as determined by the St. Joseph's Academy administration.
2. In accordance with Louisiana Law, St. Joseph's Academy, its administration, directors, faculty,

coaches, staff, etc., shall not arrange for, promote or entice specific NIL agreements for its student-athletes, nor shall they provide NIL compensation to any athlete.

3. St. Joseph's Academy may prohibit a student-athlete from engaging in specific NIL agreements if those agreements conflict with the values and principles of St. Joseph's Academy, the Catholic Church and/or the rules and regulations expressed in the St. Joseph's Academy Student Handbook.
4. Student-athletes may not engage in an agreement with, or earn compensation from endorsements for
 - a. Alcohol;
 - b. Tobacco or Nicotine in any form;
 - c. Devices or paraphernalia associated with drug use, including but not limited to e-cigarettes, vape pens or any other type of drug-delivery device;
 - d. Illegal or controlled substances, including banned athletic substances, and prescription medication;
 - e. Cannabis or cannabis-related products, including CBD, hemp and hemp-related products;
 - f. Any form of gambling, including sports wagering;
 - g. Firearms that the student-athlete could not legally purchase;
 - h. Adult entertainment or enterprises;
 - i. Politicians, political messaging or political-based advertisements.

St. Joseph's Academy retains the right to prohibit a student-athlete from engaging in an NIL agreement that promotes or endorses other products not specifically identified above if that product(s) is deemed to conflict with the values of the school or the Catholic Church.

5. St. Joseph's Academy may prohibit a student-athlete from engaging in specific NIL agreements if those agreements, or terms within the agreement, conflict with existing St. Joseph's Academy sponsorship agreements or contracts, including terms within those contracts and agreements, or other school or athletic agreements or contracts, including terms within those contracts and agreements.
6. Student-athletes and the third-party entities with whom they contract shall not authorize, permit or otherwise use St. Joseph's Academy trademarks, logos, clothing, uniforms, equipment or other SJA Intellectual Property in any NIL deals without the expressed, written consent of St. Joseph's Academy.
7. Student-athletes may not use St. Joseph's Academy facilities or property in order to endorse products or enter into NIL agreements without the expressed, written consent of St. Joseph's Academy.
8. Student-athletes may not wear, display or promote a commercial enterprise's brand, insignia, logo, etc., with official St. Joseph's Academy uniforms, practice gear or at St. Joseph's Academy athletic events without the expressed, written consent of St. Joseph's Academy.
9. All student-athletes, whether under NIL contract or not, shall remain bound to the rules and regulations found in the St. Joseph's Academy Student Handbook.
10. St. Joseph's Academy encourages student-athletes who engage or consider engaging in NIL agreements to obtain certified and licensed legal and financial counsel throughout the process. St. Joseph's Academy will not provide these services.
11. St. Joseph's Academy and its employees, coaches, directors, etc., shall not be liable for any damages to a student-athlete's ability to earn compensation for the use of the student-athlete's name, image and likeness, resulting from decisions and actions taken by St. Joseph's Academy in the ordinary course of school operations.

COMMUNICATIONS

Announcements

If you need to get a message to your daughter during the school day, please email her. Students are allowed to check email during unstructured or lunch time. The Attendance Coordinator will only email a student in an emergency. It is the student's responsibility to check her email.

Announcements are made at the beginning of 3rd period and followed up with an Announcements email. Afternoon announcements are made at the end of 8th period. Students must remain in class until all

announcements are complete and they are dismissed.

BrightArrow phone alerts, email notices or text messages to parents will be used to communicate timely information.

Media Policy

Requests from the media for interviews of any student or employee of St. Joseph's Academy must be approved by the Communications Director. Exceptions to this policy will be made in cases such as athletic team coaches/club moderators or student-athletes/club members being interviewed following an athletic/club event. The Communications Director serves as the public spokesperson for St. Joseph's Academy. No other employee or student should speak on behalf of SJA without the consent of the Principal.

Newsletters

A monthly newsletter along with events and other pertinent information is emailed to parents and is posted on the website under the Parents portal. The Connections news magazine is published three times per year and mailed to parents, alumnae and friends.

Promotional Photos/Interviews

Throughout the school year, photographs are taken and videos are made of students for a variety of purposes, including use in St. Joseph's Academy promotional materials (fliers, brochures, invitations, etc.), on the Academy's website, in Academy-produced publications (Connections, Annual Report, Student Prints, The Shield, etc.) and in various SJA and external media outlets, including social media platforms. No remuneration or payment is attached to the use of these photographs or videos.

Additionally, students may be interviewed by the Academy's Communications Department to gather information for stories which are published in or posted on the outlets described above.

On occasion, representatives of the media (print and electronic) are interested in a story relating to the Academy and may wish to interview, photograph or videotape SJA students. SJA makes every reasonable effort to supervise interactions between students and the media.

By submitting the School Handbook acknowledgment form found on MySJA, you grant permission for your daughter's photograph, video image and/or interview answers to be used in and on the above- referenced outlets.

Written objections from parents and/or students to the use of photographs, videos or answers to questions must be received by the Main Office on the students' beginning-of-the-year orientation day.

For more information, contact Communications Director Mindy Averitt at averittm@sjabr.org.

Student Directory

St. Joseph's Academy provides a password-protected online student directory on MySJA. This includes the following information as provided in the registration form: student's name, grade level, parent(s)' names(s), home phone number(s), address(es) and Safe Home participation. Students are expected to use the directory in a responsible and respectful manner.

The names and addresses of juniors and seniors are given to Jostens so this vendor can communicate with students/parents during the summer months. Names and addresses of all students are given to Kleinpeter Photography so this vendor can provide information about school pictures. If you do not wish this information to be given to these vendors, contact Principal Stacia Andricain at andricains@sjabr.org.

Deliveries to Students

During the school day, students will not be allowed to accept deliveries of food brought in from outside vendors, parents, friends or relatives.

Every effort is made to see that students receive needed school items delivered to them during the school day. SJA, however, will not accept deliveries of flowers or gifts. Visitors will be asked to drop off items at the door, and a member of the Main Office staff will retrieve them.

DINING HALL

SJA partners with SAGE Dining Services to provide nutritious and delicious meals for our students. SAGE cooks from scratch and maximizes its use of raw and minimally processed ingredients. Food is prepared using a variety of techniques, including grilling, baking, broiling, sautéing and frying, to create balanced meals and offer students a wide range of options. SAGE uses fresh fruits and vegetables and offers breakfast daily. A meatless entrée is offered daily, along with a full salad bar featuring fresh ingredients and customizable selections. Food is prepared using fresh herbs and spices, reducing the use of salt.

Daily offerings include hot entrées, made-from-scratch soups, grilled sandwiches, traditional Louisiana favorites, fresh-baked goods and customizable options featuring cuisines from around the world. SAGE also provides resources to help students make informed nutritional choices and build positive dining habits. Parents can fund their child's dining hall account through Lunchtab. SJA manages account funding and payment collection directly. Dining hall balances are expected to remain in positive standing and shouldn't be used as a credit system. Students can check their balances at the cashier stations in the dining hall. This information is also accessible through their Lunchtab account. We encourage parents to have conversations with their children about appropriate spending and responsible habits.

If a student's account is at a negative dollar amount, an email from the Dean of Women's office will be sent to the student and a parent. After two consecutive weeks with a negative balance and/or continued spending on a negative balance, the student's dining account will be frozen, and no further purchases can be made until the balance has been paid in full.

Seniors must have a positive or zero balance before final exams. Remaining balances of less than \$10 on senior accounts will automatically be donated to the meal assistance fund after graduation.

Students who have a negative balance in their dining hall account won't be permitted to take their midterm or final exams.

EMERGENCY PROCEDURES

In case of a general emergency in which school is called off due to dangerous weather or other circumstances, SJA will follow the directives for East Baton Rouge Parish public schools and the Diocese of Baton Rouge.

Students and their parents will be notified of emergency school closures via a phone messaging system, email or text. Messages will be sent automatically to either the student's phone number, the parents' home number(s), the parents' cell phone number(s) and/or the parents' work number(s). When school is closed, any after-school activities and meetings are cancelled unless otherwise communicated.

SJA will also notify media outlets of school closures. Since SJA will comply with the directives of the EBR public schools and the Diocese, there should be no need to call the school for further information in such situations. Students will receive additional information via email from the administration or their teachers.

Emergency drills are practiced with students, faculty and staff throughout the year. All information regarding safety procedures has been posted in each room on campus.

SCHOOL SAFETY PLAN

A security officer is present on campus each school day from 6:30 a.m. until 5:30 p.m.

The St. Joseph's Academy safety policies and Emergency Action Plan are available upon request. Please contact Principal Stacia Andricain at andricains@sjabr.org or (225) 388-2240 or Assistant Dean of Women Brianna Sommers at sommersb@sjabr.org.

FINANCIAL INFORMATION

Guidelines for Money-Raising Activities

The Administration prefers to keep fundraising projects to a minimum. In order to regulate the number and type of fundraising projects, the following guidelines are established for all classes, clubs or other groups in the school:

1. No class, individual or organization is to initiate any money-raising activity or request money from other classes, students, faculty/staff, clubs or organizations without the permission of the Principal. This includes GoFundMe requests.
2. Requests to raise money must be submitted in writing prior to the quarter during which funds will be collected. The request should state the goal and procedure for raising the funds.
3. Projects that are of charitable or educational value will be given first consideration.
4. Students may not sell tickets, raffles, foodstuffs or other items for outside organizations during the school day.

SchoolCash Online

SJA uses SchoolCash Online for online payment of all fees and other school-related costs. Students will not be permitted to take midterm or final exams if all fees have not been paid.

Textbook and Book Fees

Students are expected to handle all books with care and return them in prime condition. A lost or damaged book must be paid for before another book will be issued. Should a student leave during the term, it is her responsibility to return all loaned books to the Dean of Curriculum and Instruction. If a student does not return a textbook, a fee will be assessed, and payment will be due at the end of the school year. Certain courses, including AP, require students to purchase their own textbook.

Tuition

Tuition, fees and registration costs are set each year by the Board of Directors and communicated at the time of registration. SJA utilizes Blackbaud Tuition Management for the processing and collection of registration fees and tuition. Through the online registration process, you will set up your personal Blackbaud Tuition Management account and choose your preferred payment plan and payment method. Blackbaud Tuition Management provides the option to set up recurring automatic payments from your bank or on your credit card.

Tuition for the 2026-2027 academic year is \$13,984. The annual registration fee is \$575, and there is a one-time senior fee of \$575.

Tuition and other fees for 2027-2028 will be published in February 2027.

Students who have unpaid fees or tuition will not be permitted to take semester examinations. Students with an outstanding tuition balance may not register for the following academic year. Click here for the Tuition Policy.

In keeping with the vision of the Sisters of St. Joseph, no student has ever been denied admission solely on the basis of her family's ability to pay full tuition. The philosophy of SJA's tuition assistance program is that an Academy education be available to all young ladies who wish to attend and have the academic ability and

motivation to succeed.

Families applying for tuition assistance must do so annually, since family circumstances can change and the amount available for tuition assistance changes every year. The application is completed through Blackbaud Financial Aid Management. This secure, online service streamlines the data-collection process and ensures that financial aid is granted to those families who are most in need. Blackbaud Financial Aid Management will collect and compile the data and make recommendations based upon factors specific to the local economy; however, the SJA Tuition Assistance Committee will make all final decisions regarding financial aid.

Instructions for applying for tuition assistance will be provided via email. There is a \$35 Smart Aid application fee.

For additional information about tuition assistance, please contact Amy Jackson in the Finance Office at jacksona@sjabr.org or (225) 388-2234.

FOOD/DRINK

Students may eat daily in the Dining Hall or Fife Student Commons or they may bring their lunch. At no time can a student have food brought to her or delivered to campus from an outside source/vendor. If a student forgets her lunch, she can purchase lunch in the Dining Hall.

Students are allowed water only in the classroom and Technology and Learning Center as long as it is in a seal-top container. Students may not bring any food purchased from the dining hall into the classroom buildings for any reason. No food or other drinks (coffee, smoothies, sports drinks and other beverages) are allowed at any time in any school building except the Dining Hall and Fife Student Commons. If found inside a building, food will be confiscated and thrown away. Chewing gum is not allowed on the SJA campus or at any time in any school building.

HEADPHONE POLICY

Students should remove earbuds or any type of headphone when entering a classroom and should keep them off unless the teacher instructs them otherwise. Students should not bring or wear headphones or earbuds to a school assembly. For safety and respect, students should remove headphones and earbuds while traveling between areas of campus and class periods.

ST. JOSEPH'S ACADEMY HONOR PLEDGE

In keeping with the mission statement of St. Joseph's Academy and the philosophy of the Sisters of St. Joseph, calling all to oneness with God and community, SJA has established an Honor Pledge. The measure of a St. Joseph's Academy young woman is her adherence to the Honor Pledge. The pledge defines the SJA student as guided by honesty, honor and personal integrity in all matters pertaining to her life as a member of the Academy community.

St. Joseph's Academy Honor Pledge

The mission of St. Joseph's Academy is to educate young women as responsible and unifying members of the world community in the spirit and charism of the Sisters of St. Joseph. Therefore, I commit to

- Respect myself and all members of the Academy community.
- Respect the property of others and be a responsible steward of the earth's resources.
- Submit only work that is my own and give proper credit when using the words, ideas or efforts of another. Refer to the Academic Integrity Policy for more information.

All students are expected to act in a Christian manner at all times. The charism of our Sisters teaches us to strive so that all may be one. Students should strive to treat others as Christ would and remember they are representatives at SJA at all times.

Students are expected to abide by the policies and procedures outlined in this handbook and to assume responsibility for their actions at all times. Students are expected to be prepared for class and to hand in materials requested on time.

ST. JOSEPH'S ACADEMY CODE OF ETHICS FOR STUDENTS

As a young woman of St. Joseph's Academy, each student is called to live a life of sanctity, joy and action, reflecting the Gospel and the values of our Catholic faith in all aspects of her conduct. By embracing a code of ethics as SJA Redstickers, our school community thrives on unity, respect and a shared commitment to the dignity of every person.

All students are expected to

- Demonstrate integrity and honesty in words and actions.
- Treat classmates, faculty, staff and community members with compassion, dignity and respect.
- Cultivate a spirit of sisterhood, inclusivity and leadership.
- Uphold appropriate boundaries in all interpersonal interactions.
- Reject behaviors that cause harm or division in our community.

As members of a faith-based, all-girls learning community, students at St. Joseph's Academy are responsible for maintaining a safe, respectful environment for all. The following behaviors are strictly prohibited and subject to disciplinary action, including suspension or dismissal.

Inappropriate Conduct

- Violation of the school's Public Display of Affection (PDA) policy
- Any form of unwanted physical contact, including fondling, rubbing, petting or other inappropriate touching
- Derogatory or discriminatory language, including but not limited to racial, ethnic or identity-based slurs
- directed at any member of the community
- Any behavior falling under the school's Harassment, Hazing or Bullying policies

HARASSMENT/HAZING/BULLYING

St. Joseph's Academy emphasizes to all students, faculty and staff members that harassment (including sexual harassment) is prohibited behavior and will not be condoned or tolerated. This includes student-to- student, student-to-faculty/staff (and vice versa) and faculty/staff-to-faculty/staff.

All students of the Academy must be treated with respect and in a Christian manner. This prohibition against acts of harassment applies to all people engaged in all school-related activities: all students, regular and temporary, part-time or full-time employees, substitutes, volunteers, itinerant instructors and consultants. It also applies equally to clergy, religious and laypersons.

Physical Harassment: Physical harassment includes unwarranted physical touching, contact, assault, deliberate impeding or blocking movements or any intimidating interference with normal school or work movements.

Sexual Harassment: Sexual harassment can include sexual advances, requests for sexual favors or any other verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature. This behavior includes unsolicited written or verbal statements, vulgar or obscene photographs, drawings, jokes or comments, gestures or physical contact of a sexual nature.

Verbal Harassment: Verbal harassment can include derogatory remarks, jokes or slurs and belligerent or threatening words spoken to another.

Written or Electronic Communication Harassment: This includes communication of any threat of or act of sexual, verbal, physical harassment or derogatory remarks of any kind, as well as repeated threads/messages sent after communication has been asked to cease. Any student, faculty or staff member who believes this policy is being violated should report this immediately to a member of the administrative team or the president of the Academy.

Hazing: Hazing is the intentional, knowing or reckless act by a person when 1) the person knew or should have known that the act endangers the physical health or safety of the other person or causes severe emotional distress; and 2) the act was associated with being initiated into, affiliating with, participating in or membership in any SJA student organization. Hazing includes physical activity or activity involving the consumption of foods or substances that subjects a person to an unreasonable risk of harm, adversely affects the physical health or safety of the individual or causes severe emotional distress. Hazing is contrary to the charism of the Sisters of St. Joseph, is a criminal act under Louisiana law and forbidden at SJA.

Any person who believes hazing has occurred in association with any SJA student organization is strongly encouraged to report the alleged hazing to SJA administrators. All allegations of hazing will be investigated by administrators. If there is sufficient information to determine that hazing has occurred, SJA will report the hazing to law enforcement as required by Louisiana law. Any student determined to have engaged in hazing shall be, at a minimum, suspended from SJA and potentially expelled permanently.

Bullying: Bullying behavior is the repeated harassment and targeting of another person or group of persons with the intent to cause emotional, physical or psychological harm.

Any student, faculty or staff member who believes this policy is being violated should report the same immediately to a member of the Administrative Team or the President of the Academy.

Weapons: No student or teacher is permitted to possess any type of weapon while on the school grounds or at any school-related function. A weapon is defined as any instrument that is used or may be used to cause grave bodily harm. Anyone violating this regulation is subject to dismissal.

INCLUSION

Inclusion is an on-going process to increase access and engagement in learning for all students by identifying and removing barriers in a culture of collaboration, respect and support.

SJA is committed to supporting the needs of our student population. We value diversity and respect individual learning differences, working with each individual student.

INSURANCE

SJA carries student accident insurance through Scholastic Insurance. All students are automatically covered, so there is no need to enroll.

Coverage limit is \$25,000 per injury from the first day of school until the last day of school. The policy pays 80 percent of the reasonable and customary expenses incurred for necessary medical, dental or hospital care (within 104 weeks for Accidental Dental expenses) up to a maximum of \$25,000 for any one injury, subject to the deductible amount, excess provision and exclusions.

Expenses incurred after one year from the date of injury are not covered.

This insurance is provided to fill in the gaps that may exist in other insurance programs and to provide coverage where no other insurance exists. When an accident occurs, therefore, the bills for any necessary medical care must first be submitted to any other applicable insurance company, medical service plan or pre-payment program. Any unpaid balance should be submitted, along with a copy of the other company's

explanation of benefits, for processing under this insurance.

All enrolled students of the school are covered while participating in supervised and sponsored activities, including interscholastic sports, field trips and travel to and from school. Base Accident Coverage extends to all enrolled and non-enrolled students while participating in summer camps as well as volunteer workers of the policy holder.

Please note that virtual insurance coverage extends to students participating in a school-sponsored class or activity whether at school or elsewhere.

For more information or to obtain a claim form for submission, please contact Director of Operations Linda Thompson at thompsonl@sjabr.org.

LOCKERS

Any student who would like to use an SJA locker should contact the Dean of Women. **Lockers available for student use are located on the second floor of St. Joseph Hall.**

Students will have use of a locker to store personal items during physical education classes. Instructions on P.E. locker use will be given on the first day of school by the P.E. teacher. These lockers will be shared with other students. Only locks issued by SJA, not personal locks, can be used.

LOST AND FOUND

Found articles should be brought to the lost and found in St. Joseph Hall room 113, in front of the Dean of Women's office. Valuables such as jewelry and cash are to be turned into the Attendance Coordinator in the main office and may be claimed there. After nine weeks, articles unclaimed are donated to the needy.

MARRIAGE/PREGNANCY

A student who marries is not allowed to remain at St. Joseph's Academy. SJA follows the Diocesan policy regarding pregnant students.

MEDICATION/HEALTH

Students with any medical injury who need accommodations for transitions between classes, elevator use and/or dismissal accommodations must meet with the Dean of Women and the School Nurse. Accommodations are approved by the Dean of Women based on a student's specific needs and documentation.

School Nurse

A nurse is on campus from 7 a.m. until 3 p.m. When the nurse is not on campus, students should report to the Attendance Coordinator.

Health Form

St. Joseph's Academy must have a new, completed Health Information Form on file for every student at the beginning of each school year. This form is completed and submitted electronically on MySJA. Click the yellow banner at the top of the sign-on screen **in the MySJA Parent Portal.**

Medication

Students may not have medications of any kind, prescription or over-the-counter, in their possession while at school. The only exceptions are insulin, EpiPens and rescue inhalers with proper paperwork on file in the nurse's office.

All medications, including over-the-counter (OTC) medications, given by our school nurse must be prescribed by the student's personal provider.

A Prescription and Over-the-Counter Medication Form found on MySJA must be completed by the student's healthcare provider, signed by a parent and turned into the school nurse before any medication can be administered or carried by a student. **Part 1 must be completed and signed by a parent, and Part 2 must be completed and signed by the student's healthcare provider. Part 3, if applicable, must also be filled out and signed by the provider.** A new form is required each school year.

Without a completed and current Prescription and Over-the-Counter Medication Form on file, the SJA nurse will not be able to administer medications for headaches, menstrual cramps, bug bites or orthodontia discomfort, etc. If the nurse is unable to treat a student complaint due to the lack of an appropriate medical order form, and the student is unable to return to class and participate, her parent or legal guardian will be called to make arrangements to either bring and administer the medication or pick the student up from school.

All prescription medications must be delivered to the school nurse in their original container by the student's parent or legal guardian. The prescription label must reflect exactly what is on the Prescription and Over-the-Counter Medication Order Form.

Approved Carried Medications (Insulin, EpiPens, Rescue Inhalers): For your daughter's safety, in addition to a current Prescription and Over-the-Counter Medication Form, a care plan, specific to her needs, must be completed by her doctor. Parents will need to schedule an appointment with the school nurse within one week of the start of each new school year to review the plan.

In case of an emergency, the school has a supply of EpiPens on campus through the EpiPens4School Program. This does not replace the need for a student to provide or carry an EpiPen if that has been prescribed.

Sedating/Pain Medications: If a student is administered any narcotic pain medication, antianxiety medication or Benadryl (for allergic reaction) at any time during school hours, that student will not be permitted to drive from that point on during the school day. At the time the medication is administered, if the student is of driving age, a parent will be notified and the student must give their car keys to the person administering the medication for safe keeping. The student will need to be picked up by a parent at the end of the day; keys will be given to the parent at that time.

Medical Conditions

For the health and well-being of our students, faculty and staff, please adhere to the following guidelines. If you think your daughter has a contagious illness, please keep her home.

Fever: A student should not attend school unless she is fever-free (less than 100.4 degrees) for 24 hours without the use of fever-reducing medication.

Strep Throat: If a student is diagnosed with strep throat, she must be on the prescribed medication for a minimum of 24 hours before returning to school. She must also follow the fever guidelines above.

Nausea/Vomiting/Diarrhea: Students need to be free from nausea, vomiting and diarrhea for 24 hours before returning to school after an illness.

Pink Eye/Conjunctivitis: The signs and symptoms of pink eye include redness, itchiness, a gritty feeling, discharge that forms a crust overnight and/or tearing. If a student wakes up with any of these symptoms, she needs to be checked by a doctor. If a student reports to the nurse's office with any of these symptoms, she will be sent home and must be cleared by a doctor to return to school. If a student is diagnosed with bacterial pink eye, she must be on the prescribed medication for a minimum of 24 hours before returning to school. Per the Mayo Clinic, "pink eye can be highly contagious for as long as two weeks after signs and symptoms begin. Early diagnosis and treatment can protect people around you from getting pink eye, too."

Lice: Per guidelines established by the Centers for Disease Control, students diagnosed with live head lice do not need to be sent home early from school; rather, they can go home at the end of the day, be treated and return to class after appropriate treatment has begun. Nits may persist after treatment, but successful treatment should kill crawling lice.

Both the American Academy of Pediatrics and the National Association of School Nurses advocate that “no nit” policies should be discontinued. Both groups say no-nit policies that require students to be free of nits before they can return to school should be discontinued for the following reasons: Many nits are more than ¼-inch from the scalp. Such nits are usually not viable and very unlikely to hatch to become crawling lice or may in fact be empty shells, also known as casings. Nits are cemented to hair shafts and are very unlikely to be transferred successfully to other people.

Concussion: A concussion is a form of traumatic brain injury caused by a bump, blow or jolt to the head causing the brain to move rapidly back and forth within the head.

Suspected Concussion at School, Clinical Evaluation Procedures:

A. Initial Assessment

For our students’ safety, if a student complains of concussion symptoms after a bump to the head or exhibits signs or behaviors consistent with a concussion (including but not limited to loss of consciousness, headache, dizziness, confusion or balance problems, she will be sent to the School Nurse or Athletic Trainer for further assessment.

B. Concussion Assessment Tool

SJA uses the CDC’s Concussion Signs and Symptoms Checklist to determine whether a student needs further assessment by an appropriate healthcare professional. A student will be monitored for a minimum of 30 minutes. She will be checked for symptoms when the injury first occurs, at 15 minutes, then at 30 minutes.

C. Contacting a Parent

If a concussion is suspected, a parent will be contacted to make arrangements to pick the student up for further evaluation by an appropriate healthcare professional (physician, physician’s assistant or nurse practitioner). Note: Evaluation by a physician is required for student-athletes per the LHSAA rules.

No student will be allowed to drive if a concussion is suspected.

D. Return to School

With a concussion, physical and cognitive activities such as concentration and learning can be difficult and should be managed by a qualified healthcare professional. A doctor’s note will be required for a student to return to school, regardless of diagnosis.

E. Required Documentation for Return

1. If there is no concussion, the student must provide a doctor’s note stating that she does not have a concussion and has been cleared to return to school.
2. If diagnosed with a concussion, the student must provide a doctor’s note stating that she has been diagnosed with a concussion, the date when she is cleared to return to school **and any accommodations needed.**

Note: If your daughter is an athlete, please see the athletic section of the handbook regarding “Return to Play” following a concussion.

F. Accommodations at School

With a concussion, physical and cognitive activities such as concentration and learning can be difficult. Students who return to school after a concussion may need to

1. Spend fewer hours at school, possibly starting with half-days
2. Take rest breaks as needed
3. Be given more time to take tests or complete assignments
4. Receive help with schoolwork
5. Reduce time spent on the computer, reading or writing

G. Support for Student; Reporting Requirements

1. Academic Team

SJA has an academic support team that consists of the School Nurse, the student's grade-level Counselor, the Athletic Trainer (for student-athletes), school administrators and the student's teachers.

2. Parental and Student Involvement

In addition to the academic support team, the parents and student are an integral part of the student's recovery.

- a. Parents: After the initial screening appointment with the student's healthcare provider, the parent must notify the School Nurse (by phone or email) of the diagnosis. This will help the Nurse communicate with the academic support team in a timely manner to keep them informed of the student's health needs and progress. The parent must communicate daily with the Attendance Coordinator until the student returns to full days at school.
- b. Student: Once back at school, the student must check in at the start of each day with the School Nurse until she no longer has post-concussion symptoms. The Nurse will update the academic support team to keep them informed of her progress and continued health needs.

Once a doctor's note is provided giving medical clearance for a student to return to school, the following short-term accommodations may be needed to assist in the transition back to schoolwork and activities.

- Half-days when initially returning to school (must be scheduled with the student's grade-level counselor)
- Parent must communicate daily with the Attendance Coordinator
- No physical education or dance classes until symptoms are resolved
- No after-school sports until cleared by the doctor and Athletic Trainer (per LHSA "Return-to-Play" protocol)
- Reduce the amount of homework and class assignments
- Postpone classroom tests and/or standardized testing
- Provide extended time to complete schoolwork, homework or test-taking
- Provide written notes for school lessons and assignments (when possible)
- Allow for a quiet place to take breaks throughout the day
- Decrease screen time on the computer and other electronic devices
- Allow the student to wear sunglasses if light-sensitive
- Allow the student to use earplugs or headphones if bothered by noise

Notes:

1. The Academic Team will assist the student in determining any needed accommodations on an individual basis.
2. The parent must communicate daily with the Attendance Coordinator until the student returns to full days at school.
3. During class, if at any time the student has returning or worsening symptoms, she will need to take a break from the causative activity. If no improvement is shown, she must be sent to the Nurse's office.

4. Once able to resume all work, if needed, a student can meet with her grade-level Counselor to help her catch up on missed schoolwork, homework and tests. The Counselor will notify her teachers regarding any academic needs and progress towards make-up work, if needed.

EpiPens

In case of an emergency, the school has a supply of EpiPens on campus through the EpiPens4School Program. This does not replace the need for a student to provide or carry an EpiPen if that has been prescribed.

Naloxone

SJA has a supply of the lifesaving opioid-reversal agent Naloxone (generic for Narcan) in the event that an opioid overdose occurs in the school setting.

Immunization Requirements

All students are required by law to present evidence of age-appropriate immunizations against preventable communicable diseases. If SJA does not receive a copy of a student's up-to-date, signed State of Louisiana Universal Certificate of Immunizations by the registration deadline or by the due date for rising juniors, the school nurse will contact her parents to request a copy, which must be returned immediately in order for the student to remain in school.

Note: Students can participate in school without the required immunizations listed below if either of the following are presented at the beginning of each school year: 1) a written statement from a physician stating that the procedure is contraindicated for medical reasons; or 2) written dissent from the parent/guardian.

Required immunizations per the state of Louisiana:

1. Diphtheria Tetanus Acellular Pertussis vaccine (DTaP): 5 doses in student record at kindergarten entry and for entry into all subsequent grades thereafter (Those students who received their fourth dose of DTaP at age four or older do not need a fifth dose on record.)
2. Poliovirus vaccine (IPV): 4 doses in student record at kindergarten entry and for entry into all subsequent grades thereafter (Those students who received their third dose of IPV at age 4 or older do not need a fourth dose on record.)
3. Measles, Mumps, Rubella vaccine (MMR): 2 doses in student record at kindergarten entry and for entry into all subsequent grades thereafter
4. Hepatitis B vaccine (HepB): 3 doses in student record at kindergarten entry and for entry into all subsequent grades thereafter
5. Varicella vaccine (VAR): 2 doses in student record at kindergarten entry and for entry into all subsequent grades thereafter
6. Tetanus Diphtheria Acellular Pertussis vaccine (Tdap): 1 dose in student record at 6th grade entry and for entry into all subsequent grades thereafter; or starting with any student 11 years of age in any grade
7. Meningococcal vaccine (MenACWY): 1 dose in student record at 6th grade entry and for entry into all subsequent grades thereafter, through the 10th grade; or starting with any student 11 years of age in any grade; 2 doses are required in the student record once she is 16 years of age and in the 11th grade.
8. Hepatitis A vaccine (Hep A): 2 dose series (minimum interval 6 months) normally given between the ages of 12 and 23 months.

OFF-CAMPUS ACTIVITIES

Before a student may participate in an off-campus, school-sponsored activity, she must return a completed permission slip to the faculty member in charge of the activity. Failure to return the form will result in the student's forfeiture of her participation in the event. Off-Campus Activity Forms will be handed out by the coach or moderator in charge of the activity. The administration has the right to remove a student from any school travel event at any time without a refund.

Field trips and other school-sponsored events are earned. A student's attendance and discipline record may be

taken into account when permitting her to participate in the off-campus event.

PUBLIC DISPLAYS OF AFFECTION POLICY

St. Joseph's Academy students are expected to maintain high standards of conduct and respect while living out the mission of the school and the charism of the Sisters of St. Joseph. Behavior of an SJA student should be consistent with a school environment focused on relationship with God and neighbor; academics; and respect for each other's thoughts and feelings.

SJA students must refrain from public displays of affection between fellow SJA students and with Catholic High School students. This policy is expected to be upheld while in school, on school grounds or when attending or participating in any school-related activity or function. Inappropriate PDA in any school setting includes but is not limited to intimate or prolonged embracing, sharing a private space such as a restroom stall, handholding, kissing, continual or inappropriate touching, sitting on another's lap or intimate behaviors.

A student who violates this policy will be included in a conversation with her counselor and will receive a disciplinary infraction. If either the counselor or an administrator deems that it is necessary, a parent will be included in a conversation.

Public displays of affection will be addressed promptly by a member of the school staff. Students should not video or take a picture of another student engaged in a public display of affection. This action, as well as posting or sharing a video or picture in any manner, will result in disciplinary action.

PARENT ORGANIZATIONS

Dads' Club

The SJA Dads' Club provides service to the school and social opportunities for fathers and daughters. Membership includes current SJA dads, grandfathers, fathers of alumnae and friends of SJA who have paid the annual dues. Service opportunities include cooking for the Habitat for Humanity Youth Build, Sticker Spectacular and assistance at school events.

Father/Daughter Day is the highlight of the Dads' Club social calendar. The Dads' Club also co-hosts the Sticker Scramble golf tournament and the Parents' Back-to-School Dance.

For more information, contact Dads' Club Moderator Meg Gerald at geraldm@sjabr.org.

Mothers' Club

The SJA Mothers' Club plays an active and vital role in the support services of the school. It sponsors a number of annual activities, including luncheons, receptions, retreats and prayer groups. In addition, the club provides other services, such as appreciation days for students and faculty/staff. The Mothers' Club also runs the Sticker Shop and hosts the Mother-Daughter Brunch & Style Show each spring.

Members must have a daughter currently enrolled in the school and pay annual dues. For more information, contact Mothers' Club Moderator Jade Spears at spearsj@sjabr.org.

PARKING AND TRANSPORTATION

Parking is a privilege reserved for seniors, juniors and sophomores. Seniors, juniors and sophomores must have a valid driver's license (not a learner's permit) to register a vehicle and purchase a parking spot. A spot cannot sit empty. If a student will not have a car to drive, she must wait until she has a car before purchasing a spot.

Anyone not assigned a spot must find alternate transportation. Freshmen are not allowed to drive to school. We ask parents of freshmen and sophomores without a driver's license to make carpool or other transportation arrangements.

We have a security guard on campus and in our parking lots between the hours of 6:30 a.m. and 5:30 p.m. each school day.

Sophomores, juniors and seniors are entered into a lottery for parking spots. They must purchase a parking spot through SchoolCash Online and complete the corresponding form. After the spot is purchased and assigned, students should pick up their parking tags from Mrs. Amanda Stinson in the Main Office. If purchased during the fall semester, parking lot spots are \$324.75 (a onetime fee) and valid for the entire school year. If purchased in the spring semester, parking lot spots are \$162.50 and valid for the remainder of the school year.

Street parking spots are \$108.50 and sold on a first-come, first-served basis. There are only 50 spots available for street parking. Students will be assigned a specific zone of street parking for the year. For safety reasons, our goal is to have as few students parking on the street as possible.

All students who are assigned an SJA parking spot will be issued a hanging parking tag which must always be visible in their vehicle. It is the student's responsibility to move her hanging tag if she drives an alternate vehicle to school on a given day. Students are to park in their assigned spot, which corresponds with their hanging tag, and not park in another area. If a student loses her parking tag, a replacement tag, requested from the Dean of Women, will be available for a fee.

Students are reminded that driving a vehicle on campus is a privilege. All students should adhere to rules of safety and courtesy at all times. Students are expected to adhere to posted speed limits and not exceed 5 miles per hour in the parking lots. Students' arrival and departure should be orderly and cautious. At dismissal, all students are expected to walk, not run, to their vehicles.

During arrival and dismissal times, one-way signs routing traffic in parking lots must be observed, or disciplinary action may be taken. Students should use the designated crosswalks to enter and exit campus. Student drivers and those using the carpool lanes are asked to be mindful and pay attention to pedestrians.

If a student has permission from a homeowner to park in front of their property, she must follow all city ordinances. SJA has the right to ask a student to park at a different location if an issue arises. Penalties for violating parking rules include an infraction and may lead to loss of parking privileges.

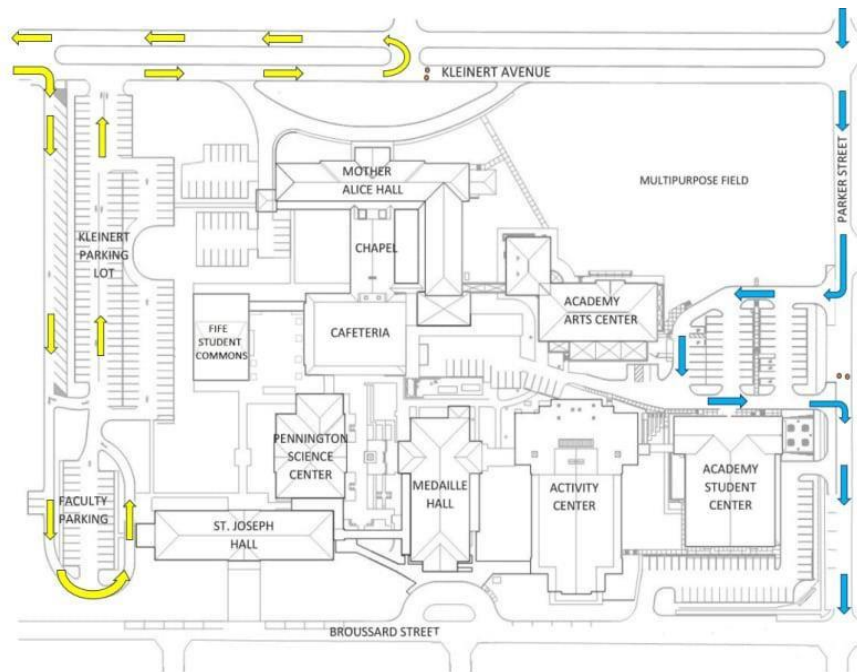
Neighborhood Parking Guidelines

If your daughter chooses to park off campus, the school assumes no liability for the car or her safety. Students must have permission from the homeowner to park in front of his/her home. Students should not block driveways.

DROP-OFF/PICK-UP BY CAR

Anyone bringing a student to school or picking her up after school must use the driveway to the west of St. Joseph Hall entered from Kleinert Avenue (9th grade) or the carpool lane of the Academy Student Center (10th and 11th grades). They must follow the directional flow of traffic as indicated on the map on the following page.

Parents should not park in an SJA parking or visitor spot to wait for their daughter. They should use one of the designated carpool lanes. Any student who is discovered being dropped off or picked up on Broussard Street, Kleinert Avenue or the faculty lot or from the parking lots of neighboring businesses will receive an infraction.



Parents who do not absolutely have to pick up their daughters at the final bell are encouraged to wait until after 3 p.m. to do so. This allows time for the lots to empty and helps relieve the bottleneck at the end of the day. Students may be picked up from the Academy Student Center or Kleinert carpool line after 3 p.m. After 3:30 p.m., students should be picked up from one of our after-school locations (Technology and Learning Center or Fife Student Commons).

After school hours (3:30 p.m. or later), students without adult supervision must wait in the Technology and Learning Center or Fife Student Commons until their ride arrives. For safety reasons, students may not be picked up on Broussard Street or Kleinert Avenue. Parents are asked not to drop off or pick up students from the Mother Alice Hall driveway or the Medaille Hall circle drive.

WHERE TO PARK

Assigned parking spots are in these five lots: Synagogue, Kleinert, Broussard Annex, Mother Thollot House and Academy Student Center. Drivers assigned to street spots may park in the designated areas on Kleinert Avenue or Parker Street. Under no circumstances are students to park on Broussard Street, in the visitor parking in front of Mother Alice Hall or any of the neutral-ground areas near the school premises. Handicapped parking is in front of Medaille Hall on Broussard Street, in the Kleinert parking lot and in the Academy Student Center parking lot. Visitors are asked to park along Broussard Street or Kleinert Avenue in the designated visitor parking areas. At no time should a visitor park in the Tyler and Possa parking lot. If a student has a medical need which would necessitate an alternative parking arrangement, she should reach out to Dean of Women Christina Richardson at richardsonc@sjabr.org.

LEAVING CAMPUS

Students are expected to remain within the gates on campus throughout the school day. If a student needs to retrieve something from her vehicle in the case of emergency **and parks on the SJA campus**, she must first report to the Dean of Women's office or the Main Office for an escort. If not deemed an emergency or if an adult escort is not available, the student will not be permitted to go to her car.

Leaving campus without adult permission or supervision is a Category III Infraction.

Students are not permitted to leave campus after school and return to sign into the after-school locations (Fife Student Commons/Technology and Learning Center).

TRANSPORTATION TO OFF-CAMPUS, SCHOOL-SPONSORED EVENTS

Depending on the nature of the event and its location, SJA may or may not provide transportation for students to attend off-campus, school-sponsored events. In those situations where SJA does not provide transportation, SJA requests that transportation be provided by the parents or guardians of the students to locations in excess of 30 miles from the SJA campus. Because students are inexperienced drivers, safety is a concern. Therefore, SJA strongly recommends that students not drive to an event that is more than 30 miles from SJA.

PERMANENT RECORDS

A record of each student's courses, grades and attendance is kept as part of permanent office files. These records are used for reference in recommendations requested by universities or prospective employers.

Unofficial copies of test scores and transcripts can be downloaded at any time by a parent or student through MySJA. A student wishing to obtain an official copy of her transcript should make this request here. The school needs one full work day to process requests for official transcripts. Students who are minors must have a parent's signature for release of transcripts. There is no charge for copies of transcripts. The school must mail official academic transcripts directly to the university or employer requesting the information. All other records are unofficial.

St. Joseph's Academy will use what appears on the student's birth certificate as her legal name on all documents.

St. Joseph's Academy abides by the provisions of the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA) with respect to the rights of parents and, in the event of divorce, the rights of custodial and noncustodial parents. In the latter case, absent a court order to the contrary, the school will provide the noncustodial parent access to academic records and to other school-related information regarding the student. If there is a court order specifying that no information is to be given, it is the responsibility of the custodial parent to provide the school with a copy of the court order.

St. Joseph's Academy abides by FERPA provisions dealing with confidentiality of students' grade records.

SCHOOL UNIFORM POLICY

All final decisions pertaining to the SJA uniform policy, including accessories, hair color, jewelry and makeup, are made by the Dean of Women.

SJA uniform vendors:

Young Fashions

11111 Coursey Boulevard

School Time

7745 Jefferson Highway

Inka's Uniforms

11626 Sherwood Forest Court

All articles of clothing should be securely labeled for identification purposes.

Dress Uniforms

The dress uniform is to be worn on all mass days and at designated school assembly days. (Items 2-5 must be purchased from the above uniform vendors)

- 1. SCHOOL-ISSUED ID:** Students are required to wear their school ID on the issued lanyard at all times during the school day. IDs must be worn on the outside of the uniform and be visible at all times. No stickers are allowed, and any pins on their lanyard should be of a positive nature and align with the

teachings of the Catholic church.

2. SKIRT: Plaid uniform skirt length should be no shorter than **three** inches from the top of the knee. Students wearing skirts that are deemed to be too short will be asked to purchase a new one or have the hem taken out in a timely manner. Uniform skirts cannot be rolled at the waist. To check for appropriate length, the gap between the student's knee and the hem of her skirt must not be greater than three inches. Use the length of the student ID to measure. **Students are required to wear shorts and/or leggings (non-flare) under skirts at all times.**
3. BLOUSE (BUTTON DOWN): Plain white oxford button down with long or short sleeves and school emblem on the collar will be required for all dress uniform days. T-shirts worn underneath must be solid white. P.E. t-shirts cannot be worn underneath. Blouses and undershirts must be tucked into uniform bottoms at all times.
4. SWEATER: Students can choose from a variety of approved red sweaters: the traditional v-neck, the v-neck vest or cardigan that can be purchased from any of the three uniform vendors and worn on any school day and on dress uniform days. Only red sweaters are allowed on dress uniform days. Uniform shirts must be worn underneath sweaters during school hours.
5. TIGHTS: Navy or black tights/leggings can be worn on cold days with or without uniform socks. Mid-calf leggings and flare yoga-type pants are not allowed.
6. SOCKS: White ankle, crew or no-show socks with or without the SJA logo are to be worn. No colored socks are allowed.
7. SHOES: Light brown Sperry/generic-brand topsiders must be worn with uniform socks or tights for all dress uniform days. Shoes must be properly worn at all times.
8. REMINDER: Shorts, pants, sweatpants, navy sweaters or sweatshirts and tennis shoes can never be worn on dress uniform days.

Regular Uniform Options

Any item of the dress uniform can be worn on any school day. The following are other optional garments that may be worn on non-dress uniform days. Items 2-6 and 8 must be purchased from the above uniform vendors.

1. SCHOOL-ISSUED ID: Students are required to wear their school ID on the issued lanyard at all times during the school day. IDs must be worn on the outside of the uniform and be visible at all times. No stickers allowed, **and any pins on their lanyard should be of a positive nature and align with the teachings of the Catholic church.** IDs are available for purchase on SchoolCash Online if forgotten.
2. SKIRT: Plaid uniform skirt length should be no shorter than **three** inches from the top of the knee. Students wearing skirts that are deemed to be too short will be asked to purchase a new one or have the hem taken out in a timely manner. Uniform skirts cannot be rolled at the waist. To check for appropriate length, the gap between the student's knee and the hem of her skirt must not be greater than three inches. Use the length of the student ID to measure. **Students are required to wear shorts and/or leggings (non-flare) under skirts at all times.**
3. SHORTS: Plaid walking shorts with SJA emblem may be worn. Length should be no shorter than **three** inches from the top of the knee.
4. PANTS: Navy uniform pants with school logo may be worn.
5. SHIRT: A white banded-bottom knit shirt with school emblem should be worn daily; however, these shirts cannot be worn on dress uniform days. T-shirts worn underneath must be solid white and tucked into the uniform bottom. P.E. t-shirts cannot be worn underneath.
6. SENIOR SHIRT: In place of the uniform shirt, seniors may wear a red banded-bottom uniform shirt with emblem daily except on specific dress uniform days as determined by the Dean of Women.
7. SOCKS: White ankle, crew socks or no-show socks with or without the school logo are to be worn. No colored socks are allowed.
8. SWEATERS: Sweaters or sweater vests must be a solid navy or red V-neck. All sweaters must bear the monogrammed logo and must be worn over uniform blouse. Only the red sweater or sweater vest are allowed on dress uniform days. Uniform shirts must be worn underneath the sweater during school hours.
9. SHOES: Athletic tennis shoes must tie and have a closed heel and toe (no high tops). The canvas part

of the shoes must be predominantly white, black, navy or gray (no patterns) and be worn with white socks. No slip-on tennis shoes are allowed. Shoe laces can be any color. Predominately white, black, navy and gray shoes are acceptable on non-dress uniform days. Shoes with patterns are not acceptable, even if the pattern uses white, black, navy and/or gray.

10. SWEATSHIRTS/LETTER SWEATERS: Red or navy monogrammed sweatshirts must be purchased from the Sticker Shop and can be worn on a daily basis except for dress uniform days. CHS letter sweaters (Bruinettes, CHS Cheer, Band and Choir), **other non-uniform sweatshirt styles from the Sticker Shop** and SJA sports team **or club** sweatshirts may only be worn on Fridays, as long as it is not a dress uniform day. Uniform shirts must be worn under sweatshirts/letter sweaters. Hoodies are not permitted to be worn during school hours.
11. JACKETS/COATS: Any jacket purchased from the uniform vendor must have a logo.
 - a. Navy fleece jackets with the SJA logo: Students can wear any navy fleece with or without the SJA logo. If the fleece does not have an SJA logo, it cannot have any logo. Fleece jackets purchased from the uniform vendors have the logo.
 - b. Navy blazer or solid navy jacket or SJA letter jacket.
 - c. Overcoats can be any color but must be removed once in the classroom unless they are navy blue or red.
 - d. Rain coats or rain jackets: Students are allowed to wear any color rain jacket (on rainy days), but they must be taken off inside classrooms unless they are navy or red.
12. SWEATPANTS: Students can purchase uniform sweatpants from the Sticker Shop. Students will be allowed to wear these as their uniform bottoms starting on the first Monday after Thanksgiving until the last day of February. **Sweatpants for individual sports teams should not be worn during the school day outside of Fridays.**
13. TIGHTS: Navy or black tights/leggings can be worn on cold days with or without uniform socks. Mid-calf leggings and yoga-type pants are not allowed.

P.E. Uniforms

1. SHIRT: Regulation shirts must be purchased on SchoolCash Online. The student's first initial and last name should be written on the front of the shirt with a permanent marker.
2. SHORTS: Any predominately red or navy shorts that are of appropriate length and fit and comfortable for physical activities are acceptable. No boxer shorts or cut-off shorts. Shorts should be longer than the PE shirt.
3. SOCKS: White socks should be worn. Uniform socks must be worn at all times outside of P.E. class.
4. SHOES: Any color tennis shoes are acceptable. Tennis shoes must tie and have a back.
5. WARM-UPS: Warm-ups may be worn over the P.E. uniform.

Slogans/Images

The wearing or displaying of clothing, stickers, pins and accessories with political slogans/images/promotions and/or any content deemed inappropriate is prohibited. Accessories of any kind should be of a positive nature and align with the teachings of the Catholic church.

Accessories

The only piercings allowed will be traditional earrings in the earlobes. Three piercings in the lobe area only are allowed. Other facial piercings are not allowed. The student will be asked to remove any unapproved jewelry, and disciplinary action may be taken. Modest jewelry is appropriate for school days.

Hats of any kind cannot be worn to school unless part of a special dress/costume day. Only beanies/wool/knit caps purchased from the SJA Sticker Stop are allowed during the winter months.

Headphones/earbuds should be removed when traveling from class to class and during assemblies. They can be worn in the classroom at the teacher's discretion.

Fun Day Guidelines

Fun Days are monthly celebrations for students, faculty and staff. Each Fun Day has a specific theme that students can choose to dress within, or they may wear their traditional SJA uniform. Fun Days are not considered free dress days. Students who are not dressed within the specific theme and/or Fun Day guidelines will be issued an infraction.

General Guidelines:

- IDs must be worn with costume at all times
- No spaghetti tank tops/no sports bras visible
- No crop tops of any kind/no exposed midriff of any kind
- No skirts or shorts shorter than school skirts. This includes but is not limited to Gold hinge, Lululemon, Nike, Free People, Outdoor Voices or Athleta style shorts/skirts. Your bottom MUST be at or longer than the approved school skirt length. If leggings are worn as part of your costume, your bottom/buttock must be fully covered by your top
- No toy weapons
- No glitter/no feathers
- No full-face paint/no full face masks
- No faux facial hair
- No sleepwear (PJ's, boxers, night gowns, **muumuus**); onesies are permitted
- No swim wear, bathing suits (over or under clothing)
- No lamp-shading. Your bottoms should be longer than your t-shirt.

SJA Dress Guidelines for Formal Attire

SJA dances are for SJA students only. Students may bring a male student from another school if desired. Students are expected to dress appropriately for all formal events ensuring they are modest, mindful and prepared for the event's environment. **The Back-To-School Dance is themed, casual attire; FROSH is considered a semi-formal dance; and Winter Formal and SJA Prom are considered formal dances.** Students can wear dresses, formal **women's** separates, jumpsuits/rompers or women's pantsuits. SJA students are not permitted to wear men's attire (suits, tuxedos, etc.) to events.

Dresses must have modest necklines with an exposed back at or near the traditional bra line. Dresses can be strapless, one shoulder or spaghetti strapped, but cutouts or visible midriffs are not permitted. Hemlines and slits should be a maximum of four inches above the knee.

Students who attend an event and are not in compliance with the dress guidelines are subject to disciplinary consequences and/or dismissal from the event.

Hair

Hair must be a natural color. Complimentary highlights and lowlights are allowed; however, extreme color changes, including but not limited to half-and-half color blocking, fluorescent or candy hair dye, are not allowed. Feathers, hair wraps, flower headpieces, scarves, bandanas as a head covering and colored hair extensions are not allowed. The final decision regarding hair color issues will be determined by the Dean of Women. Please note that extremely short/shaved haircuts are not permitted. Students considering a very short haircut should discuss it in advance with the Dean of Women.

Students who are not within the uniform guidelines for hair may be required to make changes to their hair prior to being permitted to return to campus.

Makeup

Makeup should be modest and worn at the discretion of the Dean of Women.

Tattoos

No visible tattoos are allowed.

STUDENT ID CARDS/LANYARDS

Freshmen will take photo ID pictures during Welcome Week. Sophomores and juniors will take photo ID pictures during orientation. Seniors will take their ID photos over the summer months during their drape/cap-and-gown photo sessions. Students are required to wear their school ID on an issued lanyard at all times during the school day. IDs must be worn on the outside of the uniform and be visible at all times. The student's name and picture must be visible at all times. Stickers are not permitted on Student IDs. **Any pins on their lanyard should be of a positive nature and align with the teachings of the Catholic church.**

Replacement IDs can be purchased on SchoolCash Online. Students not wearing IDs may be issued an infraction.

SYSTEM OF DISCIPLINE

The discipline system is designed to uphold the dignity of the individual; provide an atmosphere conducive to learning; and respect the needs of all members of the school community. Implementation of the discipline system requires education and a commitment to communication between all parties. In most cases, the classroom teacher is first in the hierarchy to confront a disciplinary matter. More serious discipline issues will be referred to the administration. The administration may call in outside community support. All final decisions are made by the administration. Students should be aware that their actions (no matter when engaged in) can reflect on SJA and that they are subject to disciplinary consequences on a 24/7/365 basis. For additional information regarding the St. Joseph's Academy system of discipline, contact the Dean of Women.

Under ordinary circumstances, consequences are progressive in nature. That is, second offenses are generally treated more harshly than first offenses. If a student continually violates school rules, the administration may take more serious action than is specifically described in this system.

It is possible that a student and her parents will be asked to sign a contract in order for the student to remain at SJA. Failure to follow the terms of the contract may result in the student being asked to leave.

Infractions

All students are allowed one warning infraction per semester unless a Category II or III has been issued. All disciplinary consequences remain on file for the duration of a student's time at SJA. Students will be emailed an infraction notification. Infractions may result in a student not being able to hold or be removed from a leadership role. Parents can access their daughter's conduct record through MySJA.

The Dean of Women reserves the right to supersede a warning checklist and mandate a consequence beyond that.

Category I: Personal Responsibility – 45-minute Friday Detention

- 1st infraction is a warning. The infraction is recorded through MySJA. No parent notification required.
- 2nd-3rd infractions: 45-minute Friday detention. The infraction is recorded through MySJA. No parent notification required.
- 4th infraction: 45-minute Friday detention and meeting with Dean of Women. The infraction is recorded through MySJA. Parents notified.
- 5-plus: Move to Category II infraction (2-hour Saturday School), phone call to parents, infraction recorded through MySJA.

Examples of Category I infractions:

- Unexcused absences (counted by class period)
- Violation of the cellphone policy
- Disturbance (off task or inappropriate behaviors in the classroom environment, talking/laughing during Mass, etc.)
- Improper Uniform (forgetting dress uniform for mass, wearing incorrect colored socks, etc.)
- Irresponsibility (missing a scheduled makeup test without notice, getting a loaner laptop from the

TLC, etc.)

- **Chewing gum, eating/drinking in a classroom building**
- No ID (must be on body and visible outside of uniform)
- No doctor's note received (not turned in within the three-day window)
- Parking infraction (no visible parking tag in vehicle, not following arrival/dismissal procedures)
- Tardiness (infraction issued starting with third unexcused tardy)
- Technology use (not using assigned computer case to transport laptop)
- Other actions that fall under Personal Responsibility as determined by the Dean of Women

Category II: Respect for Property and Others - 2-hour Saturday or School Holiday Detention:

- 1st-2nd infractions supersede warning infraction. The infraction is recorded through MySJA, meeting with grade-level counselor, recorded in MySJA, returned to Deans' office, two-hour Saturday/holiday school.
- 3rd infraction: recorded through MySJA, phone call to parent, meet with grade-level counselor, two-hour Saturday/holiday school. Student and parents meet with principal.
- 4th infraction: issued to and signed by student and parent, returned to Deans' office, Saturday/holiday suspension, phone call to parents, meet with grade-level counselor.

Examples of Category II infractions:

- Academic dishonesty, 1st offense (as described in the Academic Integrity Policy)
- Damaging school property (writing on campus desks, etc.)
- Missing Friday detention (Saturday school in addition to a rescheduling of assigned detention)
- Technology issues (violation of the Social Media Policy, inappropriate use of school technology, etc.)
- Unmannerly behavior and/or disrespect (on or off campus and through online methods)
- Other actions that fall under Respect for Property and Others as determined by the Dean of Women

Category III: Major Irresponsibilities/Infractions - 6-hour Saturday or Holiday Suspension:

- 1st infraction: Written infraction issued to and signed by student and parent, recorded in MySJA, returned to the Deans' office; phone call or meeting with parents, 6-hour Saturday/**holiday** suspension, meet with grade-level counselor.
- 2nd infraction: Two days of Saturday/holiday suspension, student and parents meet with the Principal, possible disciplinary contract and possible expulsion.
- 3rd infraction: Possible expulsion.

Examples of Category III infractions:

- Academic dishonesty, 2nd offense (as described in our Academic Integrity Policy)
- Alcohol possession/distribution/use
- Destruction of property (intentional damage to school laptop, defacing school walls with graffiti, etc.)
- Drug possession/distribution/use
- Leaving campus (a student leaving campus gates without permission from an adult and/or supervision)
- Major disrespect (threats of physical violence, defaming language, etc.)
- Skipping class
- Smoking, Juuling, Vaping
- Stealing
- Technology issues (violation of the Social Media Policy, intentional damage to technology, etc.)
- Weapons possession/distribution/use
- Other actions that fall under Major Irresponsibilities/Infractions as determined by the Dean of Women

A student should be aware that having a suspension on her record could affect her ability to become an SJA Student Ambassador or Student Council member, impact her position on a sports team and/or affect her ability

to participate in upcoming events.

Detentions and Saturday School

If a student receives a detention Monday through Thursday, she must attend detention the Friday of the same week. If a specific week does not have classes on Friday, detention will be held on the Thursday of that week or the following Friday. Students may also be assigned a detention on Friday mornings (6:35-7:20 a.m.) for specific infractions. Students who receive an infraction on a Friday will attend detention on the following Friday. Friday detentions are traditionally from 3 to 3:45 p.m. Students will not be allowed to move their detention due to vacations, student jobs or other non-medical appointments. Proof of medical appointments must be provided.

Permission to be excused from detention can only be granted by the Dean of Women after a phone call from a parent. After-school jobs, carpool issues or athletic practices will not be excused absences from detention. Only students who are ill, have a family emergency or athletic event may be excused from detention with advance approval.

Students may not study or talk to others during detention. If a student cannot make a Friday detention, parents must call the Dean of Women at least one day prior to the student's assigned detention date to ask permission to be excused. A student who misses Friday detention will automatically be issued a Category II infraction and required to make up the detention as well as serve the consequences for the Category II infraction, which includes 2 hours on a Saturday/holiday.

Those students who receive five or more infractions in a semester or any Category II or III infraction will be required to serve a Saturday/Holiday School as assigned by the Dean of Women. Saturday School is set on a monthly basis and per the availability of the Dean of Women. Students will be assigned a specific time frame to attend based on their consequence(s) and are expected to serve their consequence within a month of their infraction. A parent must contact the Dean of Women to reschedule his/her daughter's Saturday School in advance. A student who misses her assigned Saturday School without approval is subject to additional disciplinary consequences.

Appeal Process

Any student who feels she should have not received an infraction has the right to appeal. Students should contact the Dean of Women to let her know that they are appealing the infraction. Only the person who issued the infraction, the Dean of Women or the Principal can rescind an infraction. The appeal process must be brought to completion within three school days. If a student is in the appeal process, she does not attend detention until the matter has been fully resolved and the infraction rescinded.

BATHROOM USAGE POLICY

To maintain a strong learning environment, students are encouraged to use the restrooms during unstructured time, including lunches and travel time from class to class. If permitted to go during class time, students are expected to use the restroom closest to their class and quickly return to instruction. Students are expected to use women's restrooms across campus and should not use any faculty (men and/or women) bathroom under any circumstances. If a student is found in a faculty restroom, she will be subject to disciplinary action.

Bathrooms are private spaces. Students should avoid congregating or socializing in the bathroom and are expected to use the facilities and leave promptly to allow others their turn. Videoing or photographing should not happen in the bathroom at any time. Bathroom stalls are available for single use. At no time should more than one student be in a single stall. In cases of emergency, students are expected to alert an adult for assistance. If more than one student is seen in one bathroom stall, they may be subject to disciplinary action.

Items other than tissue paper should be discarded in the trash can. Feminine products should not be flushed as they can cause severe backup in the drainage system. Students are expected to report any cleanliness issue or damage to a faculty or staff member immediately.

DRUG/ALCOHOL POLICY

St. Joseph's Academy is fully committed to maintaining a drug- and alcohol-free campus. The use of drugs and alcohol has a profound negative impact on our students' academic performance and personal growth. SJA works in partnership with our students' parents to provide a threefold approach to uphold our commitment to maintaining a drug-free campus with drug-free students: preventative education, counseling and disciplinary action.

St. Joseph's Academy has adopted a comprehensive no-use alcohol and drug prevention curriculum that aims to empower students with knowledge that prevents them from making harmful choices related to alcohol and drugs. Students are exposed to lessons in health classes, on wellness days and in regularly scheduled class visits from grade-level counselors that teach them about the physical, psychological and relational side effects of alcohol and drug use.

As part of our commitment to supporting our students and maintaining a drug- and alcohol-free campus, SJA may require drug testing of any student when, in the professional opinion of the administration and counselors, there is reasonable concern that the student has used an illegal substance. Students who violate the alcohol and drug policy are subject to disciplinary consequences including a disciplinary contract, suspension or dismissal.

Students who admit to or test positive for substance use will be **required to obtain a outside counselor and must complete an educational program monitored by the Dean of Women's office**. If the student refuses or prematurely terminates counseling, she may be asked to withdraw from SJA.

The use, possession, distribution, sale or being under the influence of alcohol or any other drug-related substance while the student is on or off the school campus is strictly prohibited. Students who are suspected of alcohol use are subject to suspension or dismissal from the Academy. Students are expected to not participate in underage drinking or host events/parties where alcohol is provided, consumed or available for minors.

DRUGS

Unauthorized use, possession or distribution of prescription or nonprescription drugs or alcohol prior to, during or after the school day or a school event is a serious matter and is subject to immediate disciplinary action, including expulsion. If a student is suspected of being in possession of drugs, the administration will question and search the student's belongings, which could include her backpack, cellphone, locker and vehicle (if applicable). Refusal by the student or parent to permit the search will lead to additional suspension or dismissal from the Academy.

For the context of this handbook, illegal substances are all forms of drugs or any "legal" drugs that by law can only be purchased by those 21 and older. This includes but is not limited to tobacco or CBD vapes, Delta 8, alcohol, **Zyn pouches**, **Kratom**, marijuana/THC, etc.

If a student is in possession of drugs of any kind, the items will be confiscated and, depending on type of substance, police will be involved.

SMOKING AND VAPING

SJA is a smoke- and vape-free campus. Use or possession of vaping, juuling or smoking paraphernalia on campus or at a school-related event is a serious matter and is subject to immediate disciplinary action, which could include expulsion.

Any tobacco product, vaping materials or smoking-related material found in a student's possession will be confiscated. If a student is found to be in possession of a smoking device or participates in smoking while on the SJA campus or at a school-related event, immediate testing will be required as directed by the administration, at the parents' expense, for the student to return to campus for a disciplinary hearing. Delay in testing may lead to additional suspension or dismissal from the Academy.

SEARCHES AND SEIZURES

School officials have the right to conduct a reasonable search of the student and her possessions, including laptop, backpack, cell phone and vehicle (parked on or off campus, registered or unregistered through SJA) for illegal and/or illicit materials. Additionally, the administration reserves the right to inspect any and all lockers at any time. Refusal by the student or parent to permit the search will lead to additional suspension or dismissal from the Academy.

SAFE HOMES

The SJA Safe Homes Program is designed to encourage communication between parents and their children as well as parents and other parents. By agreeing to participate in the program, parents and students accept the responsibility for a drug- and alcohol-free environment. Safe Home participants agree to the following:

1. Not to permit unchaperoned parties in their homes or on their property which involve their daughter and her friends.
 2. Not to permit the serving to or consumption of alcohol or illegal substances by their daughter or her friends at any party or other social activity for which they are responsible.
 3. If their daughter's friends are attending a party or social activity in their home while under their supervision and appear to be under the influence of alcohol or other drugs, they will not allow the friend to leave without contacting the friend's parents to arrange safe transportation home.
 4. To encourage other families to join the Safe Homes Program.
 5. To encourage parents to verify a family's participation in the Safe Homes Program by using the online Student Directory before allowing their daughter to attend a social function with that family.
 6. To allow SJA to indicate their participation in the Safe Homes Program in the online Student Directory.
- Participation in the Safe Homes Program is encouraged, and participating families are expected to uphold these guidelines. However, Safe Homes is voluntary, and this is not a legally binding document. Parents are able to elect participation through the Handbook Acknowledgment form each year.

UNSTRUCTURED TIME

Students are welcome to use their unstructured time (before/after school, unstructured periods and lunch) in the Technology and Learning Center, Fife Student Commons, dining hall or outdoor areas. When permitted by the teacher and with supervision, a student may spend her unstructured time in an academic classroom/building.

STUDENT COMMUNICATIONS (EMAIL, CHAT AND SOCIAL MEDIA)

Appropriate Online Behavior

St. Joseph's Academy strives to provide the tools necessary for students to succeed academically but also encourages the appropriate use of technological resources and social media as primary means of maximizing student learning and achieving the mission and goals of the school. Further, recognizing that the proper use of these resources is a privilege, not a right, SJA accepts the responsibility to exercise all reasonable control to protect the safety and legitimate needs of the students in their use of the school's technology. Language used should be appropriate on all communication streams. Social media refers to online tools and services that allow any internet user to create and publish content.

Cell Phone/Smart Watch Policy

Cell phone use by students is not permitted during school hours. Before or after school, students are permitted to use their cellphones in any area. Students are **required** to turn off their cellphones in their bags/bookbags during the school day, including during lunch or unstructured periods. They should remain off and stowed away until the final bell rings. Cellphones are not permitted in the Technology and Learning Center during school hours. Students can wear smart watches but are not permitted to use them to text or make phone calls during the school day.

If a student is sick and needs to leave school, she must go to the nurse's office to call her parents. If a student needs to contact her parent during the school day, she is expected to email or go to the Main Office to make a

phone call. If a student is found using her cell phone, holding the cellphone in her hand, **having her cellphone on her person**, having it out and visible on her desk or texting/making calls on her smart watch, in or outside of a classroom building, restroom, common space (Quad, Fife Student Commons or Dining Hall) or any campus area during school hours), she will have the device taken from her. She will retrieve it, along with an infraction, at the end of the day from the Dean of Women.

The use of cellular devices in an unacceptable manner in the school setting is prohibited. Examples of unacceptable usage can include but are not limited to the following: use of a device for any purpose inside a restroom, use of a device on the school campus for cheating, cyber bullying, sexting and taking inappropriate pictures or videos (including videos that contain inappropriate music). Students are to refrain from creating videos with inappropriate content/**music** while wearing the school uniform at any time.

Regardless of your privacy settings, assume that all of the information you have shared on your social network is public information.

Students are not to record or take pictures of other students, faculty or staff without consent.

Teachers will require students to stow away cell phones, smart watches or other devices that might distract the student while completing any graded work in the classroom. The classroom teacher has the discretion to determine when these items can be used for educational purposes.

The use of smart watches and cell phones while testing, including exams, tests, quizzes, etc., is prohibited. Teachers will ask students to remove smart watches before any assignment or assessment. They will also ask students to put their cellphones in the designated areas within each classroom. If a student has her cellphone or smartwatch on her person in a testing environment, she is subject to the Academic Dishonesty Policy and its consequences.

Social Media Policy and Student Email Usage

SJA encourages our students to be strong digital citizens, using the technology platforms, including social media, in a responsible manner. Students using SJA email, teams or internet access are representatives of the school and are expected to act in a manner consistent with the ideals of SJA. Communications on the internet (including social media sites) and via email/teams reflect on SJA and must not damage the school's reputation. Students must maintain proper etiquette while using social media and any electronic device.

Students should be mindful of engagement on social media and filming of content at all times, especially in your SJA uniform, on or off campus. Engagement in online social media such as but not limited to Facebook, Instagram, Snapchat, Tik Tok, etc., will result in disciplinary action if the content includes inappropriate music or photographs derogatory and disrespectful speech, cyberbullying and/or morally inappropriate behavior.

Regardless of your privacy settings, assume that all of the information you have shared on your social network is public information. Students are expected to conduct themselves at all times in a manner consistent with the mission of SJA with a Christian attitude and respect for others. This expectation applies at all times, including through social media. Students should be aware that their actions (no matter when engaged in) can reflect on SJA and that they are subject to disciplinary consequences on a 24/7/365 basis.

Users may connect SJA email accounts to personal mobile devices, but in doing so, the user acknowledges that SJA reserves the right to remotely wipe the device.

Students are prohibited from changing the display name or photograph associated with their account.

Social Media/Parents

Parents are asked to set a good example for students when accessing and using social media. Engagement in social media including but not limited to Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, etc., may result in disciplinary

action and/or dismissal if the content of the student or parent's post includes defamatory comments regarding the school, the faculty or other students. We ask parents not to take unauthorized videos or pictures of students and to get the consent of both the students and their parents whenever possible before posting.

TABLET/TECHNOLOGY POLICY

St. Joseph's Academy strives to provide the technology tools necessary to succeed academically. Each student is issued a laptop computer to be used in and out of school. To ensure consistent, responsible and productive technology usage, SJA has developed the following policy. It is our expectation that students, parents and faculty/staff abide by these rules.

Tablet Responsibilities

St. Joseph's Academy assigns each student a tablet computer, power cord, stylus and carrying case, which must be brought to school every day. These items remain the property of SJA. Each student is responsible for the care of her assigned tablet computer and accessories. No stickers, decals, paint, writing or other defacement should be made on the tablet computer or case.

Failure to bring the tablet computer and/or carrying case to school will result in an infraction; the student will be issued a temporary loaner computer to use during the day. No part of the computer is to be removed or tampered with.

Failure to use the school-issued carrying case when transporting the tablet computer will result in an infraction. No other cases or sleeves may be used, including built-in backpack sleeves, as this voids the warranty on the computer. Failure to use the school-issued AC charger or using a charger not provided by the school will result in an infraction and voids the school's liability if an issue arises.

Tablets must never be loaned to someone or left unattended/unsecured. If a tablet is found unattended on school property, the student will receive an infraction for irresponsibility. Tablets should go home with students each evening and must not be left at school during vacations.

All storage, network communication, equipment and software provided by St. Joseph's Academy remain the property of SJA. The school seeks, where possible, to honor the privacy of the individual. It reserves the right, however, to access any file, email, network transmission or other information stored on or communicated through its property and will do so if a compelling reason arises. St. Joseph's Academy retains the right to monitor network activity in any manner it sees fit.

Misuse includes any online conduct on or off campus which negatively affects the reputation of the students or any member of the SJA community. This includes but is not limited to sending or posting messages that suggest harassment, racism, sexism or inappropriate language, music and/or symbols; and sending or displaying unchristian, immoral, offensive, violent, pornographic, obscene or sexually explicit messages or pictures.

The individual has no reasonable expectation of privacy.

Help Desk Policies

The Help Desk is open from 6:45 a.m. to 5 p.m. on Monday-Thursday and 6:45 a.m. to 4 p.m. on Friday. Summer hours are 8 a.m.-2 p.m. Monday-Thursday. If a student experiences an issue with her tablet computer that prevents her from completing her schoolwork or participating in class, she must visit the Help Desk as soon as possible before school, during her lunch or unstructured period or after school. A student should only visit the Help Desk during class time with her teacher's permission, and only in emergency situations.

When a student must turn her tablet computer into the Help Desk for repair:

1. The student will be issued a loaner computer to use while her assigned computer is being repaired. The student will be held responsible for any damages to the loaner while it is in her care.

2. The Help Desk will diagnose the issue(s) and order the appropriate parts from the vendor.
3. The Help Desk will repair and quality check the computer to ensure the issue is resolved.
4. The student will be notified that her computer is ready to be picked up. She should back up all necessary files from her loaner and return the loaner in the same condition as it was checked out to her.
5. The student should pick up her computer within three school days of receiving the ready notice. If a fee is incurred due to repairs, this will be communicated to the student and parent through an invoice.

Tablet Computer Repairs

Each Asus EliteBook B3402 tablet computer is covered by a warranty. The warranty does not cover loss of the power cord, stylus or case. If these items are lost, the student will be responsible for the cost of replacement. If these items are damaged, the student needs to bring them to the Help Desk to determine if the item is covered by insurance. All replacement parts are to be purchased through SJA on SchoolCash Online.

Parents may choose to purchase insurance through SJA to provide additional coverage. The annual insurance policy will cover repairs each year up to the value of the unit.

The insurance policy will not cover deliberate damage or cosmetic damage that does not interfere with the function of the computer. Damage resulting from failure to use the school-provided carrying case or charger is not considered accidental damage and will not be covered by the insurance policy. The insurance policy does not cover the following: theft from an unlocked, unattended vehicle; corrosion or rust; intentional damage; dishonest acts; power surges except lightning; unexplained loss; and war or government seizure.

Damages to the Tablet Computer

If a student accidentally damages her tablet computer, she should bring it to the Help Desk at her earliest convenience to be checked in for repair. Help Desk staff will repair the computer using the student's one-time use of her Accidental Damage Protection (ADP) followed by her insurance policy where applicable. If insurance was not purchased, the computer will be repaired at the student's expense.

If a student damages her tablet computer or a loaner computer a second time, she will be referred to the Dean of Women for disciplinary action. The cost of the damage must be covered by the student.

If a student loses her computer, she must immediately notify the Help Desk. She will be issued a temporary loaner computer and an infraction for irresponsibility. If the tablet computer is not recovered by the end of the school day, she will be referred to the Dean of Women for further action.

If found, a lost computer should be brought immediately to the Help Desk located in the Technology & Learning Center (TLC), and the Help Desk should be notified by email. If the TLC is not open, the computer should be given to a faculty or staff member.

Theft of an SJA tablet computer must be reported to the Dean of Women and the Help Desk as soon as possible. Theft of the tablet computer is not covered by the manufacturer warranty or the ADP, but may be covered by the tablet insurance policy depending on the circumstances of the theft.

All Help Desk/Technology balances need to be current before taking mid-term and final exams.

Each student is issued an SJA network account that serves as their computer account, email account, Moodle account and Adobe account. Once set, SJA network passwords are valid for 180 days. A student must be on the SJA campus connected to the SJA wireless network to change her password.

Password requirements are as follows:

- a. Must be 10 characters or longer
- b. Must include one uppercase letter and one lowercase letter

- c. Must include one number or special character
- d. Cannot contain the user's account name or parts of the user's full name that exceed two consecutive characters

To change her password, a student must either be on SJA campus connected to the SJA wireless network, or through the self-service password reset tool. The password reset tool must be set up with the student's verification methods prior to her password expiring. To set up the password reset tool, visit the Password Reset Setup.

File Storage

A common directory is provided to assist with temporary storage needs for work done as teams. These files are not protected and can be read, modified or deleted by anyone. These files are not backed up and may be purged without notice. The common drive is purged on or around the 1st and 15th of each month. Only school-related files may be stored on the common drive.

Every student accepts the responsibility of backing up on a regular basis. The student may choose to use the school-provided, cloud-based storage or other forms of backup (i.e. USB drives, external hard drives, personal cloud-based storage accounts, etc.).

Prohibited Behaviors

Using the SJA-issued tablet or other devices to participate in any of the following is strictly prohibited:

- not abiding by the Academic Integrity Policy
- conducting or participating in any actions which are illegal (according to city, state or federal law)
- violating any of this institution's policies
- threatening, bullying or harassing others
- use of inappropriate, disrespectful language or derogatory speech towards one another or about others (foul language)
- advocating racial, ethnic, religious or gender-based slurs
- purposely frustrating others from achieving their educational goals
- infringing software copyright or licensing agreements
- purposely viewing, displaying, storing or transmitting any obscene or discriminatory material or material of terrorists, gangs, hate groups, etc.
- conducting commercial or private/personal business enterprises
- promoting private businesses, product advertisement or political lobbying
- sending unauthorized bulk or random messages (e.g., junk mail, ads, etc.)
- soliciting for organizations that are unrelated to the institution's mission or purpose
- destroying the integrity of computer-based information
- maliciously installing or invoking a computer virus or other disruptive mechanism
- altering system files or configuration to disrupt computer or network functions
- seeking or gaining unauthorized access to network resources or resources on the internet or attempting to breach security mechanisms
- downloading movies and any other medium which is against the law
- downloading games, images, etc.
- sharing school-related files when the project, activity or assignment is to be done independently
- communicating via the internet, email or social networking sites in a manner which reflects negatively on St. Joseph's Academy
- posting/sending personal photos or videos which are inappropriate
- using the tablet in order to copy another person's work
- misuse of web cam
- videoing or photographing another person, including other students and SJA faculty/staff members, without permission
- soliciting donations unless school approved
- placing any stickers on the computer.

VISITORS

All visitors to the school must report to and sign in at the main office for a nametag and permission to remain on campus. For school events when guests are invited, a kiosk will be available in the Academy Student Center. When communicated, a pre-check in process will be available for our parents. A driver's license is needed for efficient check-in, or the visitor can type in his/her personal information. For frequent visitors, a quick-pin is issued to help streamline the process.